

The Prop Firm Option

Every positive-expected-value prop-firm programme, optimised setting by setting and derived step by step: how much one person can expect to make per month, and the mathematics behind every number.

\$138,412 expected per month, one person, recommended plan

Expected values for a trader with no predictive skill, under each firm's written rules as read on 4 October 2026, from simulations and exact calculations described in full inside. Firms may refuse payouts (Chapter 29 prices that risk). Not investment advice. Do not share or sell this plan: several firms close traders who run the same marketed strategy together.

Expected cash per month, one person

\$138,412

a month, $\pm$ \$4,867 (95%)

That is the expected cash, after every fee, that one person receives per month in the first year of the recommended plan: 28 accounts at 13 prop firms, each traded with zero predictive skill under every written rule of its firm, with the settings optimised in this document. From the second month on, once the first payouts arrive, the average is \$151,557 a month. The total for the first year has a median of \$1,552,019; in 90% of simulated years it lies between \$858,837 and \$2,745,202.

\$63,427

Tier A firms only (15 accounts, 5 firms)

\$95,560

Tiers A and B (22 accounts, 7 firms)

\$163,234

Every firm at its full allowance (35 accounts)

\$151,715

Recommended + futures layer (53 accounts)

\$93,711

If payouts are refused 2% / 5% / 15% of the time by tier (Chapter 29)

\$64,499

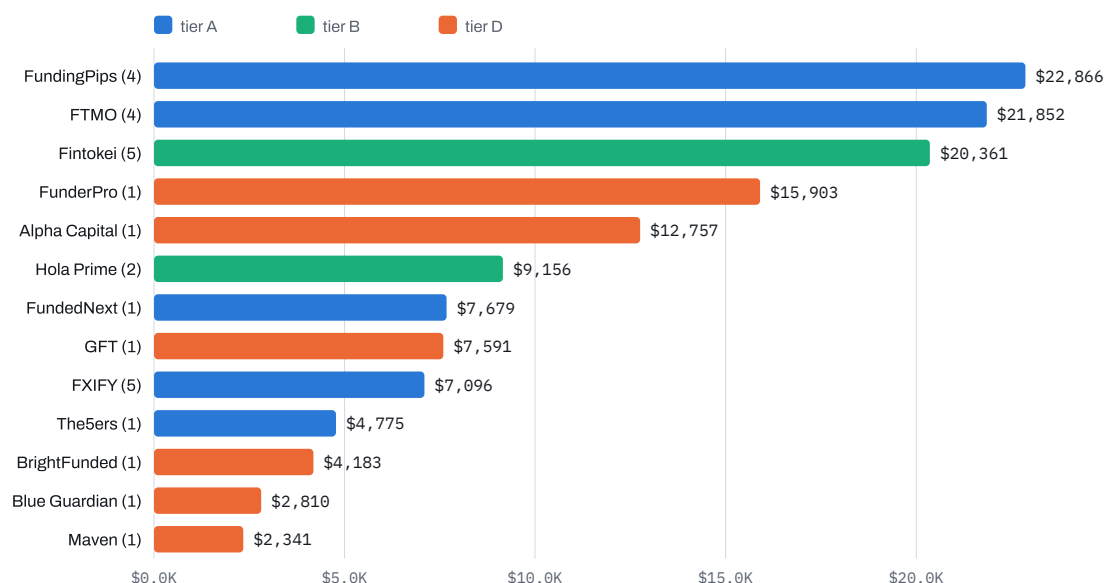
If refused 5% / 10% / 30% of the time

\$59,276

Cash needed for fees before payouts arrive (median; 5%: \$136,015)

63

Bracket orders a day across all accounts



Expected cash per month by firm in the recommended plan (number of accounts in brackets), from each account's renewal-reward value on fresh paths. Colour: the firm's reliability tier (Chapter 29).

Where it comes from

Programme	Tier	Market	Accounts	k / m / X	EV/month per account	EV/month
FTMO 2-Step	A	Nasdaq	4 × 100K	20 / 0.5 / 30%	\$5,463 ± \$342	\$21,852
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (85%) (cap)	A	USDJPY	4 × 100K	20 / 0.5 / 25%	\$5,716 ± \$316	\$22,866
The5ers High Stakes Classic	A	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	20 / 0.5 / 25%	\$4,775 ± \$250	\$4,775
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	12 / 1 / 30%	\$4,046 ± \$195	\$4,046
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 50K	12 / 1 / 30%	\$1,759 ± \$99	\$1,759
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 25K	12 / 1 / 30%	\$836 ± \$49	\$836
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 10K	12 / 1 / 30%	\$321 ± \$19	\$321
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 5K	12 / 1 / 30%	\$134 ± \$10	\$134
FundedNext Stellar	A	EURUSD	1 × 200K	20 / 1 / 25%	\$7,679 ± \$359	\$7,679
Fintokei ProTrader	B	Nasdaq	5 × 100K	12 / 0.5 / 25%	\$4,072 ± \$239	\$20,361
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	B	gold	2 × 100K	10 / 1 / 20%	\$4,578 ± \$210	\$9,156
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	30 / 0.5 / 30%	\$12,757 ± \$726	\$12,757
FunderPro Classic	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	30 / 0.35 / 30%	\$15,903 ± \$889	\$15,903
GFT Standard	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	8 / 0.75 / 8%	\$7,591 ± \$198	\$7,591
BrightFunded Classic	D	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	12 / 0.5 / 25%	\$4,183 ± \$234	\$4,183
Blue Guardian 2-Step	D	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	8 / 1 / 18%	\$2,810 ± \$169	\$2,810
Maven 2-Step	D	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	7 / 1 / 8%	\$2,341 ± \$105	\$2,341

Programme	Tier	Market	Accounts	k / m / X	EV/month per account	EV/month
28 accounts at 13 firms						\$139,369

k / m / X: reward-to-risk, stop in hourly standard deviations, funded cycle target as a share of the account. EV per account from the final run on fresh paths; the total (\$139,369) is the long-run rate, and the portfolio simulation's first-year average (\$138,412) agrees within its interval.

What the number means, and what it does not

- It is an **expected value**: the average over many possible years. A single year's cash is spread widely (the percentiles above) because funded-account payouts come in large, rare pieces.
- It assumes **zero skill**: every trade is a fair bet before costs. The value comes from the contract (a capped loss, a share of the gains), not from predicting prices. Part I proves why that is positive and how large.
- It assumes the firms **pay as their rules say**. The two scenarios above price the risk that they do not. That risk is real, and not measurable from public data.
- It assumes the **costs measured** in Chapter 3. Chapter 31 reruns every programme at 1.5 and 2 times those costs.
- It is **per person**: every firm limits what one person may hold, and Chapter 27 fills each limit. Accounts in anyone else's name are not allowed and are not in the plan.

How it was found

1. Part I derives every formula from first principles: the bracket trade, the pass probability (exactly, for any reward-to-risk), the funded account's payout (the withdrawal identity), time and value per month.
2. Every programme's settings (reward-to-risk k , stop m , funded cycle X , market, account size) were searched over 4,950 grid settings and 1,335 refined ones: 52 million simulated attempts under each firm's full rules.
3. Every reported figure was re-measured on price paths not used to choose it, and on the real 2024–26 history, and checked against exact equations written separately (Chapter 11).
4. The accounts were then run together, one person at a time, on one shared price path and calendar, 2,800 simulated years in all (Chapter 28).

Version 5's comparable plan (23 accounts at default settings) was worth \$86,084 a month in its own simulation. The gain comes from the optimised settings (Chapter 9), FXIFY's smaller accounts, a fifth Fintoeki account and FundedNext at 200K.

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Notation and conventions

Symbol	Meaning
S	account size
F	fee per attempt
A, A_1, A_2	profit target of a phase
B	maximum loss of a phase (distance to the floor)
d	daily loss limit
D	funded allowance (maximum loss of the funded account)
α	profit split
R	fee refund
X_1, X	funded cycle target: first, later
l, L	risk of a trade (L: the normal 1.5%)
k	reward-to-risk; a full win nets $w = kl$
w	net win of a trade (after cost)
c	round-trip cost of a trade
ρ	cost per dollar of risk, $c/l = \kappa/(m\sigma)$
σ	hourly standard deviation of the log price
m	stop distance in hourly standard deviations
s, u	stop and target distance as a fraction of the price
N	notional of a position, l/s
κ, φ	round-trip cost and overnight financing, as fractions of the notional
λ	leverage (1: λ)
p	win probability of one bracket
v	variance of one trade
P, P_1, P_2	pass probability
q_1, q	probability that a funded cycle reaches its target
θ	$2c/v$, the exponent of the Brownian formula
V, C, T	value of an attempt, funded cash, duration
K	expected total cost of a phase or cycle
EV/month	$30.44 \mathbb{E}[V]/\mathbb{E}[T]$ in days

Money is in US dollars. A 100K account is \$100,000 of simulated capital. $\pm$ is a 95% interval. "Fresh paths" are synthetic price paths that played no part in choosing the setting they measure. "Engine" is the rule-by-rule simulation; "chain" is the exact trade-level equations; "Brownian" is the continuous approximation. Tiers A, B, D are the firms' reliability classes (Chapter 29).

PART I

The mathematics, from zero

Every result in this document follows from a handful of facts about fair games. This part derives each of them from the beginning, with the numbers of the real plan worked through at every step. Nothing is assumed that is not proved or measured.

What is being bought

A proprietary trading firm ("prop firm") sells an *evaluation*. You pay a fee, you trade a simulated account under written rules, and if you meet the profit targets without breaking a loss limit, the firm gives you a *funded* account. On the funded account you keep a share of every profit you withdraw, and the firm absorbs every loss. You never owe the firm money beyond the fee.

That last sentence is the whole opportunity. Your downside is capped at the fee, and your upside is a share of profits that, as Chapter 7 proves, have a positive expected size even when every trade is a coin flip. The contract is an *option*: you pay a premium (the fee) for the right to keep part of the gains of a game whose losses fall on someone else.

1.1 The parts of the contract

Symbol	Meaning	FTMO 2-Step 100K, as an example
S	account size (simulated money)	\$100,000
F	fee for one attempt	\$632 (€540)
A_1, A_2	profit targets of phase 1 and phase 2	\$10,000 and \$5,000
B	maximum loss: the floor sits B below the starting balance and never moves ("static")	\$10,000
d	daily loss limit, measured from the balance at the start of each day	\$5,000
D	maximum loss on the funded account (the "allowance")	\$10,000
α	your share ("split") of every profit withdrawn	80%
R	fee refund, paid with the first payout	\$632
—	minimum trading days, payout cycle, other rules	4 days per phase; payouts every 14 days

1.2 The value of one attempt

Call the cash an attempt brings you V . It is the fee (always paid), plus, if both phases are passed, whatever the funded account pays out (the refund included):

VALUE OF ONE ATTEMPT

$$V = -F + \mathbf{1}\{\text{pass}\} \cdot C, \quad \mathbb{E}[V] = -F + \Pr(\text{pass}) \cdot \mathbb{E}[C \mid \text{pass}]$$

Here $\mathbf{1}\{\text{pass}\}$ is 1 if both phases are passed and 0 otherwise, and C is the total cash from the funded account. The second form uses the fact that the expectation of a product with an indicator is the probability times the conditional expectation. The rest of Part I computes the two unknowns, $\Pr(\text{pass})$ and $\mathbb{E}[C \mid \text{pass}]$, and then the time an attempt takes.

1.3 The whole argument in five lines

Before the details, the result in its simplest form, with no trading costs and no time. Chapter 5 proves that a fair game reaches a target A above its start before a floor B below with probability $B/(A+B)$. Chapter 7 proves that a funded account whose profits are withdrawn every cycle pays out, on average, exactly its allowance D before it is lost. Therefore:

FTMO 2-STEP, ZERO COST, ZERO SKILL

$$\begin{aligned} \Pr(\text{pass}) &= \frac{B}{A_1 + B} \cdot \frac{B}{A_2 + B} = \frac{10,000}{20,000} \cdot \frac{10,000}{15,000} = \frac{1}{3} \\ \mathbb{E}[V] &= -632 + \frac{1}{3} (0.8 \times 10,000 + 632) = -632 + 2,877 = +\$2,245 \end{aligned}$$

A coin-flipper who buys this contract makes, on average, \$2,245 per attempt. Everything else in this document refines this number: trading costs lower it, daily limits and rules change the time it takes, and the plan's settings are chosen to make the most of it per month and per person. The refinement takes the full engine of Part I; the sign of the answer is already settled here.

1.4 Why the firm still makes money

The firm's revenue is the fees of everyone, and most traders are not zero-skill coin-flippers with a plan built around the contract: they over-trade, break rules, abandon accounts and stop after one failure. The firm also pays out simulated profits only, so it carries no market risk of its own unless it copies trades. A plan that treats the contract as a mathematical object, follows every rule, and repeats it many times is the case the firm's pricing does not cover. That is also why every firm keeps the right to refuse payouts it judges to be "gambling" (Chapter 29) and why this plan follows every written rule.

The probability toolkit

Seven ideas carry the whole analysis. Each is stated, explained and, where short, proved.

2.1 Expected value and linearity

A random quantity X that takes values $x_1, x_2, \dots$ with probabilities $p_1, p_2, \dots$ has expected value

$$\mathbb{E}[X] = \sum_i p_i x_i.$$

The single most useful fact is *linearity*: for any random quantities, dependent or not,

$$\mathbb{E}[X + Y] = \mathbb{E}[X] + \mathbb{E}[Y], \quad \mathbb{E}[cX] = c \mathbb{E}[X].$$

Linearity is why the value of many accounts is the sum of their values, however strongly they move together (Chapter 28). Correlation changes the spread of outcomes, never the average.

2.2 Variance

The variance measures spread around the mean: $\text{Var}(X) = \mathbb{E}[(X - \mathbb{E}X)^2] = \mathbb{E}[X^2] - (\mathbb{E}X)^2$. Its square root is the standard deviation. For independent X, Y variances add, $\text{Var}(X + Y) = \text{Var} X + \text{Var} Y$; for dependent ones a covariance term $2 \text{Cov}(X, Y)$ is added. Variance enters in two places: the time a fair game takes to reach a target (Chapter 8), and the confidence intervals of every simulated number (Chapter 9).

2.3 Fair games and martingales

A sequence of account balances $X_0, X_1, X_2, \dots$ (one per trade, or per instant) is a *martingale* if, given everything known at step n , the expected next value is the current one:

$$\mathbb{E}[X_{n+1} \mid X_0, \dots, X_n] = X_n.$$

"Zero skill" means exactly this for the account balance before costs: no rule for choosing direction, size or timing can make the expected next balance higher than the current one, because the price itself is a martingale and the balance is a sum of positions times price changes. With costs, the expected next balance is *lower* by the cost: the balance is a *supermartingale*.

2.4 Stopping times and the optional stopping theorem

A *stopping time* τ is a rule for when to stop that uses only information available at the time: "stop when the balance first reaches the target or the floor" is one; "stop the day before the price falls" is not. The *optional stopping theorem* says that for a martingale and a stopping time that is almost surely finite, with the martingale bounded up to τ (true here: the balance lives between the floor and the target),

$$\mathbb{E}[X_\tau] = X_0.$$

No stopping rule turns a fair game into a profitable one. This single theorem gives the pass probability (Chapter 5), the win probability of a bracket (Chapter 4) and the funded account's value (Chapter 7).

2.5 Wald's identity

If each step adds an amount with mean μ (the same every step) and τ is a stopping time with finite mean, then the total gained by time τ has mean

$$\mathbb{E}[X_\tau - X_0] = \mu \mathbb{E}[\tau].$$

It converts a known final distribution into an expected number of steps: it gives the expected number of trades in a phase when trades cost money (Chapter 5).

2.6 Brownian motion

The continuous-time limit of a fair random walk is Brownian motion W_t : it starts at 0, its increments over disjoint intervals are independent, and $W_{t+h} - W_t$ is normally distributed with mean 0 and variance h . A process $X_t = \mu t + \sigma W_t$ has drift μ and variance σ^2 per unit time. Three of its martingales carry most of the analysis:

$$X_t - \mu t, \quad (X_t - \mu t)^2 - \sigma^2 t, \quad \exp\left(-\frac{\mu}{\sigma^2} X_t\right).$$

The first is the definition of drift. The second follows because the variance grows linearly in time. The third is the *exponential martingale*: for $\lambda = -2\mu/\sigma^2$, Itô's formula gives $d e^{\lambda X} = e^{\lambda X} (\lambda \mu + \frac{1}{2} \lambda^2 \sigma^2) dt + (\dots) dW$, and the dt term vanishes exactly when $\lambda = -2\mu/\sigma^2$.

2.7 The reflection principle

For a Brownian path that goes from a to b over a time interval with variance v , the chance that it rose above a level $y \geq \max(a, b)$ somewhere in between is

$$\Pr(\max \geq y \mid a \rightarrow b) = \exp\left(-\frac{2(y-a)(y-b)}{v}\right).$$

Reflect the path at its first touch of y : every path that touches y and ends at b corresponds one-to-one to a path that ends at $2y - b$, whose density relative to ending at b is the exponential above. This formula is how the simulation draws the highs and lows inside each hour exactly (Chapter 3), so that stops and targets are touched as often as a real continuous price touches them.

The price model

3.1 Hourly volatility

Prices are modelled in logarithms. Over one hour the log price changes by a random amount with mean zero and standard deviation σ , the *hourly volatility*, measured on two years of real hourly bars (Yahoo Finance, 2024–26, only hours that follow another trading hour):

Market	Price, 2 Oct 2026	Hourly σ	Daily σ	Round-trip cost κ	Financing ϕ per night	κ/σ	Entry hours (UTC)
Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100)	31,070.00	0.2737%	1.31%	0.0064%	0.0150%	0.023	01–20
USDJPY	157.83	0.1193%	0.58%	0.0051%	0.0020%	0.043	00–20
EURUSD	1.126	0.0853%	0.42%	0.0062%	0.0020%	0.073	07–20
gold (XAUUSD)	4,176.80	0.2838%	1.36%	0.0108%	0.0150%	0.038	01–20
micro Nasdaq futures (MNQ)	31,070.00	0.2737%	1.31%	0.0027%	0.0000%	0.010	01–20

σ : standard deviation of hourly log returns on 2024–26 data (sigma_v32.json); daily = hourly $\times \sqrt{23}$ (indices, gold) or $\sqrt{24}$ (currencies). κ : spread + commission + slippage allowance as a fraction of the notional, per round trip (calibrate.py). ϕ : overnight financing per rollover, as a fraction of the notional. κ/σ is the cost of one hourly standard deviation of movement: the lower, the cheaper the market. Micro Nasdaq futures carry no financing (the cost is in the price) and are used only by the futures firms.

Over h hours the standard deviation grows like $\sigma\sqrt{h}$: the Nasdaq moves about 1.31% in a 23-hour trading day. Every stop and target in the plan is expressed in multiples of σ , so the same rules fit every market.

3.2 Zero drift

The model gives the price no trend at all. This is the zero-skill assumption: whatever direction rule the plan uses, it has no information about the next move. The Nasdaq has risen on average over decades, but that drift is about 0.0025% per hour, roughly a hundredth of the hourly volatility, and the plan is long and short equally often, so it neither helps nor hurts.

3.3 Synthetic paths

Results are computed on synthetic price histories built to be exactly fair:

- Twelve years of hourly bars per path. Each hour is split into 12 sub-steps of independent normal increments with variance $\sigma^2/12$, less a correction $-\sigma^2/24$ per step so that the price itself, not just its logarithm, has zero drift.
- Within each sub-step the highest and lowest point is drawn from the exact distribution of a Brownian bridge (2.7): with endpoints a, b and variance v , the maximum is

$$\max = \frac{1}{2} \left(a + b + \sqrt{(b-a)^2 - 2v \ln U} \right), \quad U \sim \text{Uniform}(0, 1),$$

which is the inverse of the reflection-principle distribution. The minimum is the mirror image.

- Markets that close at weekends are closed in the path from Friday to Sunday, but the price keeps moving underneath, so Monday can open with a gap.
- Each path is fixed by its random seed, so any path can be rebuilt exactly. The optimiser searches on paths 21–24, confirms on 25–28 and reports final figures on 29–32 (33–36 for the one setting re-chosen for robustness), so no reported number is measured on the paths that chose the settings (Chapter 9). Gold, USDJPY and EURUSD accounts use their own independent paths (seed + 50, + 60, + 70), because those markets do not move with the Nasdaq.

3.4 Real paths

Every final figure is also run on the real 2024–26 hourly history of its market. One two-year history carries its own trends and calm or wild months, so real-path figures scatter around the synthetic ones by a few hundred dollars a month. They are a check, not the estimate.

The bracket trade

Every trade in the plan is a *bracket*: one position with a stop-loss and a take-profit attached the moment it opens, never moved. This chapter derives everything about one such trade.

4.1 Set-up

Open a long position at price e with notional size N dollars (a short position is the mirror image). Place the stop a fraction s below the entry and the target a fraction u above:

$$\text{stop} = e(1 - s), \quad \text{target} = e(1 + u).$$

The plan fixes three things and derives the rest:

- the **risk** l : what a stopped-out trade loses before costs, 1.5% of the account;
- the **stop distance** $s = m\sigma$: m hourly standard deviations of the market;
- the **reward-to-risk ratio** k : a winning trade nets $w = kl$ after costs.

The notional follows from the risk and the stop, and the target from the requirement that a win nets exactly w after the round-trip cost c :

POSITION AND TARGET

$$N = \frac{l}{s}, \quad Nu - c = w \Rightarrow u = \frac{s(w + c)}{l}.$$

So a win pays $+w$ and a loss costs $-(l + c)$: the cost is paid on every trade, and the target is moved out by exactly the cost so that a win is worth what the plan intends. (Chapter 17 of version 4 found that a take-profit set without the cost turns the last "win" before a target into a small loss; this is that fix, in formula form.)

4.2 The win probability

The price is a martingale and the trade ends the first time it touches the stop or the target, a stopping time. By optional stopping (2.4), the expected exit price equals the entry price:

$$p \cdot e(1 + u) + (1 - p) \cdot e(1 - s) = e \Rightarrow pu = (1 - p)s \Rightarrow p = \frac{s}{s + u}.$$

Substituting u :

WIN PROBABILITY OF A ZERO-SKILL BRACKET

$$p = \frac{s}{s + s(w + c)/l} = \frac{l}{l + w + c} = \frac{1}{1 + k + c/l}.$$

With no cost, a 1 : 5 bracket wins one time in six. The cost makes the target slightly farther and the win slightly rarer.

4.3 The mean and the variance of one trade

The trade pays $+w$ with probability p and $-(l + c)$ otherwise. Its mean is

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{pnl}] = pw - (1 - p)(l + c) = \frac{lw - (w + c)(l + c)}{l + w + c} = \frac{-c(l + w + c)}{l + w + c} = -c.$$

For the variance, look at the result before cost, $Y = \text{pnl} + c$. It takes the values $w + c$ (probability p) and $-l$, and its mean is $p(w + c) - (1 - p)l = \frac{l(w + c) - (w + c)l}{l + w + c} = 0$. So

$$\text{Var}(\text{pnl}) = \text{Var}(Y) = \mathbb{E}[Y^2] = p(w + c)^2 + (1 - p)l^2 = \frac{l(w + c)^2 + (w + c)l^2}{l + w + c} = l(w + c).$$

THE TRADE'S MEAN IS MINUS ITS COST, EXACTLY; ITS VARIANCE IS k TIMES THE RISK SQUARED

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{pnl}] = -c, \quad v \equiv \text{Var}(\text{pnl}) = l(w + c) = l^2 \left(k + \frac{c}{l}\right).$$

The variance of one trade is k times the risk squared, plus a small cost term. Larger k means fewer, bigger moves of the balance; Chapter 8 shows this leaves the *time* to a target unchanged and lowers the total cost.

4.4 What a trade costs

The round-trip cost is a fraction κ of the notional (spread, commission and an allowance for slippage), plus overnight financing φ of the notional for each daily rollover the position is held through:

$$c = \kappa N + \varphi N \cdot (\text{rollovers}) = \frac{\kappa l}{m\sigma} + \dots, \quad \frac{c}{l} \approx \frac{\kappa}{m\sigma}.$$

Market	c/l at m = 0.35	0.5	0.75	1.0	financing per night / l at m = 0.35	at m = 1.0
Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100)	6.7%	4.7%	3.1%	2.3%	15.7%	5.5%
USDJPY	12.2%	8.5%	5.7%	4.3%	4.8%	1.7%
EURUSD	20.8%	14.5%	9.7%	7.3%	6.7%	2.3%
gold (XAUUSD)	10.9%	7.6%	5.1%	3.8%	15.1%	5.3%

The cost of one round trip, and of one night held, in units of the risk l , for stops of m hourly standard deviations: $c/l = \kappa/(m\sigma)$ and $\varphi/(m\sigma)$. A Nasdaq position with a stop of 0.35 hourly moves pays 6.7% of its risk to open and close, and 15.7% of its risk for every night it is held. Overnight financing is the larger cost for the plan's long-running winners, and the engine charges it on every rollover.

The cost in units of risk, $c/l = \kappa/(m\sigma)$, is the number that decides which markets are worth trading: it is the price of movement. The Nasdaq is cheap (a tight spread on a fast market); EURUSD is about three times dearer per unit of movement, which is why it gives up about a third of the value (Chapter 9).

4.5 The plan's trade on the Nasdaq, worked through

The plan's FTMO setting is $l = \$1,500$ (1.5% of \$100,000), a stop of $m = 0.5$ hourly standard deviations, and $k = 20$. Take the very first trade of phase 1, when the account is at its start and the target is $A = \$10,000$ away. Since $k l = \$30,000$ is more than the distance to the target, the win is cut to $w = \$10,000$ (5.5). With the Nasdaq at 31,070:

Stop distance: $s = m\sigma = 0.5 \times 0.2737\% = 0.1368\%$ of the price, i.e. 42.5 index points.

Notional: $N = l/s = 1,500/0.001368 = \$1,096,137$, i.e. \$35.28 per index point ($= l/\text{stop points}$). If one lot is worth \$1 per point (read the contract specification; some platforms use \$10 or \$20), that is 35.28 lots, rounded *down* to the lot step.

Cost: $c = \kappa N = 0.0064\% \times \$1,096,137 = \$70.15$, so $c/l = 4.68\%$.

Target: $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.1368\% \times 10,070.15/1,500 = 0.9187\%$, i.e. 285.4 points above the entry (for a long).

Win probability: $p = l/(l + w + c) = 1,500/(1,500 + 10,000 + 70.15) = 0.1296$.

Mean: $-c = -\$70.15$. Check: $p w - (1 - p)(l + c) = 0.12964 \times 10,000 - 0.87036 \times 1,570.15 = -70.15$.

Variance: $v = l(w + c) = 1,500 \times 10,070.15 = 15,105,229$, standard deviation \$3,887.

Overnight financing if held through a rollover: $\varphi N = 0.015\% \times \$1,096,137 = \$164$ per night.

Margin at 1:50: $N/50 = \$21,923 = 21.9\%$ of the balance (the plan's limit is 60%; the smallest stop FTMO's leverage allows is $m_{\min} = 0.183$, Chapter 10).

Duration (8.1): on average $m^2(w + c)/l = 0.5^2 \times 6.713 = 1.68$ hours of open market; a losing trade lasts 1.20 hours on average and a winning one 4.87 hours (8.1).

The same position with its target uncut, $w = k l = \$30,000$ (as on a funded cycle, whose target is \$30,000): $p = 0.0475$, target 852 points away (2.74% of the price), average duration 5.0 hours, winners 37 hours on average, so a winner is usually held through one or more nights and pays \$164 per night in financing. The engine charges every one of those nights.

4.6 Four ways a simulation can flatter a trade

Each of these was found and fixed in earlier versions; each makes a zero-skill bracket look profitable when it is not.

- Skipping the entry bar.** If stops and targets are checked only from the next hour, a move that would have stopped the trade inside the entry hour is ignored. Measured effect on a 1 : 3 bracket: +0.14 units of risk per trade, all of it fake.
- Checking prices too rarely.** A price sampled a few times an hour misses touches in between; the stop (closer) is missed more often than the target. Effect: +0.11 R. The Brownian-bridge extremes (3.3) remove it.
- Ties inside one bar.** When one hourly bar's range contains both the stop and the target, the bar alone does not say which came first. Version 5's engine (and the first run of this version) decided it with the overall fair chance $l/(l + w + c)$. That chance is right for the whole trade but not for a trade *given* that both levels fell inside one hour, and for narrow brackets (a stop of 0.35 hourly moves with $k = 2$ or 3) it gave the trade an edge of $+0.025 \pm 0.016$ R at $k = 2$ and $+0.034 \pm 0.020$ R at $k = 3$ per trade, enough to lift FundingPips' capped phase 2 from its exact zero-cost value of 66.7% to 67.8% $\pm 0.6\%$. The engine now replays the twelve five-minute sub-steps of that hour in order and takes whichever level the path reached first; only a tie inside one five-minute step falls back to the fair chance. After the fix: -0.014 ± 0.011 R at $k = 2$ and -0.005 ± 0.014 R at $k = 3$, and FundingPips' phase 2 at zero cost 66.8% $\pm 0.6\%$. Every figure in this document comes from the corrected engine. On the real history, which has only hourly bars, ties still use the fair chance.
- Gaps.** A price that opens beyond the stop (after a weekend, say) fills at the open, not at the stop. The engine fills it at the open; the loss can then exceed l , and if it breaks a daily or maximum loss limit the account fails, as it would in reality.

The engine's checks against theory are in Chapter 11: a 1 : 1 bracket wins 50.24% of the time (theory 50%), a 1 : 2 bracket 32.86% (33.3%), and the average result of a 1 : 3 bracket is $+0.017 \pm 0.018$ R (theory 0).

Reaching a target before a floor

A phase of an evaluation is passed when the balance gains A before it loses B . This is the oldest problem in probability, the *gambler's ruin*. This chapter solves it exactly with and without costs, and counts the trades it takes.

5.1 No costs: $P = B/(A + B)$

Let X_n be the balance relative to the start after n trades, a martingale with $X_0 = 0$, and τ the first time it reaches $+A$ or $-B$. The plan sizes trades so the balance lands exactly on the target or the floor (5.5), so X_τ is $+A$ with probability P and $-B$ otherwise. Optional stopping:

$$0 = \mathbb{E}[X_\tau] = P \cdot A - (1 - P) \cdot B \Rightarrow \boxed{P = \frac{B}{A + B}}.$$

The answer depends on nothing but the two distances: not on k , not on the stop, not on how many trades it takes. No way of trading changes it. This is why "skill-free" pass rates are so predictable: FTMO phase 1 is a coin flip ($10/20 = 50\%$), phase 2 is two in three ($10/15$).

5.2 With costs: the exponential martingale

With a cost c per trade the balance drifts down by c per trade and has variance v per trade (4.3). Treat it as a Brownian motion with drift $-c$ and variance v per trade. By 2.6, $e^{\theta X}$ is a martingale for

$$\theta = \frac{2c}{v}.$$

Optional stopping on it:

$$1 = \mathbb{E}[e^{\theta X_\tau}] = P e^{\theta A} + (1 - P) e^{-\theta B}.$$

PASS PROBABILITY WITH COSTS

$$P = \frac{1 - e^{-\theta B}}{e^{\theta A} - e^{-\theta B}} = \frac{e^{\theta B} - 1}{e^{\theta(A+B)} - 1}, \quad \theta = \frac{2c}{v} = \frac{2c/l}{k + c/l}.$$

As $c \rightarrow 0$, $\theta \rightarrow 0$ and $P \rightarrow B/(A + B)$. For small θ , expanding both exponentials to second order,

$$P \approx \frac{B}{A + B} \left(1 - \frac{\theta A}{2}\right), \quad \frac{\theta A}{2} = \frac{c A}{v} \approx \frac{(c/l)(A/l)}{k}.$$

The relative loss of pass probability is the cost per trade in units of risk, times the target in units of risk, divided by k . Three levers reduce it: a cheaper market (smaller c/l), a wider stop (also smaller c/l , but slower, Chapter 8), and a larger k .

5.3 How many trades: Wald's identity

Each trade adds $-c$ on average, so by Wald (2.5), $\mathbb{E}[X_\tau] = -c \mathbb{E}[\tau]$, and $\mathbb{E}[X_\tau] = PA - (1 - P)B$:

EXPECTED NUMBER OF TRADES IN A PHASE

$$\mathbb{E}[\tau] = \frac{(1 - P)B - PA}{c} \xrightarrow{c \rightarrow 0} \frac{AB}{v} = \frac{AB}{l^2 k}.$$

The zero-cost limit follows from the second martingale of 2.6, $X_n^2 - nv$: $\mathbb{E}[X_\tau^2] = v \mathbb{E}[\tau]$, and $\mathbb{E}[X_\tau^2] = PA^2 + (1 - P)B^2 = AB$ when $P = B/(A + B)$. In units of risk, FTMO phase 1 ($A = B = 6.67l$) takes $44.4/k$ trades: about 9 at $k = 5$, 7 at $k = 6$.

5.4 The plan's phases, worked through

Phase 1 ($A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$) at the plan's setting. Because $kl = \$30,000 \geq A + B$, every win ends the phase, and the chain of 5.6 is the sequence below. Each loss moves the balance down by $l + c = \$1,570.15$; the last trade risks only what is left above the floor less the \$100 buffer.

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$10,000	0.1296	1.0000	0.1296	0.1296
2	-\$1,570	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$11,570	0.1142	0.8704	0.0994	0.2290
3	-\$3,140	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$13,140	0.1020	0.7710	0.0786	0.3076
4	-\$4,710	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$14,710	0.0921	0.6924	0.0638	0.3714
5	-\$6,281	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$16,281	0.0840	0.6286	0.0528	0.4242
6	-\$7,851	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$17,851	0.0772	0.5758	0.0445	0.4687

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
7	-\$9,421	\$479	\$22.41	\$19,421	0.0240	0.5313	0.0128	0.4815

The product formula gives $P_1 = 0.4815$. The full chain (which also counts the last tiny trades a few dollars above the floor) gives $P_1 = 0.4829$, with an expected 5.77 trades and an expected total cost $K(0) = \$343$. The identity of 5.6 checks it: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 343)/20,000 = 0.4829$.

Phase 2 ($A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$, a fresh account):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$5,000	0.2283	1.0000	0.2283	0.2283
2	-\$1,570	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$6,570	0.1843	0.7717	0.1422	0.3705
3	-\$3,140	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$8,140	0.1545	0.6295	0.0972	0.4677
4	-\$4,710	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$9,710	0.1330	0.5323	0.0708	0.5385
5	-\$6,281	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$11,281	0.1167	0.4615	0.0539	0.5924
6	-\$7,851	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$12,851	0.1040	0.4076	0.0424	0.6348
7	-\$9,421	\$479	\$22.41	\$14,421	0.0321	0.3652	0.0117	0.6465

$P_2 = 0.6479$ (product 0.6465), 4.63 trades and \$282 of cost on average; identity $(10,000 - 282)/15,000 = 0.6478$. Together $P = P_1 P_2 = 0.4829 \times 0.6479 = 0.3129$.

The Brownian formula of 5.2 at the same setting uses $c = \$70.15$, $v = l(kl + c) = 45,105,229$ and $\theta = 2c/v = 3.111e - 06$, and gives $P = 0.3256$: too high, because it treats a 1 : 30 trade as if it could overshoot the target, and so undercounts how many trades (and costs) a phase takes. At the version 5 default ($k = 5$, $m = 0.75$), where trades are small next to the distances, the Brownian formula and the exact chain agree: 0.3129 against 0.3105.

The engine, with the daily loss limit, minimum days, weekends, gaps and overnight financing, gives $P = 0.3073 \pm 0.0058$ on the fresh paths: 0.6% below the chain, the cost of the nights a winning trade is held and of the trades cut at the Friday close.

5.5 Landing exactly on the target or the floor

The formulas assume the balance ends exactly at $+A$ or $-B$. Two sizing rules make that true in practice:

- **Take-profit capped at what is left.** When the remaining distance to the target is less than kl , the win w is set to the remaining distance (plus cost, 4.1). Profit beyond the target would be wasted: it raises no probability and was paid for with risk.
- **Risk capped near the floor.** The risk is the smallest of 1.5% of the account, the room above the floor less 0.1% of the account, and the room left in today's loss limit less 0.2%. A stop-out can then never break a limit; only a price gap through the stop can (4.6).

Both rules keep every trade a fair bracket, so the martingale arguments still apply exactly; they only change the number of trades.

5.6 The exact chain, and bold play

The formulas of 5.2 treat the balance as a Brownian motion, which is accurate when each trade is small next to the distances A and B . The plan's optimised settings are not like that: with $k = 30$ a single win is worth 45% of the account, so the take-profit is almost always cut to the distance that is left (5.5), and one win ends the phase. For such settings the balance is better described exactly, as a chain that jumps from trade to trade. At a balance x above the start ($-B < x < A$) the next trade has

ONE STEP OF THE EXACT CHAIN

$$l(x) = \min(L, x + B - \text{buffer}), \quad w(x) = \min(kl(x), A - x, \text{cap}), \quad c(x) = \rho l(x), \quad p(x) = \frac{l}{l + w + c},$$

$$x \rightarrow x + w \text{ with probability } p, \quad x \rightarrow x - l - c \text{ otherwise,}$$

where L is the normal risk, $\rho = \kappa/(m\sigma)$ the cost per dollar of risk, and the cap is any limit a rule puts on one win (a best-day share, a daily profit cap, FundingPips' profit concentration). The chance $V(x)$ of reaching A before $-B$, the expected number of trades $N(x)$ and the expected total cost $K(x)$ solve

$$V(x) = pV(x + w) + (1 - p)V(x - l - c), \quad N(x) = 1 + pN(x + w) + (1 - p)N(x - l - c), \quad K(x) = c + pK(x + w) + (1 - p)K(x - l - c)$$

with $V = 1$ at the target, $V = 0$ at the floor and $N = K = 0$ at both. These are solved by iteration on a grid of 6,000 points (analytic_v6.py). Two exact facts check the solution. First, optional stopping on the balance (whose mean falls by exactly the cost of each trade) gives

PASS PROBABILITY, EXACT, ANY K

$$P \cdot A - (1 - P) \cdot B = -K(0) \implies P = \frac{B - \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}]}{A + B}.$$

Every dollar of expected cost lowers the pass probability by exactly $1/(A+B)$. Second, when $kL \geq A+B$ every win ends the phase, and the chain becomes a simple sequence: the j -th trade starts at $x_j = -j(L+c)$ and wins the whole distance $A - x_j$ with chance $p_j = L/(L+A-x_j+c)$, so

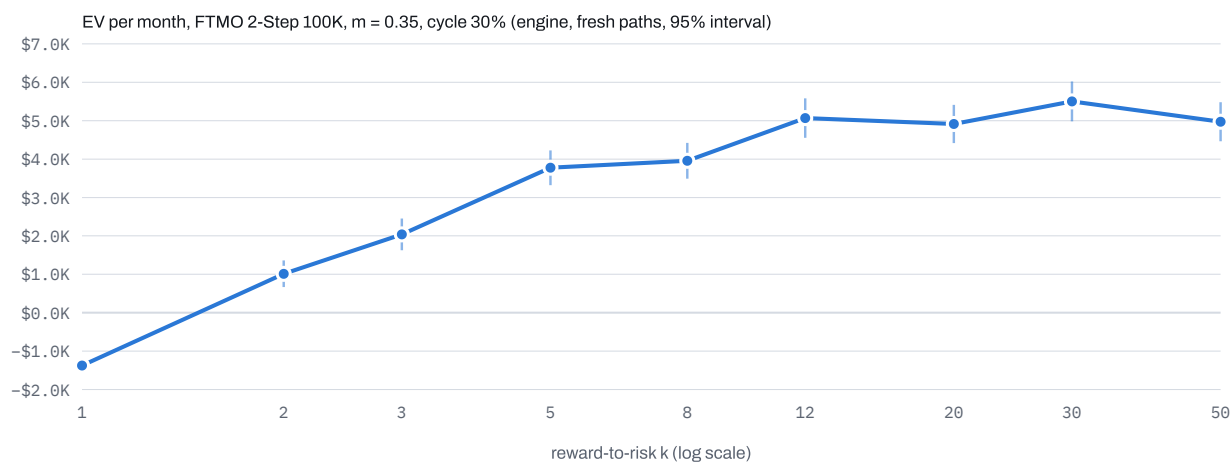
BOLD PLAY, WRITTEN OUT

$$P = 1 - \prod_{j=0}^{n-1} (1 - p_j) = p_0 + (1 - p_0)p_1 + (1 - p_0)(1 - p_1)p_2 + \dots$$

The last factor uses the smaller risk that fits above the floor. This is *bold play*, studied by Dubins and Savage (1965): in a game that is fair or slightly unfavourable, the strategy that maximises the chance of reaching a goal is to stake, each time, enough to reach the goal in one win (or everything, if that is less). The reason is the cost: each trade loses c on average, and the expected total cost $K(0)$ is what lowers P . Bold play reaches the goal or the floor in the fewest trades, so it pays the least cost. Chapter 9 finds that the optimiser, left free, moves every programme toward this corner.

For FTMO at a stop of 0.35 and a cycle of \$30,000, the table follows the chain and the engine as k grows. The pass probability rises because the expected cost falls (fewer trades), exactly as 5.6 says, and the value per month follows.

k	Phase 1 trades	Phase 1 cost K	P_1 exact	P exact	Funded cash, exact	Value of an attempt, exact	P , engine	EV per month, engine
1	42.3	\$3,999	0.3002	0.1553	\$1,228	-\$441	0.152	-\$1,377 ± \$172
2	22.7	\$2,136	0.3933	0.2319	\$3,297	+\$132	0.233	\$1,014 ± \$345
3	15.8	\$1,466	0.4268	0.2616	\$4,498	+\$545	0.252	\$2,040 ± \$413
5	10.4	\$927	0.4537	0.2867	\$5,719	+\$1,008	0.281	\$3,774 ± \$451
8	7.2	\$617	0.4692	0.2999	\$6,519	+\$1,323	0.287	\$3,958 ± \$465
12	5.8	\$485	0.4758	0.3046	\$6,999	+\$1,500	0.295	\$5,068 ± \$516
20	5.7	\$480	0.4761	0.3048	\$7,397	+\$1,623	0.287	\$4,914 ± \$496
30	5.7	\$479	0.4762	0.3049	\$7,550	+\$1,670	0.297	\$5,503 ± \$517
50	5.7	\$476	0.4763	0.3051	\$7,553	+\$1,672	0.294	\$4,972 ± \$506



Bold play in the engine: value per month against k , FTMO 2-Step, everything else fixed. Below $k = 3$ the cost of many small trades eats the option; the gain flattens beyond $k = 20$, where one win already reaches every target.

The evaluation in full

6.1 Two phases

A 2-step evaluation starts phase 2 on a fresh account once phase 1 is passed. The phases share nothing but the trader, so with zero skill they are independent and

$$\Pr(\text{pass}) = P_1 \cdot P_2.$$

The order of the targets does not matter for this product when costs are zero ($B/(A_1 + B) \cdot B/(A_2 + B)$ is symmetric), but it does for time and cost: the larger target first means fewer second phases are ever started, which saves the second phase's trades on the attempts that would fail anyway.

6.2 The daily loss limit

Most firms add a second floor that moves: the balance (or equity) may not fall more than d below its level at the start of the day. Breaking it fails the account at once. The plan never risks breaking it by its own stop: each trade's risk is at most today's remaining room less 0.2% of the account, and when less than a tenth of the normal risk remains, it stops for the day. With a 1.5% risk and a 4–5% limit, that takes two or three losses in one day, which happens on a minority of days (counted in each programme's chapter).

Because the plan reacts to the daily limit only by trading smaller or stopping, every trade is still a fair bracket and the pass probability is unchanged except through costs: smaller trades cost the same fraction of their size but there are more of them. The engine models the limit exactly, including the rare gap that breaks it.

6.3 Minimum trading days

Some firms require a minimum number of days with at least one trade in each phase (FTMO 4, FundedNext 5, BrightFunded 5, FXIFY Classic 4, Alpha 3). If the target is reached earlier, the plan places one minimal trade (the smallest lot) on each remaining required day. This is allowed at every firm that counts *trading* days, adds a negligible cost and only adds time. It is never done where the rule counts *profitable* days (6.4).

6.4 Profitable-day rules

Some firms require days with at least +0.5% profit (The5ers, Fintokei, Maven, Blue Guardian, FundingPips' 95% option), and forbid manufacturing them. The plan uses a *daily profit target*: while profitable days are missing, each day it trades normally until the day's profit reaches

$$g_{\text{today}} = \max\left(0.55\% S, \frac{\text{distance left to the target}}{\text{profitable days still needed}}\right)$$

and then stops for the day. Every trade is still a full-size fair bracket (its take-profit is capped at what is left of today's target), so nothing is manufactured. Stopping at a daily target is another stopping time, so in a fair game it leaves the probability of the final outcome unchanged; what changes is the time, because a phase now takes at least as many days as profitable days required. If the target is reached with profitable days still missing, trading continues under the daily target until they are complete, which exposes the balance a little longer and lowers the pass probability slightly (The5ers phase 1: 49.8% $\pm$ 0.7% with costs removed against 50%).

6.5 Weekends, nights and news

The plan holds no position over a weekend at any firm (no new trade after 19:00 UTC on Friday; everything closed by 20:30 UTC), places no new trade from 15 minutes before to 5 minutes after a high-impact US release, and on funded accounts is flat 10 minutes before such releases. Positions may run through the night on weekdays where the firm allows it (all CFD firms here); the futures layer is flat by 20:00 UTC every day. These rules cost a little time (forced closes end some trades early at a price between stop and target, which is still a fair outcome) and remove the largest gap risk.

6.6 Review time

Firms take one to three working days to check a passed phase and issue the next account. The engine adds one day after phase 1 and the firm's stated time after phase 2.

What a funded account pays

On the funded account the plan trades each *payout cycle* to a profit target X above the starting balance, stops, requests the payout on the first allowed day, and withdraws every dollar above the start. The balance is back at the start, the floor (static) is still D below it, and the next cycle begins. The account ends the first time the balance touches the floor. This chapter computes what that pays.

7.1 The withdrawal identity

Let Y_t be the balance above the start plus everything withdrawn so far (before the split). A withdrawal moves money from the first term to the second and leaves Y unchanged; a trade changes Y by its result. So Y behaves exactly like the trading result itself: a fair game before costs. The account ends when the balance is at $-D$, at which time $Y_\tau = -D + W$, where W is the total withdrawn. Optional stopping on Y , allowing for the cost c of each of the N_f funded trades (Wald):

$$\mathbb{E}[Y_\tau] = -c \mathbb{E}[N_f] \Rightarrow \mathbb{E}[W] = D - c \mathbb{E}[N_f].$$

THE WITHDRAWAL IDENTITY

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{cash from a funded account}] = \alpha (D - c \mathbb{E}[N_f]) + R \cdot \Pr(\text{refund reached}).$$

Before costs, a funded account pays out on average its whole allowance times the split, whatever the cycle target, the stop, k , the payout calendar or the trading rule. A \$100,000 account with a \$10,000 static allowance and an 80% split is worth \$8,000 plus the refund term, less the cost of the trades it takes to get there. The identity needs only that profits are eventually withdrawn and that the account can end only at its floor; it holds with best-day rules, payout caps and minimum days, which change time, never the average.

7.2 The same result, cycle by cycle

The identity can also be built from the parts, which gives the time and the number of payouts. Each cycle is a fresh gambler's ruin from the start: reach $+X$ before $-D$. Its success chance is q from 5.2 with $A = X$, $B = D$. Cycles succeed independently until the first failure, so the number of paid cycles K satisfies $\Pr(K \geq j) = q^j$:

$$\mathbb{E}[K] = \sum_{j \geq 1} q^j = \frac{q}{1-q}.$$

With no cost $q = D/(X + D)$, so $\mathbb{E}[K] = D/X$ and the expected total withdrawn is $X \cdot D/X = D$: the identity again. With a first cycle X_1 different from later ones X (first-payout rules) and success chances q_1, q :

FUNDED CASH, CYCLE FORM

$$\mathbb{E}[C] = \alpha \left(X_1 q_1 + X \frac{q_1 q}{1-q} \right) + R \cdot q_1 q^{r-1},$$

where the refund comes with the r -th payout ($r = 1$ at most firms; FundingPips Standard and Blue Guardian 4, Maven 3). Where a refund is paid in r equal parts with the first r payouts (Hola Prime), the last term is $\frac{R}{r} \sum_{j=1}^r q_1 q^{j-1}$.

7.3 What the cycle target changes

Before costs, nothing about the average. With costs, the expected number of funded trades is, by the zero-cost formula of 5.3 summed over the expected $1/(1-q) = (X + D)/X$ cycles,

$$\mathbb{E}[N_f] \approx \frac{XD}{v} \cdot \frac{X+D}{X} = \frac{D(X+D)}{v} = \frac{D(X+D)}{l^2 k}.$$

A larger cycle target means more trades over the account's life, more cost, and more time between payouts; a smaller one means more payout requests, each followed by waiting for the payout date. The best X balances the two, and depends on the firm's payout calendar (Chapter 9 finds it by search). It also changes how many payout requests a firm sees, which matters if payouts can be refused (Chapter 29).

7.4 Rules that change only time

- **Best-day (consistency) rules.** If no day may exceed a share β of a payout's profit, the plan caps each day's take-profit at βX less what the day has already made, so a cycle needs at least $1/\beta$ profitable days. FXIFY Classic ($\beta = 25\%$) needs four, Hola Prime (40%) three.
- **Profitable days per cycle** (FundingPips 95%, Hola Prime): the daily profit target of 6.4, applied per cycle.
- **Payout calendars.** The first payout is allowed 14 to 30 days after the account opens, then every 10 to 30 days. A cycle that reaches its target early waits, flat, for the date.
- **Payout caps** (GFT: the first two payouts at most 6% of the account): the cycle target is set to the cap.
- **Daily profit caps** (GFT funded \$3,000 a day): the take-profit is capped at what is left of the day's cap.

7.5 The plan's funded account, worked through

FTMO's funded account at the plan's setting: allowance $D = \$10,000$ (static), cycle target $X_1 = X = \$30,000$, split $\alpha = 80\%$, refund $R = \$632$ with the first payout. One cycle is the bold chain from 0 to $+X$ before $-D$:

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$30,000	0.0475	1.0000	0.0475	0.0475
2	-\$1,570	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$31,570	0.0453	0.9525	0.0431	0.0906
3	-\$3,140	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$33,140	0.0432	0.9094	0.0393	0.1299
4	-\$4,710	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$34,710	0.0413	0.8701	0.0360	0.1659
5	-\$6,281	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$36,281	0.0396	0.8341	0.0331	0.1990
6	-\$7,851	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$37,851	0.0381	0.8010	0.0305	0.2294
7	-\$9,421	\$479	\$22.41	\$39,421	0.0120	0.7706	0.0092	0.2387

The full chain gives the cycle's success chance $q = 0.2371$ (product 0.2387). Cycles repeat until one fails, so

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid cycles}] = q/(1 - q) = 0.2371/0.7629 = 0.3108$$

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{withdrawn before the split}] = X q/(1 - q) = 30,000 \times 0.3108 = \$9,325$$

Withdrawal identity (7.1): $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost of all funded trades}] = 10,000 - 678 = \$9,322$ (the same, to the grid's precision)

$$\mathbb{E}[C] = \alpha \times 9,325 + R q = 0.8 \times 9,325 + 632 \times 0.2371 = \$7,610$$

The engine, on fresh paths, pays \$7,124 per funded account: 6.4% less than the chain, almost all of it overnight financing on the long-running winners (a cycle's winning trade must travel 2.7% of the price and is usually held through nights at \$164 each). The cash comes in large, rare pieces:

Paid cycles	Probability $q^j(1 - q)$	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7629	\$0
1	0.1809	\$24,632
2	0.0429	\$48,632
3	0.0102	\$72,632
4	0.0024	\$96,632

76% of funded accounts never pay; 24% pay at least \$24,632. That is the price of bold play: the same average as many small payouts, in fewer, larger ones. Chapter 29 returns to what that means if payouts can be refused.

Time, and value per month

8.1 How long one trade lasts

For a driftless price with variance σ^2 per hour, the second martingale of 2.6 is $Z_t^2 - \sigma^2 t$, where Z is the log-price move since entry. Stopping when Z first touches $+d_t$ (target) or $-d_s$ (stop), with $\Pr(\text{target}) = d_s/(d_s + d_t)$:

$$\sigma^2 \mathbb{E}[\tau] = \mathbb{E}[Z_\tau^2] = \frac{d_s}{d_s + d_t} d_t^2 + \frac{d_t}{d_s + d_t} d_s^2 = d_s d_t.$$

EXPECTED DURATION OF A BRACKET (HOURS OF OPEN MARKET)

$$\mathbb{E}[\tau] = \frac{d_s d_t}{\sigma^2} = \frac{(m\sigma) \cdot m\sigma(k + c/l)}{\sigma^2} = m^2 (k + c/l).$$

A 1 : 6 bracket with its stop at half an hourly move lasts on average $0.25 \times 6.03 \approx 1.5$ hours of open market; at 0.75 hourly moves, 3.4 hours. Most trades are short (the stop is close) and a few are long (the wins).

8.2 How long a phase lasts

Multiply the number of trades (5.3) by the duration of each (8.1). In the zero-cost limit:

$$\mathbb{E}[T_{\text{phase}}] \approx \frac{AB}{l^2 k} \cdot m^2 k = \left(\frac{A}{l}\right) \left(\frac{B}{l}\right) m^2 \text{ hours.}$$

The k cancels: bigger wins come more rarely and take longer, exactly offsetting. What sets the speed is m/l , i.e. the size of the position: the account's balance moves like a Brownian motion whose variance per hour is $(N\sigma)^2$, and the time to cover distances A and B is $AB/(N\sigma)^2$. For FTMO phase 1 at $m = 0.5$ this is $6.67^2 \times 0.25 \approx 11$ hours of open market. In practice the minimum trading days, the trading window, weekends, news and reviews dominate: phase 1 takes about four calendar days at FTMO because the rules require four trading days, not because the market is slow.

This is why the plan's risk per trade matters so much: time scales like $1/l^2$. Doubling the risk would quarter the market time. The plan keeps 1.5% because that is what the firms' rules and stated guidance allow (Chapter 10), and gets its speed from a short stop instead, which raises the notional at the same risk.

8.3 Value per month: the renewal–reward theorem

The plan runs *slots*: one account position at a firm, refilled with a new evaluation the moment an attempt ends (a failed phase or a lost funded account). Over a long run a slot completes many attempts, each with value V_i and duration T_i , independent and identically distributed. The average value per unit time after n attempts is $\sum V_i / \sum T_i$, and by the law of large numbers

RENEWAL–REWARD THEOREM

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n V_i}{\sum_{i=1}^n T_i} = \frac{\mathbb{E}[V]}{\mathbb{E}[T]}, \quad \text{EV per month} = 30.44 \times \frac{\mathbb{E}[V]}{\mathbb{E}[T \text{ in days}]}$$

The ratio of expectations, not the expectation of ratios: an attempt that lasts five months and one that lasts five days are weighted by their length. This is the objective the plan maximises for every programme.

8.4 How precise a simulated figure is

With n simulated attempts, the estimate $\hat{r} = \bar{V}/\bar{T}$ has, by the delta method, standard error

$$\text{se}(\hat{r}) \approx \frac{\text{sd}(V_i - \hat{r} T_i)}{\sqrt{n} \bar{T}}.$$

Every "±" in this document is 1.96 of these standard errors (a 95% interval), converted to dollars per month. With 24,000 attempts it is typically ±\$100–\$200 a month per account.

8.5 The plan's attempt, timed

FTMO at the plan's setting. Phase 1 takes on average 5.77 trades (5.6); the first lasts 1.68 hours of open market on average (4.5), later ones a little longer (the target is farther). So the market time of a phase is a few hours, and the calendar is set by the rules: four trading days per phase, a review of one day after phase 1 and up to three after phase 2, the 14-day wait for the first payout, and the trading window (no new trades after 20:00 UTC, none at weekends).

Engine, fresh paths: an attempt lasts $\mathbb{E}[T] = 8.68$ days on average, from the purchase to the failed phase or the lost funded account.
 So one slot buys $30.44/8.68 = 3.51$ evaluations a month and pays $3.51 \times \$632 = \$2,217$ a month in fees before refunds.
 Value of an attempt (engine): $\mathbb{E}[V] = \$1,557$; pass rate 30.7%; cash per funded account \$7,124.
 Renewal-reward (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,557/8.68 = \$5,463$ per month, $\pm \$342$ (95%).
 The median time from buying an attempt that pays to its first payout is 26 days; 7.0% of attempts reach a payout.

Decomposed (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 51% of attempts fail in phase 1, and an attempt that fails anywhere in the evaluation lasts 4.1 days on average, mostly the minimum days and the wait to the next trading day. An attempt that passes spends 10.9 days in the evaluation (four trading days per phase and the reviews) and 8.1 days funded, making 0.30 payouts on average. The weighted average, $(1 - P) \times 4.1 + P \times (10.9 + 8.1)$, is the 8.9 days of an attempt on this path.

Optimising every setting

Four numbers define how the plan trades a programme: the risk per trade l , the reward-to-risk ratio k , the stop m (in hourly standard deviations) and the funded cycle target X . A fifth choice is the market. This chapter explains what each one does, which are fixed by the rules, and how the rest were searched.

9.1 What each setting does

Setting	Value of an attempt	Time of an attempt	Set by
Risk l	almost none (5.1); a little through costs	market time $\propto 1/l^2$ (8.2)	the firms' rules and guidance: 1.5% (Chapter 10)
Reward:risk k	cost drag on pass probability $\propto 1/k$ (5.2); fewer funded trades	none in theory (8.2); in practice longer trades meet weekends and payout dates	search
Stop m	cost per trade $c/l \propto 1/m$	market time $\propto m^2$	search, within the leverage limit
Cycle target X	none before costs (7.1); more funded trades with larger X	payout waiting against cycle length (7.3)	search, within payout rules
Market	cost per unit of movement κ/σ	trading hours	leverage, independence rules, cost

The trade-offs are clear in direction but not in size, because the rules (minimum days, payout dates, daily limits, weekends) dominate the clock. So the values were found by simulation with the full rule engine, and the theory is used to check them (Chapter 11).

9.2 The search

- Grid.** For every programme and every market it may trade: $k \in \{2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10, 12\}$, $m \in \{0.5, 0.75, 1, 1.25, 1.5\}$ (only stops the firm's leverage allows, Chapter 10), and three to five cycle targets suited to the programme's payout rules. That is 4,950 settings, each run for 4,000 attempts on four synthetic paths (21–24): 19.8 million simulated attempts.
- Refine.** For each programme, the eight best grid settings, the version 5 default, and extensions wherever the best sat on the edge of the grid were run again for 24,000 attempts on four *different* paths (25–28).
- Edges.** Wherever the refined best still sat on an edge, one more step was taken in that direction (k up to 20, stops down to the leverage limit, cycles up to 25%), again for 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28.
- Bold play.** Because the best settings kept moving toward large k , large cycles and tight stops, a last round tried $k \in \{20, 30, 50\}$, cycles of 25%, 30%, 40% and 50%, and stops of 0.25, 0.3 and 0.35 where leverage allows. In all, 1,335 settings were refined, 32.0 million attempts.
- Choose, within practical limits.** The plan's setting is the highest refined value per month among settings with a stop of at least 0.35 hourly moves, a cycle of at most 30% of the account and k of at most 30 (9.3 explains each limit). Where a wider stop is as good at the assumed cost and much better if costs are higher, the wider stop is used (FundedNext, 9.3).
- Report.** The chosen setting is run a third time on four fresh paths (29–32; 33–36 for the one re-chosen for robustness) and on the real price history. Every figure reported for a programme comes from this last run, so none is inflated by having been picked as the best of many noisy estimates (the "winner's curse"). The curse is visible: the chosen settings average 10% less on fresh paths than on the paths that chose them.

9.3 What the search found, in general

Every programme moved the same way. Compared with version 5's default ($k = 5$, $m = 0.75$, cycles of 10%), the chosen settings have a larger k (7 to 30), the tightest stop the leverage and the limits below allow, and cycles of 20–30% of the account. Over the thirteen programmes in the plan, one 100K account each, the value rises from \$47,905 to \$59,847 a month (+\$11,942, 25%), measured on paths that played no part in the choice.

Why. Three effects, each derived in Part I, point the same way:

- Cost per trade falls with a wider target* (bold play, 5.6): the pass probability is $(B - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}])/(A + B)$ exactly, and the fewest trades means the least cost. A 1 : 30 bracket reaches the target in one win; a 1 : 5 bracket needs two or three wins and more losses in between.
- Time falls with a tighter stop* (8.2): the market time of a phase is $(A/l)(B/l)m^2$ hours, so halving m quarters it. The cost per trade rises like $1/m$, which the large k offsets.
- Fewer, larger payouts* (7.3): a funded account pays its allowance αD on average whatever the cycle; larger cycles mean fewer trades (less cost) and fewer payout dates to wait for.

Where it stops: the plan's limits. Left free, the search keeps going toward $k = 50$, cycles of 40–50% and stops of 0.25. The plan stops at a stop of 0.35, a cycle of 30% and $k = 30$, for reasons the model cannot price:

- Stop of at least 0.35 hourly moves* (30 Nasdaq points, 6.6 USDJPY pips, \$4.1 on gold). The cost κ is an average of measured spreads and commissions. Real spreads widen several-fold at the daily break, at the open and around news, and a stop a few spreads from the price is hit by the widening alone. The engine does not model this, and its effect grows as the stop tightens. For FTMO the uncapped setting (50 /

0.25 / 40%) is worth \$6,560 a month on the fresh paths and \$6,004 on the real history, against \$5,463 and \$5,971 for the plan's. The difference is real in the model and is given up deliberately.

- *Cycle of at most 30% of the account.* A \$40,000–\$50,000 payout on a \$100,000 account after one trade invites a review of the kind every firm reserves the right to make. Beyond 30% the measured gains are within the noise for most programmes.
- *k of at most 30.* With cycles of at most 30% and a 1.5% risk, a win of *k l* already reaches every target at $k \approx 27$. Larger *k* changes nothing but the order size on paper.

Robustness to costs. The cost check (Chapter 31) asks what each setting is worth if real costs are 1.5 or 2 times the assumption. Two accounts trade the dearer currency markets and were checked at neighbouring stops. FundingPips on USDJPY: at $m = 0.35$ \$4,991, \$3,155 and \$1,163 a month at 1, 1.5 and 2 times the cost; at the search's own choice $m = 0.5$ \$5,341, \$4,692 and \$3,510; at 0.75 \$5,050, \$4,130, \$3,744. The search's choice is already the robust one. FundedNext on EURUSD: at the search's choice $m = 0.75$ \$4,258, \$3,220, −\$146; at $m = 1.0$ \$3,630, \$3,153, \$2,273. A small loss at the assumed cost buys protection against losing the whole account's value, so the plan uses $m = 1.0$ for FundedNext and reports its figures from new paths 33–36.

Large gains, large noise. Near the optimum the value per month is flat: many settings sit within each other's 95% intervals. The k-curve of 5.6 shows the shape: k = 3: \$2,040, k = 8: \$3,958, k = 20: \$4,914, k = 30: \$5,503. The ranking near the top is not reliable, but the direction is: the chosen setting beats the version 5 default by more than their combined 95% interval in 10 of the 13 programmes; in the others (GFT Standard, Blue Guardian 2-Step, Maven 2-Step) the two are equal within the noise, and the plan keeps the searched setting.

9.4 Every programme before and after

Programme, market	v5 setting k / m / X	v5 EV/month	Chosen k / m / X	Chosen EV/month (95%)	Real history	Best outside the limits
FTMO 2-Step, Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$4,246	20 / 0.5 / 30%	\$5,463 ± \$342	\$5,971	50 / 0.25 / 40%: \$6,560
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (85%) (cap), USDJPY	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$4,219	20 / 0.5 / 25%	\$5,716 ± \$316	\$5,423	50 / 0.5 / 40%: \$5,705
The5ers High Stakes Classic, Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$4,030	20 / 0.5 / 25%	\$4,775 ± \$250	\$4,174	within limits
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), Nasdaq	5 / 1 / 10%	\$2,796	12 / 1 / 30%	\$4,046 ± \$195	\$3,167	20 / 1 / 40%: \$3,763
FundedNext Stellar, EURUSD	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$2,936	20 / 1 / 25%	\$3,804 ± \$181	\$3,630	within limits
Fintokei ProTrader, Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$3,757	12 / 0.5 / 25%	\$4,072 ± \$239	\$4,196	within limits
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, gold	5 / 1 / 10%	\$3,735	10 / 1 / 20%	\$4,578 ± \$210	\$4,223	within limits
Alpha Capital Pro 10%, Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$4,653	30 / 0.5 / 30%	\$6,372 ± \$363	\$7,445	30 / 0.5 / 40%: \$6,033
FunderPro Classic, Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$5,072	30 / 0.35 / 30%	\$7,734 ± \$448	\$6,555	30 / 0.35 / 40%: \$8,184
GFT Standard, Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$3,982	8 / 0.75 / 8%	\$3,953 ± \$103	\$3,608	within limits
BrightFunded Classic, Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$3,382	12 / 0.5 / 25%	\$4,183 ± \$234	\$4,879	within limits
Blue Guardian 2-Step, Nasdaq	5 / 1 / 8%	\$2,761	8 / 1 / 18%	\$2,810 ± \$169	\$2,397	within limits
Maven 2-Step, Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 8%	\$2,335	7 / 1 / 8%	\$2,341 ± \$105	\$2,015	7 / 1 / 18%: \$2,738
FTMO 1-Step, Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$3,366	12 / 0.75 / 12%	\$3,386 ± \$153	\$3,049	within limits
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (85%) (4 days), USDJPY	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$4,161	14 / 0.5 / 30%	\$5,376 ± \$299	\$5,911	30 / 0.5 / 50%: \$4,882
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), USDJPY	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$3,620	14 / 0.6 / 30%	\$4,055 ± \$231	\$4,267	20 / 0.6 / 50%: \$4,148
The5ers High Stakes, Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$3,759	20 / 0.6 / 20%	\$4,482 ± \$218	\$4,674	20 / 0.6 / 40%: \$4,482
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	5 / 1 / 10%	\$2,534	30 / 1 / 30%	\$3,280 ± \$165	\$3,122	50 / 1 / 30%: \$3,293
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$2,526	11 / 0.75 / 30%	\$3,570 ± \$219	\$3,793	20 / 0.75 / 40%: \$3,545
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$2,222	12 / 0.85 / 30%	\$3,253 ± \$186	\$3,105	30 / 0.85 / 50%: \$2,921
FundedNext Stellar, gold	5 / 1 / 10%	\$3,526	10 / 1 / 30%	\$4,187 ± \$209	\$3,991	within limits
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$3,094	14 / 0.75 / 20%	\$3,922 ± \$232	\$5,426	within limits
Alpha Capital Pro 10% (on-demand), Nasdaq	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$4,966	12 / 0.5 / 20%	\$5,910 ± \$310	\$6,700	within limits

All values per month for one 100K account (Fintokei, FXIFY, FundedNext etc. at 100K here; Part II gives the sizes the plan uses), from the final run on fresh paths 29–32 (33–36 for FundedNext, re-chosen for robustness), 24,000 attempts each, and 8,000 attempts on the real 2024–26 history. Shaded rows are the programmes in the plan. X is the funded cycle target as a share of the account. "=" means the version 5 default is the chosen setting.

Position size, leverage and margin

A setting is only usable if the firm lets you open the position it implies. This chapter turns the settings into lots and checks them against each firm's leverage.

10.1 From risk to lots

The stop distance in price points is $s \times \text{price} = m\sigma \times \text{price}$. If one lot gains or loses V dollars per point (read it from the firm's contract specification), then

LOTS FOR A GIVEN RISK

$$\text{lots} = \frac{l}{\text{stop points} \times V} = \frac{l}{m\sigma \text{ price } V}, \quad \text{notional} = \text{lots} \times \text{price} \times V = \frac{l}{m\sigma}.$$

Round lots *down* to the firm's lot step, so the realised risk is never above 1.5%. The take-profit in points is the stop in points times $(w + c)/l$, where c is the measured cost of the round trip in dollars for that lot size.

10.2 Leverage and the smallest usable stop

The firm holds margin of notional $\div$ leverage. A position needs

$$\text{margin} = \frac{\text{notional}}{\lambda} = \frac{l}{m\sigma\lambda}$$

for leverage λ (1: λ). The plan allows at most 60% of the balance as margin, which leaves the margin level above 160% even after a full stop-out and keeps the account clear of the "excessive margin use" that some firms review. With $l = 1.5\%$ of the account, this gives the smallest stop the firm allows:

SMALLEST STOP THAT FITS THE LEVERAGE

$$m \geq m_{\min} = \frac{l/S}{0.6\lambda\sigma} = \frac{0.025}{\lambda\sigma}.$$

Programme	Market	Leverage	$m_{\min}$	Plan's m	Notional per 100K	Margin / balance
FTMO 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:50	0.183	0.5	\$1,096,137	22%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (85%) (cap)	USDJPY	1:100	0.210	0.5	\$2,514,484	25%
The5ers High Stakes Classic	Nasdaq	1:25	0.365	0.5	\$1,096,137	44%
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	Nasdaq	1:10	0.913	1	\$548,068	55%
FundedNext Stellar	EURUSD	1:100	0.293	1	\$1,759,509	18%
Fintokei ProTrader	Nasdaq	1:50	0.183	0.5	\$1,096,137	22%
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	gold	1:10	0.881	1	\$528,477	53%
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	Nasdaq	1:20	0.457	0.5	\$1,096,137	55%
FunderPro Classic	Nasdaq	1:30	0.304	0.35	\$1,565,910	52%
GFT Standard	Nasdaq	1:15	0.609	0.75	\$730,758	49%
BrightFunded Classic	Nasdaq	1:20	0.457	0.5	\$1,096,137	55%
Blue Guardian 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:10	0.913	1	\$548,068	55%
Maven 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:20	0.457	1	\$548,068	27%
FTMO 1-Step	Nasdaq	1:50	0.183	0.75	\$730,758	15%

Leverage as published by each firm on 4 October 2026 (optimize_v6.LEV). $m_{\min} = (l/S)/(0.6\lambda\sigma)$ is the smallest stop whose margin fits in 60% of the balance at 1.5% risk. FundingPips gives 1:5 on indices and metals above half a lot (dynamic leverage), so its accounts trade USDJPY. The plan's stop is the larger of $m_{\min}$, 0.35 and the searched optimum.

The table changes the plan in three places. **FundingPips** applies "dynamic leverage" to indices and metals that falls to 1:5 above half a lot, which any position of this size exceeds: on the Nasdaq the smallest stop would be 1.8 hourly moves, so FundingPips trades USDJPY at 1:100 instead. **FXIFY**, **FundedNext**, **Hola Prime** and **Blue Guardian** give 1:10 on indices (and FundedNext 1:10 on gold since January 2026): their stops are wider, or they trade a currency pair. Leverage is the most frequently changed rule of all; read it on the firm's contract page before the first trade.

10.3 Which market each account trades

Three groups of markets are used, each with one shared direction (Chapter 28):

- **Nasdaq 100** (US100 CFD, or micro Nasdaq futures): every firm that allows the position on indices and allows the same trades as your own accounts elsewhere.
- **USDJPY**: FundingPips (leverage), and FXIFY if its Nasdaq stop would be too wide.
- **Independent markets** for firms that forbid copying trades from other firms' accounts or into funded accounts: Hola Prime and FundedNext each trade a market that no other account trades (gold, EURUSD), with their own direction rule, so their trades are never copies of anything.

10.4 The ten-minute rule

FundingPips groups every position on the same market in the same direction, *including a position opened within 10 minutes of closing a losing one*, into one "trade idea", and closes the account if a trade idea loses 2% (realised and unrealised together). Two stopped-out 1.5% trades in a row in the same direction within 10 minutes would therefore break it. The plan waits at least 10 minutes after any losing trade before opening the next one in the same direction, at every firm. In the simulation the next entry is always at a later hour's open, which already satisfies this.

10.5 Risk per trade: why 1.5%, and what more would give

Time falls like $1/t^2$ (8.2), so more risk per trade is the strongest lever there is. The plan does not use it, because the rules say no or come close:

- FTMO states a recommended risk of 1–1.5% per trade and monitors "gambling" behaviour;
- FundingPips Flex closes the account at a 2% loss on one trade idea; Alpha Capital forbids risking or losing 2% or more on one trade; FunderPro and Hola Prime (funded) cap risk at 2%; Blue Guardian closes trades at a 2% open loss;
- a 2% stop on a 2% limit leaves no room for slippage, so the usable maximum at those firms is about 1.5–1.75% anyway.

Risk per trade	EV per month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.00%	\$4,440 ± \$409	\$1,422	30.1%	9.7
1.25%	\$5,006 ± \$453	\$1,469	30.4%	8.9
1.50%	\$5,411 ± \$479	\$1,528	30.3%	8.6
1.75%	\$5,804 ± \$515	\$1,592	29.7%	8.4
2.00%	\$5,478 ± \$496	\$1,496	30.2%	8.3

FTMO 2-Step 100K at the plan's $k = 20$, $m = 0.5$, cycle 30K, fresh paths 29–32, 12,000 attempts per row.

Within the noise of 12,000 attempts the value per month barely moves with the risk between 1% and 2%. The theory says why: risk changes the *market* time of a phase (8.2), but at these stops the market time is a few hours, and the calendar (minimum days, reviews, payout dates) is what an attempt is waiting for. There is nothing here worth breaking a firm's guidance for. The plan keeps 1.5%.

Checking the engine against the formulas

The simulation and the formulas of Chapters 4–7 were written separately. The formulas leave out daily limits, minimum and profitable days, best-day caps, gaps, overnight financing and the calendar; the engine includes all of them. Where the two agree, both are right; where they differ, the difference should be explained by what the formulas leave out.

11.1 Basic checks

Check (synthetic path, no costs unless stated)	Theory	Engine
Win rate of a 1 : 1 bracket	50.0%	50.24%
Win rate of a 1 : 2 bracket	33.3%	32.86%
Average result of a 1 : 3 bracket, in units of risk	0	+0.017 ± 0.018
Win rate of 1 : 1, 1 : 2, 1 : 3, 1 : 6 brackets with a tight stop ($m = 0.35$)	50.00% / 33.33% / 25.00% / 14.29%	50.40% / 32.87% / 24.88% / 14.24%
FundingPips Flex phase 2 (wins capped at 55% of the target), zero cost	66.7%	66.8% ± 0.6%
FTMO phase 1 pass rate, zero cost, $k = 5$	50.0%	49.76% ± 0.35%
FTMO funded account, zero cost: average withdrawn before split	\$10,000	\$9,877 ± \$169
FTMO phase 1 pass rate, zero cost, a bold setting ($k = 30$, $m = 0.35$)	50.0%	49.84% ± 0.69%
The5ers phase 1 pass rate, zero cost, with its profitable-days rule / without it	50.0%	49.8% / 50.5% (± 0.7%)
FTMO 2-Step pass rate with the plan's direction rule / with a coin flip (with costs)	equal 30.9% / 30.5%; \$5,000 / \$5,509 a month	
Independent coin-flip program (verify.py), FTMO pass rate	33.3%	33.3%

11.2 Every chosen programme: formulas against the engine

Programme	k / m	P Brownian (5.2)	P exact chain (5.6)	P engine	Funded cash, chain	Funded cash, engine	Attempt value, chain	Attempt value, engine
FTMO 2-Step, Nasdaq	20 / 0.5	0.326	0.313	0.307	\$7,610	\$7,124	+\$1,749	+\$1,557
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (85%) (cap), USDJPY	20 / 0.5	0.261	0.259	0.252	\$9,092	\$8,766	+\$1,860	+\$1,708
The5ers High Stakes Classic, Nasdaq	20 / 0.5	0.363	0.348	0.323	\$7,678	\$7,385	+\$2,129	+\$1,840
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), Nasdaq	12 / 1	0.327	0.323	0.319	\$8,943	\$8,766	+\$2,337	+\$2,251
FundedNext Stellar, EURUSD	20 / 1	0.359	0.337	0.344	\$7,442	\$7,129	+\$1,958	+\$1,904
Fintokei ProTrader, Nasdaq	12 / 0.5	0.335	0.326	0.303	\$7,403	\$6,866	+\$1,863	+\$1,529
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, gold	10 / 1	0.358	0.352	0.350	\$6,987	\$6,954	+\$1,859	+\$1,836
Alpha Capital Pro 10%, Nasdaq	30 / 0.5	0.328	0.313	0.307	\$7,567	\$7,035	+\$1,872	+\$1,660
FunderPro Classic, Nasdaq	30 / 0.35	0.326	0.305	0.301	\$7,529	\$7,048	+\$1,756	+\$1,579
GFT Standard, Nasdaq	8 / 0.75	0.358	0.354	0.350	\$7,022	\$7,126	+\$1,961	+\$1,972
BrightFunded Classic, Nasdaq	12 / 0.5	0.320	0.313	0.315	\$7,257	\$6,519	+\$1,689	+\$1,475
Blue Guardian 2-Step, Nasdaq	8 / 1	0.326	0.322	0.299	\$6,445	\$6,016	+\$1,497	+\$1,220
Maven 2-Step, Nasdaq	7 / 1	0.299	0.296	0.275	\$5,863	\$5,749	+\$1,297	+\$1,139
FTMO 1-Step, Nasdaq	12 / 0.75	0.469	0.468	0.344	\$8,257	\$6,165	+\$3,284	+\$1,537
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (85%) (4 days), USDJPY	14 / 0.5	0.340	0.325	0.308	\$8,534	\$7,193	+\$2,278	+\$1,720

Programme	k / m	P Brownian (5.2)	P exact chain (5.6)	P engine	Funded cash, chain	Funded cash, engine	Attempt value, chain	Attempt value, engine
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), USDJPY	14 / 0.6	0.344	0.331	0.291	\$9,812	\$8,491	+\$2,752	+\$1,971
The5ers High Stakes, Nasdaq	20 / 0.6	0.327	0.316	0.296	\$7,770	\$7,599	+\$1,966	+\$1,760
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	30 / 1	0.331	0.323	0.314	\$7,181	\$7,007	+\$1,771	+\$1,651
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	11 / 0.75	0.316	0.308	0.297	\$7,487	\$7,186	+\$1,758	+\$1,582
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	12 / 0.85	0.320	0.311	0.306	\$6,227	\$6,405	+\$1,389	+\$1,408
FundedNext Stellar, gold	10 / 1	0.358	0.352	0.345	\$7,327	\$7,237	+\$2,028	+\$1,946
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	14 / 0.75	0.349	0.327	0.318	\$5,653	\$5,820	+\$1,251	+\$1,250
Alpha Capital Pro 10% (on-demand), Nasdaq	12 / 0.5	0.320	0.313	0.309	\$6,703	\$6,657	+\$1,599	+\$1,559

Chain and Brownian columns: analytic_v6.py, written separately from the engine; they leave out daily limits, minimum and profitable days, payout dates, weekends, gaps and overnight financing. Engine: the final run on fresh paths (24,000 attempts; pass rates ± 0.006).

Pass probabilities. For the thirteen programmes in the plan, the exact chain is above the engine by 0.9% on average (range -0.7% to 2.5%). The gap is what the chain leaves out, and each part has a known sign: overnight financing on winners held through the night (always a cost), trades cut at the Friday close or the daily window (fair, but each extra trade costs c), the profitable-day and best-day rules that keep the balance exposed longer, and the rare gap through a daily loss limit. The Brownian formula is too high for bold settings (it undercounts trades) and accurate for small k . The one large gap is FTMO 1-Step (0.468 against 0.344): its maximum loss trails the best end-of-day balance, which the chain (a static floor) does not model. That is also why the 1-Step is worth less.

Funded cash. The engine pays 4% less than the chain on average. Most of it is financing. FTMO with financing switched off is worth \$5,828 a month against \$5,509 with it. The daily loss limit, also left out of the chain, costs a little value and more time: in an engine experiment without it, an FTMO attempt is worth \$1,600 against \$1,505 with it, but \$6,581 a month against \$5,243, because stopping for the day after two or three losses stretches the calendar.

Conclusion. Two independent programs, one a rule-by-rule simulation on price paths and the other a set of exact equations on the trade-level chain, agree on every programme to within the effects the equations leave out, and those effects have the expected signs. Every reported value comes from the engine, the more conservative of the two.

Every programme, optimised and derived

One chapter per programme, each built the same way: the firm's rules as published; exactly what the engine simulates; the search and its results; the chosen setting on fresh paths and the real history; one trade worked through in dollars and points; the evaluation and the funded account derived with the exact chain; value per attempt and per month; account sizes and the number of accounts; what higher costs do; and how the plan meets every rule.

FTMO 2-Step Challenge

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting $k = 20$, $m = 0.5$, cycle 30% of the account; **\$5,463 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$342); in the plan: $4 \times 100K$, \$21,852 a month.

12.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	€540 for 100K (about \$632), €1,080 for 200K; refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5% of the initial balance
Maximum daily loss	5% of the initial balance, measured from the balance at 00:00 CE(S)T
Maximum loss	10% of the initial balance, static
Minimum trading days	4 per phase (a day with at least one position opened)
Funded split and payouts	80% (90% after scaling); first reward 14 days after the first trade, then every 14 days; no minimum
Consistency rule	none on the 2-Step (the 1-Step has a 50% best-day rule)
Leverage	1:50 on indices (Normal account)
News and weekends	funded Standard account: no new orders 2 minutes around restricted news; no weekend holding
Per person	\$400,000 per trader or strategy across all accounts, evaluations included; the same strategy may run on several accounts within the cap
Prohibited	gambling (no plan, all-in), account rolling, opposite positions across accounts or providers, gap trading, latency arbitrage

12.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$632
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 4 trading days
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 4 trading days
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; fee refunded with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; flat at weekends

Trades: Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

12.3 The search

Searched: 225 grid settings (Nasdaq; 4,000 attempts each) and 84 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on Nasdaq within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
20	0.5	30%	\$6,236 $\pm$ \$348	31.0%	8.9		yes
30	0.35	25%	\$6,183 $\pm$ \$341	30.0%	8.3	bold	yes
30	0.35	30%	\$6,075 $\pm$ \$371	30.0%	8.1	bold	yes
12	0.5	30%	\$6,016 $\pm$ \$350	30.3%	8.8		yes
20	0.5	25%	\$6,007 $\pm$ \$317	31.1%	9.0		yes
30	0.5	30%	\$6,005 $\pm$ \$349	30.9%	8.9	bold	yes
15	0.5	30%	\$5,983 $\pm$ \$347	30.9%	8.8		yes
50	0.25	40%	\$7,051 $\pm$ \$510	28.7%	6.6	bold	no
30	0.25	40%	\$7,001 $\pm$ \$514	28.9%	6.5	bold	no
50	0.25	30%	\$6,912 $\pm$ \$431	28.6%	6.9	bold	no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

k \ X	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
5	-	-	4.66	-	-	-	-	-

k \ X	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
7	-	-	5.16	-	-	-	-	-
8	4.69	-	5.10	-	-	-	-	-
10	-	4.91	5.14	5.47	5.36	5.47	-	-
12	-	5.08	5.45	5.64	5.63	6.02	-	-
14	-	-	-	5.71	5.70	5.92	-	-
15	-	-	-	5.74	5.95	5.98	-	-
20	-	-	-	5.56	6.01	6.24	5.86	5.54
30	-	-	-	-	5.95	6.01	6.22	6.21
50	-	-	-	-	5.84	6.01	6.18	6.00

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 –0.6) at the stop $m = 0.5$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
0.25	12	50 / 40%	\$7,051 $\pm$ \$510	28.7%	6.6
0.3	12	30 / 30%	\$6,239 $\pm$ \$382	29.6%	7.9
0.35	26	30 / 25%	\$6,183 $\pm$ \$341	30.0%	8.3
0.5	33	20 / 30%	\$6,236 $\pm$ \$348	31.0%	8.9
0.75	1	5 / 10%	\$4,279 $\pm$ \$162	30.1%	12.0

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

12.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	$k / m / X$	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	20 / 0.5 / 30%	\$5,463 $\pm$ \$342	\$5,971 $\pm$ \$540	30.7%	\$7,124	8.7	\$1,557
Best outside the plan's limits	50 / 0.25 / 40%	\$6,560 $\pm$ \$482	\$6,004 $\pm$ \$749	29.0%	\$7,081	6.6	\$1,424
Version 5 default	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$4,246 $\pm$ \$159	\$4,287 $\pm$ \$251	30.6%	\$7,529	12.0	\$1,670
FTMO 1-Step (one phase, trailing loss, 90%)	12 / 0.75 / 12%	\$3,386 $\pm$ \$153	\$3,049 $\pm$ \$246	34.4%	\$6,165	13.8	\$1,537

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

12.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.5 \times 0.2737\% = 0.1368\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **42.5 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$1,096,137$; **\$35.28 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot (platform specification), rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$70.15$, i.e. $c/l = 4.68\%$; financing \$164 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$10,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.919\%$ away, **285.4 points**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1296$.

Mean $-c = -\$70.15$; variance $l(w + c) = 15,105,229$ (sd \$3,887); duration 1.68 h on average (losers 1.20 h, winners 4.9 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$30,000: take-profit 852 points away, $p = 0.0475$, winners 37 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:50: $N/50 = \$21,923 = 21.9\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.183$.

12.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

$kl = \$30,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$10,000	0.1296	1.0000	0.1296	0.1296
2	−\$1,570	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$11,570	0.1142	0.8704	0.0994	0.2290
3	−\$3,140	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$13,140	0.1020	0.7710	0.0786	0.3076
4	−\$4,710	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$14,710	0.0921	0.6924	0.0638	0.3714
5	−\$6,281	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$16,281	0.0840	0.6286	0.0528	0.4242

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
6	-\$7,851	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$17,851	0.0772	0.5758	0.0445	0.4687
7	-\$9,421	\$479	\$22.41	\$19,421	0.0240	0.5313	0.0128	0.4815

Product formula $P_1 = 0.4815$; full chain 0.4829.

$P_1 = 0.4829$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.77$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \343
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 343)/20,000 = 0.4829$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$: cost lowers it by 1.71%.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

$k l = \$30,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$5,000	0.2283	1.0000	0.2283	0.2283
2	-\$1,570	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$6,570	0.1843	0.7717	0.1422	0.3705
3	-\$3,140	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$8,140	0.1545	0.6295	0.0972	0.4677
4	-\$4,710	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$9,710	0.1330	0.5323	0.0708	0.5385
5	-\$6,281	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$11,281	0.1167	0.4615	0.0539	0.5924
6	-\$7,851	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$12,851	0.1040	0.4076	0.0424	0.6348
7	-\$9,421	\$479	\$22.41	\$14,421	0.0321	0.3652	0.0117	0.6465

Product formula $P_2 = 0.6465$; full chain 0.6479.

$P_2 = 0.6479$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.63$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \282
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 282)/15,000 = 0.6478$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$: cost lowers it by 1.88%.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.4829 \times 0.6479 = 0.3129$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.3073 ± 0.0058**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3256.

12.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split $\alpha = 80\%$.
One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.2371$.
Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.3108$; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,325.
Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 10,000 - 678 = \$9,322$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).
Cash: $\alpha \times 9,325 + R \cdot \Pr(\text{refund}) = 0.8 \times 9,325 + 150 = \$7,610$ per funded account (chain); the refund term is \$150, the fee $R = \$632.00$ times the chance of reaching the payout that carries it.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,124** per funded account (-6.4% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 7.0% of attempts reach a payout; median 26 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7629	\$0
1	0.1809	\$24,632
2	0.0429	\$48,632
3	0.0102	\$72,632
4	0.0024	\$96,632

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

12.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3129 \times 7,610 - 632.00 = \$1,749$ (chain); engine \$1,557.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 8.68$ days per attempt, so 3.51 attempts a month per slot and \$2,217 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 51% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 4.1 days on average; a passed one spends 10.9 days in the evaluation and then 8.1 days funded, making 0.30 payouts on average; 12.5 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,557 / 8.68 = \$5,463 \pm \$342$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; $\$5,971 \pm \540 on the real 2024–26 history.

12.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$632	\$632	\$5,463 $\pm$ \$342	\$5,463
200K	\$1,264	\$632	\$11,061 $\pm$ \$685	\$5,530

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: \$400,000 per trader across all accounts, evaluations included. **Copying:** your own accounts, within the cap. **The plan:** $4 \times 100K$, worth \$21,852 a month (4 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: $4 \times 100K$, worth \$21,852 a month (4 accounts). $4 \times 100K$ or $2 \times 200K$ (the same value, Chapter 27).

12.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
$\times 1$	\$5,411 $\pm$ \$479	30.3%	8.6
$\times 1.5$	\$5,350 $\pm$ \$487	29.7%	8.5
$\times 2$	\$4,910 $\pm$ \$517	28.9%	7.4

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

12.11 How the plan meets every rule

- Nasdaq 100 CFD, one position per account, shared direction with every other Nasdaq account
- 1.5% risk (inside FTMO's stated 1–1.5% guidance) with the stop attached at entry
- minimum days filled with one minimal trade per day after the target, where needed
- flat at weekends and 10 minutes before high-impact news on funded accounts
- every account traded the same way; none abandoned or sacrificed (no account rolling)

Sources: ftmo.com (trading objectives; FAQ on accounts and the \$400,000 cap; forbidden practices); propfirmmatch.com (FTMO leverage).

FundingPips 2-Step Flex

USDJPY; plan setting $k = 20$, $m = 0.5$, cycle 25% of the account; **\$5,716 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$316); in the plan: $4 \times 100K$, \$22,866 a month.

13.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$499 for 100K (largest size); no registration-fee refund on Flex
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 6%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% / 12% static
Minimum days	85% option: 1 trading day (accounts from 26 August 2026); 95% option: 3 profitable days (+0.5%) in each phase
Funded split and payouts	85% or 95%, chosen at purchase; every 14 days; the 95% option needs 3 profitable days in every reward cycle
Risk per trade idea	at most 2% above \$25K; a trade idea is all positions on one market in one direction, including one opened within 10 minutes of closing a loss; a breach closes the account
Profit Concentration Policy	evaluations from 27 June 2026, \$25K and up: if one trade idea makes more than 60% of a phase target, the funded account needs 4 profitable days (+0.5%) before every reward request, permanently
Leverage	1:100 on forex; indices and metals on dynamic leverage falling to 1:5 above 0.5 lots
Weekends and news	weekend holding blocked on Master accounts since 29 January 2026; profits from 5 minutes before to 5 minutes after restricted news may be deducted
Per person	\$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts
Copying	only between your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services

13.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$499
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$12,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; at least 1 trading days; one trade may make at most \$5,500 (55% of the target)
Phase 2	target \$6,000; maximum loss \$12,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; at least 1 trading days; one trade may make at most \$3,300 (55% of the target)
Funded account	maximum loss \$12,000, static; daily loss \$4,000; split 85%; no fee refund; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; flat at weekends

Trades: USDJPY, entries 00:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

13.3 The search

Searched: 225 grid settings (USDJPY; 4,000 attempts each) and 86 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on USDJPY within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
20	0.5	25%	\$6,274 $\pm$ \$328	25.7%	9.3		yes
20	0.5	30%	\$6,254 $\pm$ \$350	26.0%	9.2		yes
30	0.5	30%	\$6,153 $\pm$ \$356	25.6%	9.2	bold	yes
20	0.35	25%	\$6,123 $\pm$ \$360	22.3%	7.9		yes
15	0.5	30%	\$6,080 $\pm$ \$341	25.6%	9.2		yes
20	0.5	20%	\$6,032 $\pm$ \$281	25.8%	9.6		yes
30	0.35	30%	\$6,014 $\pm$ \$392	22.4%	7.7	bold	yes
50	0.5	40%	\$6,337 $\pm$ \$393	26.0%	9.2	bold	no
30	0.5	50%	\$6,304 $\pm$ \$420	25.7%	9.1	bold	no
50	0.5	50%	\$6,277 $\pm$ \$423	25.7%	9.1	bold	no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

k \ X	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
5	-	4.46	-	-	-	-	-	-
7	-	4.92	-	-	-	-	-	-
12	4.73	-	5.50	5.71	5.80	5.56	-	-
14	-	-	-	5.79	5.67	5.84	-	-
15	-	-	5.59	5.86	5.74	6.08	-	-
16	-	-	-	5.81	5.87	5.83	-	-
20	-	-	5.51	6.03	6.27	6.25	6.05	5.77
30	-	-	-	-	5.81	6.15	6.16	6.30
50	-	-	-	-	5.85	6.09	6.34	6.28

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 – 0.6) at the stop $m = 0.5$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
0.25	12	30 / 30%	\$5,145 $\pm$ \$423	18.0%	6.6
0.3	12	50 / 30%	\$5,961 $\pm$ \$407	20.3%	7.2
0.35	26	30 / 50%	\$6,207 $\pm$ \$493	22.5%	7.6
0.5	31	50 / 40%	\$6,337 $\pm$ \$393	26.0%	9.2
0.75	5	8 / 15%	\$5,184 $\pm$ \$201	28.9%	12.8

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

Searched but not used	Best k / m / X	Refined EV/month
85%, no cap on single trades: breaks the Profit Concentration Policy's conditions on new evaluations	50 / 0.35 / 50%	\$9,268 $\pm$ \$535
2-Step Standard: rules last checked in version 3	50 / 0.3 / 40%	\$7,668 $\pm$ \$484

13.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	k / m / X	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	20 / 0.5 / 25%	\$5,716 $\pm$ \$316	\$5,423 $\pm$ \$507	25.2%	\$8,766	9.1	\$1,708
Best outside the plan's limits	50 / 0.5 / 40%	\$5,705 $\pm$ \$383	\$6,548 $\pm$ \$654	25.5%	\$8,600	9.0	\$1,690
Version 5 default	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$4,219 $\pm$ \$157	\$3,763 $\pm$ \$266	28.6%	\$8,117	13.1	\$1,822
85%, concentration policy accepted (4 profitable days per cycle)	14 / 0.5 / 30%	\$5,376 $\pm$ \$299	\$5,911 $\pm$ \$469	30.9%	\$7,193	9.7	\$1,720
95% option (3 profitable days per phase and cycle)	14 / 0.6 / 30%	\$4,055 $\pm$ \$231	\$4,267 $\pm$ \$389	29.1%	\$8,491	14.8	\$1,971

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

13.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.5 \times 0.1193\% = 0.0597\%$ of the price; at 157.83 that is **9.4 pips**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$2,514,484$; **\$159.32 per pip**; at \$6.34 per pip per standard lot, **25.14 lots** (round down).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$128.24$, i.e. $c/l = 8.55\%$; financing \$50 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1, cap) = \$5,500$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.224\%$ away, **35.3 pips**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.2104$.

Mean $-c = -\$128.24$; variance $l(w + c) = 8,442,358$ (sd \$2,906); duration 0.94 h on average (losers 0.71 h, winners 1.8 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$25,000: take-profit 158 pips away, $p = 0.0563$, winners 26 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:100: $N/100 = \$25,145 = 25.1\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.210$.

13.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$12,000$

Not a pure bold chain: one trade may make at most \$5,500, so at least 2 wins are needed. The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$P_1 = 0.4618$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.23$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$1,842$
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (12,000 - 1,842)/22,000 = 0.4617$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.5455$: cost lowers it by 8.36%.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$544 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$6,000$, $B = \$12,000$

Not a pure bold chain: one trade may make at most \$3,300, so at least 2 wins are needed. The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$P_2 = 0.5618$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.47$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$1,888$
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (12,000 - 1,888)/18,000 = 0.5618$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$: cost lowers it by 10.48%.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$544 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.4618 \times 0.5618 = 0.2595$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.2518 ± 0.0055**; the Brownian formula gives 0.2606.

13.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$12,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$25,000$; split $\alpha = 85\%$.
One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.2997$.
Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.4279$; expected withdrawn before the split \$10,696.
Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 12,000 - 1,307 = \$10,693$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).
Cash: $\alpha \times 10,696 = \$9,092$ per funded account (chain).
Engine, fresh paths: **\$8,766** per funded account (-3.6% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 7.6% of attempts reach a payout; median 22 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7003	\$0
1	0.2099	\$21,250
2	0.0629	\$42,500
3	0.0188	\$63,750
4	0.0056	\$85,000

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

13.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.2595 \times 9,092 - 499.00 = \$1,860$ (chain); engine \$1,708.
Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 9.10$ days per attempt, so 3.35 attempts a month per slot and \$1,670 of fees a month before refunds.
Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 54% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 5.7 days on average; a passed one spends 8.0 days in the evaluation and then 11.0 days funded, making 0.43 payouts on average; 28.0 trades per attempt.
Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,708/9.10 = \$5,716 \pm \$316$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; \$5,423 ± \$507 on the real 2024–26 history.

13.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$499	\$499	\$5,716 ± \$316	\$5,716

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: \$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts. **Copying:** your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services. **The plan:** $4 \times 100\text{K}$, worth \$22,866 a month (4 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: $4 \times 100\text{K}$, worth \$22,866 a month (4 accounts). Flex goes up to 100K, so four accounts.

13.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
$\times 1$	\$5,341 $\pm$ \$443	25.4%	9.0
$\times 1.5$	\$4,692 $\pm$ \$449	21.6%	8.4
$\times 2$	\$3,510 $\pm$ \$443	17.2%	7.7

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

13.11 How the plan meets every rule

- USDJPY, because the Nasdaq position would need 1:7 leverage and FundingPips gives 1:5 at that size
- 1.5% risk, below the 2% trade-idea limit; at least 10 minutes after any loss before the next trade in the same direction
- the Profit Concentration Policy handled as chosen in this chapter
- $4 \times 100\text{K}$ Flex (the largest Flex size) fills the \$400,000 cap
- own program or manual entry on each account; no copier service

Sources: proptadingvibes.com (FundingPips rules, updated 16 Sep 2026; account types and leverage); help.fundingpips.com (2 Step Flex; Risk Per Trade Idea); search summaries of the Profit Concentration Policy.

The5ers High Stakes

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting $k = 20$, $m = 0.5$, cycle 25% of the account; **\$4,775 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$250); in the plan: $1 \times 100K$, \$4,775 a month.

14.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	New (10% / 5%): \$491 for 100K; Classic (8% / 5%): \$545; smaller sizes \$19–\$278
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	New 10% / 5%; Classic 8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10% static
Profitable days	3 per phase (at least +0.5%); may not be manufactured
Funded split and payouts	80% rising with scaling; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; \$150 minimum
Fee return	10% as hub credit after phase 1, 20% after phase 2, 70% with the first payout (the model counts it all at the first payout)
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:25 metals and indices
News	no new orders from 2 minutes before to 2 minutes after high-impact news
Per person	one 50K or 100K High Stakes account, plus up to $1 \times 25K$, $3 \times 10K$, $3 \times 5K$, $3 \times 2.5K$
Copying	allowed across your own accounts

14.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$545
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; fee refunded with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; flat at weekends

Trades: Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

14.3 The search

Searched: 225 grid settings (Nasdaq; 4,000 attempts each) and 34 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on Nasdaq within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
20	0.5	25%	\$5,004 $\pm$ \$260	31.4%	11.7		yes
12	0.5	30%	\$4,978 $\pm$ \$274	31.9%	11.7		yes
30	0.5	30%	\$4,963 $\pm$ \$279	32.0%	11.6	bold	yes
15	0.5	25%	\$4,960 $\pm$ \$253	31.4%	11.7		yes
14	0.5	25%	\$4,946 $\pm$ \$258	31.2%	11.7		yes
14	0.5	30%	\$4,942 $\pm$ \$276	31.9%	11.6		yes
15	0.5	30%	\$4,924 $\pm$ \$280	31.4%	11.6		yes
50	0.5	30%	\$4,916 $\pm$ \$279	31.9%	11.7	bold	no
30	0.5	40%	\$4,901 $\pm$ \$314	31.9%	11.5	bold	no
50	0.5	25%	\$4,841 $\pm$ \$251	31.5%	11.9	bold	no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

$k \setminus X$	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
5	-	4.04	-	-	-	-	-

k \ X	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
7	-	4.28	-	-	-	-	-
8	4.07	-	-	-	-	-	-
10	-	4.50	4.54	4.48	4.46	-	-
12	4.47	-	4.80	4.90	4.98	-	-
14	-	-	4.77	4.95	4.94	-	-
15	-	-	4.84	4.96	4.92	-	-
20	-	-	4.63	5.00	4.89	4.74	4.44
30	-	-	-	4.89	4.96	4.90	4.64
50	-	-	-	4.84	4.92	4.81	4.70

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 –0.6) at the stop $m = 0.5$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
0.5	30	20 / 25%	\$5,004 $\pm$ \$260	31.4%	11.7
0.75	4	12 / 15%	\$4,499 $\pm$ \$175	33.6%	14.1

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

14.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	$k / m / X$	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	20 / 0.5 / 25%	\$4,775 $\pm$ \$250	\$4,174 $\pm$ \$400	32.3%	\$7,385	11.7	\$1,840
Version 5 default	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$4,030 $\pm$ \$138	\$4,001 $\pm$ \$231	32.9%	\$7,535	14.6	\$1,931
High Stakes New (10% / 5%, \$491)	20 / 0.6 / 20%	\$4,482 $\pm$ \$218	\$4,674 $\pm$ \$379	29.6%	\$7,599	12.0	\$1,760

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

14.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.5 \times 0.2737\% = 0.1368\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **42.5 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$1,096,137$; **\$35.28 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot (platform specification), rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$70.15$, i.e. $c/l = 4.68\%$; financing \$164 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$8,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.736\%$ away, **228.7 points**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1567$.

Mean $-c = -\$70.15$; variance $l(w + c) = 12,105,229$ (sd \$3,479); duration 1.35 h on average (losers 0.98 h, winners 3.3 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$25,000: take-profit 711 points away, $p = 0.0565$, winners 26 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:25: $N/25 = \$43,845 = 43.8\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.365$.

14.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Not a pure bold chain: the phase needs 3 profitable days, so the plan aims at a daily target and wins are smaller (6.4); the chain below ignores that rule, which changes time, not the average (11.1). The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$$P_1 = 0.5376, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.41, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$324$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 324)/18,000 = 0.5376$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.5556: \text{ cost lowers it by } 1.79\%.$$

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Not a pure bold chain: the phase needs 3 profitable days, so the plan aims at a daily target and wins are smaller (6.4); the chain below ignores that rule, which changes time, not the average (11.1). The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$P_2 = 0.6479$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.63$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \282
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 282)/15,000 = 0.6478$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$: cost lowers it by 1.88%.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.5376 \times 0.6479 = 0.3483$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.3229 ± 0.0059**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3629.

14.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$25,000$; split $\alpha = 80\%$.
One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.2735$.
Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.3764$; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,411.
Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 10,000 - 592 = \$9,408$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).
Cash: $\alpha \times 9,411 + R \cdot \text{Pr}(\text{refund}) = 0.8 \times 9,411 + 149 = \$7,678$ per funded account (chain); the refund term is \$149, the fee $R = \$545.00$ times the chance of reaching the payout that carries it.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,385** per funded account (-3.8% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 8.6% of attempts reach a payout; median 28 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7265	\$0
1	0.1987	\$20,545
2	0.0543	\$40,545
3	0.0149	\$60,545
4	0.0041	\$80,545

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

14.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3483 \times 7,678 - 545.00 = \$2,129$ (chain); engine \$1,840.
Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 11.73$ days per attempt, so 2.60 attempts a month per slot and \$1,414 of fees a month before refunds.
Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 47% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 6.7 days on average; a passed one spends 13.2 days in the evaluation and then 9.9 days funded, making 0.42 payouts on average; 18.9 trades per attempt.
Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,840/11.73 = \$4,775 \pm \$250$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; \$4,174 ± \$400 on the real 2024–26 history.

14.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$545	\$545	\$4,775 ± \$250	\$4,775
25K (New rules)	\$176	\$704	\$927 ± \$54	\$3,707
10K (New rules)	\$69	\$690	\$381 ± \$22	\$3,807
5K (New rules)	\$35	\$700	\$190 ± \$11	\$3,808
2.5K (New rules)	\$19	\$760	\$92 ± \$5	\$3,676

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: one 100K (or 50K) High Stakes account, plus 1 × 25K, 3 × 10K, 3 × 5K, 3 × 2.5K. **Copying:** your own accounts. **The plan:** 1 × 100K, worth \$4,775 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 × 100K; 1 × 25K; 3 × 10K; 3 × 5K; 3 × 2.5K, worth \$7,691 a month (11 accounts). The small accounts add about 2% for ten more accounts; optional.

14.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
× 1	\$4,627 ± \$341	32.9%	11.7
× 1.5	\$4,136 ± \$354	28.7%	11.0
× 2	\$4,023 ± \$361	28.5%	10.3

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

14.11 How the plan meets every rule

- Nasdaq, shared direction
- daily profit target while profitable days are missing (6.4); never tiny trades
- news window wider than required
- one 100K account; the small accounts are optional (Chapter 27)

Sources: the5ers.com (High Stakes page; payout policy and hub credit FAQ); propfirmbridge.com (High Stakes review, 15 Sep 2026).

FXIFY Two Phase Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting $k = 12$, $m = 1$, cycle 30% of the account; **\$4,046 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$195); in the plan: $1 \times 100K$; $1 \times 50K$; $1 \times 25K$; $1 \times 10K$; $1 \times 5K$, \$7,096 a month.

15.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$549 for 100K (largest Classic size); refunded with the first payout
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	5% / 10%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% / 10% static
Minimum trading days	4 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80% every 14 days, or 100% every 30 days (chosen at purchase)
Consistency rule (funded)	no day may exceed 25% of the profit of a payout; the benchmark is the account's best day ever and does not reset
Leverage	1:10 on indices; 1:30 forex and metals (1:50 with an add-on)
Per person	one active account of each size, challenge and funded alike (5K, 10K, 15K, 25K, 50K, 100K, 200K, 400K; \$805,000 in all, rule of 25 November 2024); Classic goes up to 100K; Classic prices 5K \$59, 10K \$89, 25K \$199, 50K \$379, 100K \$549
Copying	between your own FXIFY accounts allowed; into FXIFY from external accounts only with approval (30-day statement); third-party copying prohibited

15.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$549
Phase 1	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; at least 4 trading days
Phase 2	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; at least 4 trading days
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$4,000; split 100%; fee refunded with payout number 1; first payout 30 days after funding, then every 30 days; best day at most 25% of a payout's profit; flat at weekends

Trades: Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

15.3 The search

Searched: 315 grid settings (Nasdaq, USDJPY; 4,000 attempts each) and 66 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on Nasdaq within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
12	1	30%	\$4,336 $\pm$ \$203	32.0%	17.3		yes
15	1	30%	\$4,336 $\pm$ \$197	32.2%	17.5		yes
20	1	30%	\$4,280 $\pm$ \$199	31.8%	17.5		yes
16	1	30%	\$4,255 $\pm$ \$197	32.0%	17.5		yes
14	1	30%	\$4,224 $\pm$ \$199	32.1%	17.3		yes
30	1	30%	\$4,212 $\pm$ \$200	32.0%	17.6	bold	yes
12	1	25%	\$4,059 $\pm$ \$181	32.2%	17.6		yes
20	1	40%	\$4,591 $\pm$ \$230	32.0%	17.0	bold	no
50	1	40%	\$4,589 $\pm$ \$231	31.8%	17.1	bold	no
30	1	40%	\$4,552 $\pm$ \$229	31.7%	17.1	bold	no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

$k \setminus X$	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
3	-	-	3.37	-	-	-	-	-
4	-	-	3.38	-	-	-	-	-

k \ X	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
5	2.95	-	3.38	-	-	-	-	-
6	-	3.13	-	-	-	-	-	-
8	-	-	3.50	-	-	-	-	-
10	-	-	3.53	-	-	-	-	-
12	-	-	3.57	3.97	4.06	4.34	-	-
14	-	-	-	3.81	4.04	4.22	-	-
15	-	-	3.55	3.80	3.90	4.34	-	-
16	-	-	-	3.85	3.87	4.25	-	-
20	-	-	3.54	3.84	3.81	4.28	4.59	4.16
30	-	-	-	-	3.72	4.21	4.55	4.12
50	-	-	-	-	3.72	4.25	4.59	4.10

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 – 0.6) at the stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
1	35	20 / 40%	\$4,591 $\pm$ \$230	32.0%	17.0
1.25	1	4 / 15%	\$3,259 $\pm$ \$119	30.5%	21.2

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

15.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	$k / m / X$	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	12 / 1 / 30%	\$4,046 $\pm$ \$195	\$3,167 $\pm$ \$273	31.9%	\$8,766	16.9	\$2,251
Best outside the plan's limits	20 / 1 / 40%	\$3,763 $\pm$ \$210	\$2,988 $\pm$ \$307	31.6%	\$8,163	16.4	\$2,031
Version 5 default	5 / 1 / 10%	\$2,796 $\pm$ \$94	\$2,137 $\pm$ \$147	31.0%	\$8,001	21.0	\$1,932
80% every 14 days, Nasdaq	30 / 1 / 30%	\$3,280 $\pm$ \$165	\$3,122 $\pm$ \$260	31.4%	\$7,007	15.3	\$1,651
100% every 30 days, USDJPY	11 / 0.75 / 30%	\$3,570 $\pm$ \$219	\$3,793 $\pm$ \$365	29.7%	\$7,186	13.5	\$1,582
80% every 14 days, USDJPY	12 / 0.85 / 30%	\$3,253 $\pm$ \$186	\$3,105 $\pm$ \$289	30.6%	\$6,405	13.2	\$1,408

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

15.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$548,068$; **\$17.64 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot (platform specification), rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$35.08$, i.e. $c/l = 2.34\%$; financing \$82 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$5,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.919\%$ away, **285.4 points**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.2295$.

Mean $-c = -\$35.08$; variance $l(w + c) = 7,552,615$ (sd \$2,748); duration 3.36 h on average (losers 2.57 h, winners 6.0 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$18,000: take-profit 1,022 points away, $p = 0.0768$, winners 56 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:10: $N/10 = \$54,807 = 54.8\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.913$.

15.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

$k l = \$18,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$5,000	0.2295	1.0000	0.2295	0.2295
2	-\$1,535	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$6,535	0.1859	0.7705	0.1432	0.3727
3	-\$3,070	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$8,070	0.1562	0.6273	0.0980	0.4707
4	-\$4,605	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$9,605	0.1346	0.5293	0.0713	0.5420

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
5	-\$6,140	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$11,140	0.1183	0.4580	0.0542	0.5962
6	-\$7,675	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$12,675	0.1056	0.4038	0.0426	0.6388
7	-\$9,210	\$690	\$16.12	\$14,210	0.0462	0.3612	0.0167	0.6555

Product formula $P_1 = 0.6555$; full chain 0.6571.

$P_1 = 0.6571$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.67$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \144
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 144)/15,000 = 0.6571$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$: cost lowers it by 0.96%.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$730 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Not a pure bold chain: $kl = \$18,000 < A + B$, so from deep below the start one win does not reach the target. The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$P_2 = 0.4912$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.87$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \177
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 177)/20,000 = 0.4912$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$: cost lowers it by 0.88%.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$730 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.6571 \times 0.4912 = 0.3227$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.3194 ± 0.0059**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3269.

15.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split $\alpha = 100\%$.
One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.2272$.
Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.2940$; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,819.
Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 10,000 - 1,182 = \$8,818$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).
Cash: $\alpha \times 8,819 + R \cdot \text{Pr}(\text{refund}) = 1 \times 8,819 + 125 = \$8,943$ per funded account (chain); the refund term is \$125, the fee $R = \$549.00$ times the chance of reaching the payout that carries it.
Best-day rule (25%): each day's take-profit is capped at \$7,500 less what the day has made, so a cycle needs at least 4 profitable days; the chain applies it as a cap per win.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$8,766** per funded account (-2.0% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 9.5% of attempts reach a payout; median 44 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7728	\$0
1	0.1756	\$30,549
2	0.0399	\$60,549
3	0.0091	\$90,549
4	0.0021	\$120,549

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

15.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3227 \times 8,943 - 549.00 = \$2,337$ (chain); engine \$2,251.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 16.93$ days per attempt, so 1.80 attempts a month per slot and \$987 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 35% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 7.9 days on average; a passed one spends 13.2 days in the evaluation and then 23.1 days funded, making 0.42 payouts on average; 23.1 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 2,251 / 16.93 = \$4,046 \pm \$195$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; $\$3,167 \pm \273 on the real 2024–26 history.

15.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$549	\$549	\$4,046 $\pm$ \$195	\$4,046
50K	\$379	\$758	\$1,759 $\pm$ \$99	\$3,518
25K	\$199	\$796	\$836 $\pm$ \$49	\$3,344
10K	\$89	\$890	\$321 $\pm$ \$19	\$3,205
5K	\$59	\$1,180	\$134 $\pm$ \$10	\$2,688

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: one active account of each size (\$805,000 in all). **Copying:** between your own FXIFY accounts; Pro may not receive copied trades. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 100K; 1 $\times$ 50K; 1 $\times$ 25K; 1 $\times$ 10K; 1 $\times$ 5K, worth \$7,096 a month (5 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: 1 $\times$ 100K; 1 $\times$ 50K; 1 $\times$ 25K; 1 $\times$ 10K; 1 $\times$ 5K, worth \$7,096 a month (5 accounts). Every Classic size with a published price; 15K and the 2 Phase Pro sizes are left out (Chapter 27).

15.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
$\times 1$	\$3,918 $\pm$ \$275	31.3%	16.7
$\times 1.5$	\$3,714 $\pm$ \$268	31.6%	16.8
$\times 2$	\$3,127 $\pm$ \$266	30.4%	16.0

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

15.11 How the plan meets every rule

- Nasdaq with the stop widened to fit 1:10 leverage (USDJPY was searched too and is worth less)
- each day's take-profit capped at 25% of the cycle target, so the best-day rule always holds
- 100% every 30 days (better value than 80% every 14 days in the search)
- one Classic account of each size: 100K, 50K, 25K, 10K and 5K (15K has no published Classic price and is left out)
- 2 Phase Pro is not used: it may not receive copied trades (only be the master), so it would need a market of its own, and its \$4,000 daily profit cap is flat at every size

Sources: cryptoslate.com (FXIFY review, updated 4 Oct 2026: Classic and Pro prices and rules); fxify.com FAQs ("What is the max allocation?"; 2 Phase Pro max allocation; copy trading); search summaries of FXIFY leverage.

FundedNext Stellar 2-Step

EURUSD; plan setting $k = 20$, $m = 1$, cycle 25% of the account; **\$3,804 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$181); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$7,679 a month.

16.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$549.99 for 100K; \$1,049.99 for 200K (from August 2026); refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10%
Minimum trading days	5 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80%; rewards on a 21-day cycle
15% challenge reward	for accounts bought from 12 January 2026, paid only on Scale-Up eligibility (not counted)
Consistency rule	none on Stellar accounts; profit around high-impact news counts at 40% on funded accounts
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:10 gold (from January 2026); 1:10 indices (from May 2026)
Per person	\$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited
Copying	between your own challenge accounts; never into a funded account
Monitored as gambling	one-sided betting, account rolling, many quick breaches, losses exceeding gains

16.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$549.99
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 5 trading days
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 5 trading days
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; fee refunded with payout number 1; first payout 21 days after funding, then every 21 days; flat at weekends

Trades: EURUSD, entries 07:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

16.3 The search

Searched: 360 grid settings (EURUSD, gold; 4,000 attempts each) and 110 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on EURUSD within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
20	0.75	25%	\$4,477 $\pm$ \$226	32.1%	11.8		yes
30	0.75	30%	\$4,349 $\pm$ \$250	31.8%	11.6	bold	yes
30	0.75	25%	\$4,300 $\pm$ \$224	31.7%	11.7	bold	yes
20	0.75	30%	\$4,282 $\pm$ \$249	31.5%	11.4	bold	yes
14	0.75	20%	\$4,198 $\pm$ \$202	31.7%	11.8		yes
16	0.75	20%	\$4,193 $\pm$ \$196	31.7%	11.9		yes
20	0.6	20%	\$4,173 $\pm$ \$220	30.2%	10.1		yes
50	0.75	25%	\$4,347 $\pm$ \$224	31.7%	11.8	bold	no
50	0.75	30%	\$4,334 $\pm$ \$249	31.7%	11.6	bold	no
50	0.75	40%	\$4,232 $\pm$ \$292	31.7%	11.5	bold	no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

$k \setminus X$	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
5	2.87	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
6	-	-	3.36	-	-	-	-	-
10	-	3.70	3.91	-	-	-	-	-

$k \backslash X$	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
12	-	3.81	3.92	4.05	3.89	-	-	-
14	-	-	4.01	4.20	4.12	-	-	-
15	-	-	4.05	4.15	4.17	-	-	-
16	-	-	4.06	4.19	4.17	-	-	-
20	-	-	4.07	4.11	4.48	4.28	3.94	3.65
30	-	-	-	-	4.30	4.35	4.19	3.77
50	-	-	-	-	4.35	4.33	4.23	3.83

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 – 0.6) at the stop $m = 0.75$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
0.3	12	30 / 25%	−\$496 ± \$323	15.2%	4.3
0.35	13	50 / 25%	\$19 ± \$342	15.4%	4.4
0.5	5	12 / 15%	\$3,540 ± \$175	29.3%	10.2
0.6	15	20 / 20%	\$4,173 ± \$220	30.2%	10.1
0.75	31	20 / 25%	\$4,477 ± \$226	32.1%	11.8

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

16.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	$k / m / X$	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	20 / 1 / 25%	\$3,804 ± \$181	\$3,630 ± \$293	34.4%	\$7,129	15.2	\$1,904
Refined best before the robustness check	20 / 0.75 / 25%	\$4,178 ± \$221	\$4,416 ± \$351	32.1%	\$6,666	11.6	\$1,591
Version 5 default	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$2,936 ± \$118	\$3,991 ± \$176	30.2%	\$6,163	13.6	\$1,314
on gold (taken by Hola Prime in the plan)	10 / 1 / 30%	\$4,187 ± \$209	\$3,991 ± \$273	34.5%	\$7,237	14.1	\$1,946

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

16.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.0853\% = 0.0853\%$ of the price; at 1.1256 that is **9.6 pips**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$1,759,509$; **\$156.32 per pip**; at \$10.00 per pip per standard lot, **15.63 lots** (round down).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$109.09$, i.e. $c/l = 7.27\%$; financing \$35 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$8,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.461\%$ away, **51.9 pips**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1561$.

Mean $-c = -\$109.09$; variance $l(w + c) = 12,163,634$ (sd \$3,488); duration 5.41 h on average (losers 3.94 h, winners 13.3 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$25,000: take-profit 161 pips away, $p = 0.0564$, winners 105 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:100: $N/100 = \$17,595 = 17.6\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.293$.

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16.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

$kl = \$30,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$8,000	0.1561	1.0000	0.1561	0.1561
2	−\$1,609	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$9,609	0.1337	0.8439	0.1128	0.2689
3	−\$3,218	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$11,218	0.1169	0.7311	0.0855	0.3544
4	−\$4,827	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$12,827	0.1039	0.6456	0.0671	0.4215
5	−\$6,436	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$14,436	0.0935	0.5785	0.0541	0.4756
6	−\$8,045	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$16,045	0.0850	0.5244	0.0446	0.5201

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
7	-\$9,655	\$245	\$17.85	\$17,655	0.0137	0.4799	0.0066	0.5267

Product formula $P_1 = 0.5267$; full chain 0.5283.

$$P_1 = 0.5283, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.41, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$493$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 493)/18,000 = 0.5282$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.5556: \text{ cost lowers it by 2.73\%}.$$

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$1,582 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000, B = \$10,000$

$kl = \$30,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$5,000	0.2270	1.0000	0.2270	0.2270
2	-\$1,609	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$6,609	0.1825	0.7730	0.1411	0.3681
3	-\$3,218	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$8,218	0.1526	0.6319	0.0965	0.4645
4	-\$4,827	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$9,827	0.1312	0.5355	0.0702	0.5347
5	-\$6,436	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$11,436	0.1150	0.4653	0.0535	0.5882
6	-\$8,045	\$1,500	\$109.09	\$13,045	0.1024	0.4118	0.0421	0.6304
7	-\$9,655	\$245	\$17.85	\$14,655	0.0165	0.3696	0.0061	0.6365

Product formula $P_2 = 0.6365$; full chain 0.6379.

$$P_2 = 0.6379, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.66, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$433$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 433)/15,000 = 0.6378$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.6667: \text{ cost lowers it by 2.87\%}.$$

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$1,582 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.5283 \times 0.6379 = 0.3370$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.3443 ± 0.0060**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3588.

16.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$25,000$; split $\alpha = 80\%$.

One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.2673$.

Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.3647$; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,119.

Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 10,000 - 886 = \$9,114$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).

Cash: $\alpha \times 9,119 + R \cdot \Pr(\text{refund}) = 0.8 \times 9,119 + 147 = \$7,442$ per funded account (chain); the refund term is \$147, the fee $R = \$549.99$ times the chance of reaching the payout that carries it.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,129** per funded account (-4.2% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 9.9% of attempts reach a payout; median 36 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7327	\$0
1	0.1958	\$20,550
2	0.0523	\$40,550
3	0.0140	\$60,550
4	0.0037	\$80,550

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

16.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3370 \times 7,442 - 549.99 = \$1,958$ (chain); engine \$1,904.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 15.24$ days per attempt, so 2.00 attempts a month per slot and \$1,099 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 47% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 7.3 days on average; a passed one spends 14.6 days in the evaluation and then 15.8 days funded, making 0.39 payouts on average; 14.7 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,904 / 15.24 = \$3,804 \pm \$181$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; $\$3,630 \pm \293 on the real 2024–26 history.

16.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$549.99	\$550	\$3,804 ± \$181	\$3,804
200K	\$1,049.99	\$525	\$7,679 ± \$359	\$3,840

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: \$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited. **Copying:** between your own challenge accounts, never into a funded account. **The plan:** $1 \times 200K$, worth \$7,679 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: $1 \times 200K$, worth \$7,679 a month (1 accounts). One 200K account on its own market; a second account would need a third independent market.

16.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
× 1	\$3,630 ± \$258	34.0%	14.8
× 1.5	\$3,153 ± \$277	29.9%	12.6
× 2	\$2,273 ± \$282	27.3%	10.7

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

16.11 How the plan meets every rule

- its own market (no other account trades it), with its own direction rule: its trades are never copies
- one account at the largest size, 200K (cheaper per dollar), within the \$300,000 cap
- flat around news, so the 40% news share never applies

Sources: help.fundednext.com (Stellar 2-Step, updated 2 Oct 2026; copy trading; prohibited strategies); proptadingvibes.com (Stellar 2-Step; consistency rule); search summaries of FundedNext leverage and 200K price.

Fintokei ProTrader

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting $k = 12$, $m = 0.5$, cycle 25% of the account; **\$4,072 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$239); in the plan: $5 \times 100K$, \$20,361 a month.

17.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$549 for 100K; \$1,249 for 200K; \$2,599 for 400K; returned with the first payout as a sign-up bonus
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 6%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of start-of-day equity / 10% static
Minimum days	3 profitable days per phase (the stricter of two published readings)
Maximum risk per trade	3% on open trades (a warning, after which consistency rules can apply)
Funded split and payouts	80%; first request 14 days after the funded account opens, then every 14 days; at least 3% profit; all positions closed at the request
Discretionary consistency rules	if trading is flagged unsustainable: leverage 1:10, daily profit and loss capped at 1%
Leverage	1:100 forex, gold and silver; 1:50 indices
Per person	€500,000 of accounts in total
Copying	your own trades across your own accounts allowed; other people's signals prohibited

17.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$549
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500
Phase 2	target \$6,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; fee refunded with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$3,000; flat at weekends

Trades: Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

17.3 The search

Searched: 225 grid settings (Nasdaq; 4,000 attempts each) and 87 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on Nasdaq within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
12	0.5	25%	\$4,752 $\pm$ \$255	29.8%	11.6		yes
20	0.5	25%	\$4,742 $\pm$ \$258	29.3%	11.5		yes
16	0.5	25%	\$4,698 $\pm$ \$257	29.6%	11.6		yes
16	0.5	20%	\$4,683 $\pm$ \$224	29.9%	11.9		yes
30	0.5	25%	\$4,657 $\pm$ \$260	29.3%	11.7	bold	yes
15	0.5	20%	\$4,656 $\pm$ \$229	29.4%	11.8		yes
15	0.5	25%	\$4,626 $\pm$ \$255	29.3%	11.5		yes
50	0.35	50%	\$4,731 $\pm$ \$382	27.7%	10.4	bold	no
30	0.5	40%	\$4,724 $\pm$ \$307	29.7%	11.3	bold	no
30	0.5	50%	\$4,700 $\pm$ \$333	29.6%	11.3	bold	no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

k \ X	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
6		3.73	-	-	-	-	-	-
7	-	-	4.03	-	-	-	-	-

k \ X	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
8	-	-	4.06	-	-	-	-	-
10	3.86	4.02	4.08	-	-	-	-	-
12	-	4.07	4.31	4.59	4.75	-	-	-
14	-	-	4.40	4.51	4.55	-	-	-
15	-	4.20	4.30	4.66	4.63	-	-	-
16	-	-	4.32	4.68	4.70	-	-	-
20	-	4.18	4.16	4.40	4.74	4.62	4.67	4.45
30	-	-	-	-	4.66	4.62	4.72	4.70
50	-	-	-	-	4.43	4.50	4.59	4.45

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 –0.6) at the stop $m = 0.5$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
0.25	12	30 / 40%	\$4,641 $\pm$ \$367	26.2%	9.3
0.3	12	50 / 50%	\$4,553 $\pm$ \$375	27.1%	10.0
0.35	27	50 / 50%	\$4,731 $\pm$ \$382	27.7%	10.4
0.5	35	12 / 25%	\$4,752 $\pm$ \$255	29.8%	11.6
0.75	1	5 / 10%	\$3,680 $\pm$ \$137	31.0%	14.2

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

17.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	$k / m / X$	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	12 / 0.5 / 25%	\$4,072 $\pm$ \$239	\$4,196 $\pm$ \$399	30.3%	\$6,866	11.4	\$1,529
Version 5 default	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$3,757 $\pm$ \$140	\$3,568 $\pm$ \$227	31.1%	\$7,430	14.3	\$1,761

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

17.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.5 \times 0.2737\% = 0.1368\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **42.5 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$1,096,137$; **\$35.28 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot (platform specification), rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$70.15$, i.e. $c/l = 4.68\%$; financing \$164 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$8,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.736\%$ away, **228.7 points**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1567$.

Mean $-c = -\$70.15$; variance $l(w + c) = 12,105,229$ (sd \$3,479); duration 1.35 h on average (losers 0.98 h, winners 3.3 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$18,000: take-profit 512 points away, $p = 0.0766$, winners 14 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:50: $N/50 = \$21,923 = 21.9\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.183$.

17.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Not a pure bold chain: the phase needs 3 profitable days, so the plan aims at a daily target and wins are smaller (6.4); the chain below ignores that rule, which changes time, not the average (11.1). The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$$P_1 = 0.5375, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.47, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$326$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 326)/18,000 = 0.5374$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.5556: \text{ cost lowers it by } 1.81\%.$$

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$6,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Not a pure bold chain: the phase needs 3 profitable days, so the plan aims at a daily target and wins are smaller (6.4); the chain below ignores that rule, which changes time, not the average (11.1). The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$P_2 = 0.6063$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.99$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \301
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 301)/16,000 = 0.6062$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.6250$: cost lowers it by 1.87%.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.5375 \times 0.6063 = 0.3259$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.3026 ± 0.0058**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3347.

17.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$25,000$; split $\alpha = 80\%$.
One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.2662$.
Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.3628$; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,071.
Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 10,000 - 932 = \$9,068$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).
Cash: $\alpha \times 9,071 + R \cdot \text{Pr}(\text{refund}) = 0.8 \times 9,071 + 146 = \$7,403$ per funded account (chain); the refund term is \$146, the fee $R = \$549.00$ times the chance of reaching the payout that carries it.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$6,866** per funded account (-7.2% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 7.7% of attempts reach a payout; median 28 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7338	\$0
1	0.1954	\$20,549
2	0.0520	\$40,549
3	0.0138	\$60,549
4	0.0037	\$80,549

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

17.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3259 \times 7,403 - 549.00 = \$1,863$ (chain); engine \$1,529.
Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 11.43$ days per attempt, so 2.66 attempts a month per slot and \$1,462 of fees a month before refunds.
Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 48% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 6.7 days on average; a passed one spends 13.4 days in the evaluation and then 9.9 days funded, making 0.39 payouts on average; 20.2 trades per attempt.
Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,529/11.43 = \$4,072 \pm \$239$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; \$4,196 ± \$399 on the real 2024–26 history.

17.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$549	\$549	\$4,072 ± \$239	\$4,072
200K	\$1,249	\$624	\$7,748 ± \$481	\$3,874

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: €500,000 of accounts. **Copying:** your own trades across your own accounts. **The plan:** $5 \times 100\text{K}$, worth \$20,361 a month (5 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: $5 \times 100\text{K}$, worth \$20,361 a month (5 accounts). $5 \times 100\text{K} = \$500,000 \approx €444,000$.

17.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
× 1	\$3,932 ± \$339	29.6%	11.4

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
× 1.5	\$3,581 ± \$332	28.1%	10.9
× 2	\$3,344 ± \$339	26.8%	10.1

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

17.11 How the plan meets every rule

- Nasdaq, shared direction; $5 \times 100K$: \$500,000 is about €444,000 at 1.1256, inside the €500,000 cap, and 100K is cheaper per dollar than 200K
- 1.5% risk, half the 3% limit
- every position closed before a payout request

Sources: fintokei.com (ProTrader page); Fintokei ProTrader terms (version 6); support.fintokei.com (consistency rules); propfirmmap.com.

Hola Prime 2-Step Prime

gold (XAUUSD); plan setting $k = 10$, $m = 1$, cycle 20% of the account; **\$4,578 a month per 100K** ($\pm \$210$); in the plan: $2 \times 100K$, \$9,156 a month.

18.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	about \$599 for 100K (published \$409–\$599 with the payout option); returned 25% with each of the first four payouts
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5% (the 200K size has 4% / 8% limits)
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the previous day's closing balance / 10% static
Minimum trading days	3 per phase
Funded split and payouts	bi-weekly 80% with 3 profitable days in the cycle; monthly 95% with 7; on-demand 80%
Consistency (funded)	best day at most 40% of the payout's profit
Risk (funded)	stop-loss on every trade; at most 2% risk per trade
Leverage	1:50 forex; 1:10 indices and metals
Per person	\$500,000
Copying	only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); copying from accounts at other prop firms prohibited
Prohibited	one-sided betting, grid trading, excessive margin use, hedging across accounts

18.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$599
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 3 trading days
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 3 trading days
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; fee returned in 4 equal parts with the first 4 payouts; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; best day at most 40% of a payout's profit; 3 profitable days of \$500+ per cycle; flat at weekends

Trades: gold (XAUUSD), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

18.3 The search

Searched: 315 grid settings (EURUSD, gold; 4,000 attempts each) and 84 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on gold within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
10	1	20%	\$4,980 $\pm$ \$211	35.0%	12.5		yes
10	1	25%	\$4,910 $\pm$ \$230	34.7%	12.2		yes
12	1	20%	\$4,794 $\pm$ \$207	35.0%	12.5		yes
30	1	25%	\$4,769 $\pm$ \$224	34.7%	12.6	bold	yes
12	1	25%	\$4,738 $\pm$ \$226	34.7%	12.3		yes
20	1	25%	\$4,703 $\pm$ \$225	34.4%	12.5		yes
15	1	25%	\$4,673 $\pm$ \$226	34.3%	12.3		yes
30	1	40%	\$4,888 $\pm$ \$255	34.8%	12.6	bold	no
50	1	40%	\$4,856 $\pm$ \$254	34.8%	12.6	bold	no
20	1	50%	\$4,777 $\pm$ \$257	34.8%	12.8	bold	no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

$k \setminus X$	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
4	-	3.78	-	-	-	-	-	-

k \ X	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
5	3.96	-	4.07	-	-	-	-	-
6	-	4.35	4.25	-	-	-	-	-
7	-	-	4.52	-	-	-	-	-
8	-	-	4.52	-	-	-	-	-
10	-	-	4.65	4.98	4.91	-	-	-
12	-	-	4.44	4.79	4.74	-	-	-
14	-	-	4.55	4.57	4.65	-	-	-
15	-	-	4.50	4.61	4.67	-	-	-
20	-	-	4.44	4.62	4.70	4.64	4.77	4.78
30	-	-	-	-	4.77	4.59	4.89	4.72
50	-	-	-	-	4.77	4.59	4.86	4.73

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 – 0.6) at the stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
1	33	10 / 20%	\$4,980 $\pm$ \$211	35.0%	12.5

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

18.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	k / m / X	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	10 / 1 / 20%	\$4,578 $\pm$ \$210	\$4,223 $\pm$ \$267	35.0%	\$6,954	12.2	\$1,836
Version 5 default	5 / 1 / 10%	\$3,735 $\pm$ \$140	\$3,472 $\pm$ \$191	33.5%	\$6,694	13.4	\$1,646
on EURUSD (taken by FundedNext in the plan)	14 / 0.75 / 20%	\$3,922 $\pm$ \$232	\$5,426 $\pm$ \$389	31.8%	\$5,820	9.7	\$1,250

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

18.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2838\% = 0.2838\%$ of the price; at 4,176.80 that is **11.9 dollars**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$528,477$; **\$126.53 per dollar**; at \$100.00 per dollar per standard lot, **1.27 lots** (round down).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$57.08$, i.e. $c/l = 3.81\%$; financing \$79 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$8,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 1.525\%$ away, **63.7 dollars**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1570$.

Mean $-c = -\$57.08$; variance $l(w + c) = 12,085,613$ (sd \$3,476); duration 5.37 h on average (losers 3.91 h, winners 13.2 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$15,000: take-profit 119 dollars away, $p = 0.0906$, winners 40 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:10: $N/10 = \$52,848 = 52.8\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.881$.

18.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Not a pure bold chain: $kl = \$15,000 < A + B$, so from deep below the start one win does not reach the target. The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$$P_1 = 0.5403, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.62, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$275$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 275)/18,000 = 0.5403$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.5556: \text{ cost lowers it by } 1.52\%.$$

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

$kl = \$15,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$57.08	\$5,000	0.2288	1.0000	0.2288	0.2288
2	-\$1,557	\$1,500	\$57.08	\$6,557	0.1849	0.7712	0.1426	0.3713
3	-\$3,114	\$1,500	\$57.08	\$8,114	0.1551	0.6287	0.0975	0.4688
4	-\$4,671	\$1,500	\$57.08	\$9,671	0.1336	0.5312	0.0710	0.5398
5	-\$6,228	\$1,500	\$57.08	\$11,228	0.1173	0.4602	0.0540	0.5938
6	-\$7,785	\$1,500	\$57.08	\$12,785	0.1046	0.4062	0.0425	0.6363
7	-\$9,342	\$558	\$21.21	\$14,342	0.0374	0.3637	0.0136	0.6499

Product formula $P_2 = 0.6499$; full chain 0.6512.

$P_2 = 0.6512$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.70$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \233
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 233)/15,000 = 0.6511$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$: cost lowers it by 1.55%.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.5403 \times 0.6512 = 0.3518$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.3501 ± 0.0060**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3583.

18.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split $\alpha = 80\%$.
One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.3020$.
Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.4327$; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,653.
Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 10,000 - 1,348 = \$8,652$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).
Cash: $\alpha \times 8,653 + R \cdot \text{Pr}(\text{refund}) = 0.8 \times 8,653 + 64 = \$6,987$ per funded account (chain); the refund term is \$64, the fee $R = \$599.00$ times the chance of reaching the payout that carries it.
Best-day rule (40%): each day's take-profit is capped at \$8,000 less what the day has made, so a cycle needs at least 3 profitable days; the chain applies it as a cap per win.
Profitable days per cycle (3 of \$500+): a daily target until they are complete (6.4); time, not value.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$6,954** per funded account (-0.5% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 11.9% of attempts reach a payout; median 25 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6980	\$0
1	0.2108	\$16,150
2	0.0637	\$32,300
3	0.0192	\$48,449
4	0.0058	\$64,599

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

18.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3518 \times 6,987 - 599.00 = \$1,859$ (chain); engine \$1,836.
Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 12.21$ days per attempt, so 2.49 attempts a month per slot and \$1,494 of fees a month before refunds.
Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 45% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 5.7 days on average; a passed one spends 10.2 days in the evaluation and then 14.1 days funded, making 0.52 payouts on average; 17.3 trades per attempt.
Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,836/12.21 = \$4,578 \pm \$210$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; \$4,223 ± \$267 on the real 2024–26 history.

18.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$599	\$599	\$4,578 ± \$210	\$4,578

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: \$500,000. **Copying:** only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); never from other firms.

The plan: 2 × 100K, worth \$9,156 a month (2 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: 2 × 100K, worth \$9,156 a month (2 accounts). A master and a copier on gold; more accounts would need more independent markets.

18.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
× 1	\$4,362 ± \$288	34.4%	12.1
× 1.5	\$4,043 ± \$284	33.2%	11.7
× 2	\$3,578 ± \$288	32.4%	11.1

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

18.11 How the plan meets every rule

- its own market, traded by no other account (so nothing is copied from another firm)
- two accounts: one master and one copier, the most Hola Prime allows to share trades
- take-profit capped at 40% of the cycle target per day; daily profit target until 3 profitable days

Sources: holaprime.com (2-Step Prime FAQ; prohibited trading practices); propfirmmap.com; thetrustedprop.com.

Alpha Capital Alpha Pro 10%

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting $k = 30$, $m = 0.5$, cycle 30% of the account; **\$6,372 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$363); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$12,757 a month.

19.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$497 for 100K; \$997 for 200K; refund policy reported inconsistently (assumed none)
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% (balance) / 10% static
Minimum trading days	3 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80%; bi-weekly from 14 days after the first funded trade (first request after 5 trading days); or on demand with a 40% best-day rule and 2% minimum
Risk	never risk or lose 2% or more on one trade or group of trades closed together
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:20 indices; 1:30 metals
Per person	\$400,000 per household; \$300,000 per strategy
Copying	from your own external accounts with proof of ownership

19.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$497
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 3 trading days
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 3 trading days
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; no fee refund; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; flat at weekends

Trades: Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

19.3 The search

Searched: 225 grid settings (Nasdaq; 4,000 attempts each) and 36 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on Nasdaq within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
30	0.5	30%	\$6,939 $\pm$ \$377	30.5%	8.0	bold	yes
20	0.5	30%	\$6,873 $\pm$ \$368	30.2%	7.9		yes
20	0.5	25%	\$6,851 $\pm$ \$334	30.6%	8.1		yes
30	0.5	25%	\$6,795 $\pm$ \$331	30.5%	8.3	bold	yes
14	0.5	30%	\$6,754 $\pm$ \$371	30.6%	7.9		yes
15	0.5	30%	\$6,739 $\pm$ \$370	30.8%	8.0		yes
14	0.5	25%	\$6,660 $\pm$ \$337	30.4%	8.0		yes
30	0.5	40%	\$6,962 $\pm$ \$426	30.7%	7.9	bold	no
50	0.5	40%	\$6,943 $\pm$ \$423	30.3%	7.9	bold	no
50	0.5	30%	\$6,863 $\pm$ \$372	30.6%	8.1	bold	no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

$k \setminus X$	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
6	-	5.22	-	-	-	-	-	-
7	-	-	5.60	-	-	-	-	-
10	-	5.59	6.09	-	-	-	-	-

k \ X	10%	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
12	5.34	5.80	6.08	6.60	6.64	6.50	-	-
14	-	-	-	6.34	6.66	6.75	-	-
15	-	-	5.99	6.28	6.44	6.74	-	-
16	-	-	-	6.45	6.53	6.56	-	-
20	-	-	6.21	6.62	6.85	6.87	6.32	6.28
30	-	-	-	-	6.80	6.94	6.96	6.65
50	-	-	-	-	6.59	6.86	6.94	6.40

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 –0.6) at the stop $m = 0.5$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
0.5	34	30 / 40%	\$6,962 $\pm$ \$426	30.7%	7.9
0.75	2	6 / 15%	\$5,465 $\pm$ \$213	31.1%	10.4

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

19.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	$k / m / X$	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	30 / 0.5 / 30%	\$6,372 $\pm$ \$363	\$7,445 $\pm$ \$602	30.7%	\$7,035	7.9	\$1,660
Best outside the plan's limits	30 / 0.5 / 40%	\$6,033 $\pm$ \$404	\$7,290 $\pm$ \$664	30.9%	\$6,582	7.8	\$1,536
Version 5 default	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$4,653 $\pm$ \$154	\$4,406 $\pm$ \$242	31.2%	\$7,145	11.3	\$1,730
on-demand payouts (40% best-day rule)	12 / 0.5 / 20%	\$5,910 $\pm$ \$310	\$6,700 $\pm$ \$505	30.9%	\$6,657	8.0	\$1,559

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

19.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.5 \times 0.2737\% = 0.1368\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **42.5 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$1,096,137$; **\$35.28 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot (platform specification), rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$70.15$, i.e. $c/l = 4.68\%$; financing \$164 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$10,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.919\%$ away, **285.4 points**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1296$.

Mean $-c = -\$70.15$; variance $l(w + c) = 15,105,229$ (sd \$3,887); duration 1.68 h on average (losers 1.20 h, winners 4.9 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$30,000: take-profit 852 points away, $p = 0.0475$, winners 37 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:20: $N/20 = \$54,807 = 54.8\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.457$.

19.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

$kl = \$45,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$10,000	0.1296	1.0000	0.1296	0.1296
2	-\$1,570	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$11,570	0.1142	0.8704	0.0994	0.2290
3	-\$3,140	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$13,140	0.1020	0.7710	0.0786	0.3076
4	-\$4,710	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$14,710	0.0921	0.6924	0.0638	0.3714
5	-\$6,281	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$16,281	0.0840	0.6286	0.0528	0.4242
6	-\$7,851	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$17,851	0.0772	0.5758	0.0445	0.4687
7	-\$9,421	\$479	\$22.41	\$19,421	0.0240	0.5313	0.0128	0.4815

Product formula $P_1 = 0.4815$; full chain 0.4831.

$P_1 = 0.4831$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.72$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \340
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 340)/20,000 = 0.4830$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$: cost lowers it by 1.69%.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

$k l = \$45,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$5,000	0.2283	1.0000	0.2283	0.2283
2	-\$1,570	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$6,570	0.1843	0.7717	0.1422	0.3705
3	-\$3,140	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$8,140	0.1545	0.6295	0.0972	0.4677
4	-\$4,710	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$9,710	0.1330	0.5323	0.0708	0.5385
5	-\$6,281	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$11,281	0.1167	0.4615	0.0539	0.5924
6	-\$7,851	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$12,851	0.1040	0.4076	0.0424	0.6348
7	-\$9,421	\$479	\$22.41	\$14,421	0.0321	0.3652	0.0117	0.6465

Product formula $P_2 = 0.6465$; full chain 0.6482.

$P_2 = 0.6482$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.57$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \278
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 278)/15,000 = 0.6481$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$: cost lowers it by 1.85%.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.4831 \times 0.6482 = 0.3131$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.3065 ± 0.0058**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3282.

19.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split $\alpha = 80\%$.
One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.2397$.
Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.3153$; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,459.
Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 10,000 - 544 = \$9,456$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).
Cash: $\alpha \times 9,459 = \$7,567$ per funded account (chain).
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,035** per funded account (-7.0% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 7.0% of attempts reach a payout; median 24 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7603	\$0
1	0.1823	\$24,000
2	0.0437	\$48,000
3	0.0105	\$72,000
4	0.0025	\$96,000

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

19.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3131 \times 7,567 - 497.00 = \$1,872$ (chain); engine \$1,660.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 7.93$ days per attempt, so 3.84 attempts a month per slot and \$1,908 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 51% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 4.0 days on average; a passed one spends 9.0 days in the evaluation and then 8.0 days funded, making 0.31 payouts on average; 12.3 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,660 / 7.93 = \$6,372 \pm \$363$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; \$7,445 $\pm$ \$602 on the real 2024–26 history.

19.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$497	\$497	\$6,372 $\pm$ \$363	\$6,372
200K	\$997	\$498	\$12,757 $\pm$ \$726	\$6,378

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: \$400,000 per household, \$300,000 per strategy. **Copying:** from your own external accounts with proof. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$12,757 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 $\times$ 200K; 1 $\times$ 100K, worth \$19,129 a month (2 accounts). One 200K (recommended); 200K + 100K reaches the \$300,000 strategy cap.

19.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
$\times 1$	\$6,654 $\pm$ \$510	30.9%	8.0
$\times 1.5$	\$5,516 $\pm$ \$489	29.7%	7.6
$\times 2$	\$5,960 $\pm$ \$551	28.3%	6.6

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

19.11 How the plan meets every rule

- Nasdaq, 1.5% risk (well below 2%)
- bi-weekly payouts (no best-day rule)
- one account in the recommended plan

Sources: alphacapitalgroup.uk; tradetanto.com; quantvps.com (Alpha payout rules); trustpilot.com (rating withheld).

FunderPro Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting $k = 30$, $m = 0.35$, cycle 30% of the account; **\$7,734 a month per 100K** ($\pm \$448$); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$15,903 a month.

20.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$539 for 100K list (often 20% off); \$989 for 200K; refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10% static
Minimum days	none
Funded split and payouts	80% bi-weekly
Consistency rule	none on Classic
Risk per trade	at most 2%
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:30 indices and metals
Per person	\$200,000
Copying	no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts; no copying from accounts you do not own

20.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$539
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; fee refunded with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; flat at weekends

Trades: Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

20.3 The search

Searched: 225 grid settings (Nasdaq; 4,000 attempts each) and 52 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on Nasdaq within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
30	0.35	30%	\$9,056 $\pm$ \$452	29.9%	6.3	bold	yes
30	0.35	25%	\$8,882 $\pm$ \$400	30.0%	6.6	bold	yes
15	0.35	25%	\$8,814 $\pm$ \$400	30.2%	6.5		yes
16	0.35	25%	\$8,782 $\pm$ \$394	30.3%	6.5		yes
15	0.35	30%	\$8,705 $\pm$ \$448	30.3%	6.3		yes
16	0.35	20%	\$8,627 $\pm$ \$333	30.6%	6.9		yes
20	0.35	25%	\$8,609 $\pm$ \$392	30.3%	6.5		yes
30	0.35	40%	\$9,226 $\pm$ \$539	30.1%	6.1	bold	no
30	0.35	50%	\$9,191 $\pm$ \$605	30.2%	6.1	bold	no
50	0.35	50%	\$9,036 $\pm$ \$605	30.1%	6.1	bold	no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

k \ X	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
12	7.69	7.89	8.11	8.35	-	-
14	-	8.10	8.15	8.07	-	-
15	-	8.40	8.81	8.70	-	-

$k \setminus X$	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
16	-	8.63	8.78	8.59	-	-
20	-	8.50	8.61	8.43	8.23	8.21
30	-	-	8.88	9.06	9.23	9.19
50	-	-	8.56	9.03	8.83	9.04

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 – 0.6) at the stop $m = 0.35$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
0.35	26	30 / 40%	\$9,226 $\pm$ \$539	30.1%	6.1
0.5	25	14 / 30%	\$8,510 $\pm$ \$417	31.3%	7.1
0.75	1	5 / 10%	\$5,026 $\pm$ \$165	30.5%	10.4

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

20.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	$k / m / X$	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	30 / 0.35 / 30%	\$7,734 $\pm$ \$448	\$6,555 $\pm$ \$648	30.1%	\$7,048	6.2	\$1,579
Best outside the plan's limits	30 / 0.35 / 40%	\$8,184 $\pm$ \$536	\$7,517 $\pm$ \$776	29.8%	\$7,222	6.0	\$1,611
Version 5 default	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$5,072 $\pm$ \$168	\$4,664 $\pm$ \$260	31.1%	\$7,429	10.6	\$1,770

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

20.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.35 \times 0.2737\% = 0.0958\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **29.8 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$1,565,910$; **\$50.40 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot (platform specification), rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$100.22$, i.e. $c/l = 6.68\%$; financing \$235 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$10,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.645\%$ away, **200.4 points**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1293$.

Mean $-c = -\$100.22$; variance $l(w + c) = 15,150,327$ (sd \$3,892); duration 0.82 h on average (losers 0.59 h, winners 2.4 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$30,000: take-profit 597 points away, $p = 0.0475$, winners 18 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:30: $N/30 = \$52,197 = 52.2\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.304$.

20.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

$kl = \$45,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$10,000	0.1293	1.0000	0.1293	0.1293
2	-\$1,600	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$11,600	0.1136	0.8707	0.0989	0.2282
3	-\$3,200	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$13,200	0.1013	0.7718	0.0782	0.3065
4	-\$4,801	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$14,801	0.0915	0.6935	0.0634	0.3699
5	-\$6,401	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$16,401	0.0833	0.6301	0.0525	0.4224
6	-\$8,001	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$18,001	0.0765	0.5776	0.0442	0.4666
7	-\$9,601	\$299	\$19.96	\$19,601	0.0150	0.5334	0.0080	0.4746

Product formula $P_1 = 0.4746$; full chain 0.4762.

$P_1 = 0.4762$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.73$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \479

Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 479)/20,000 = 0.4760$

Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$: cost lowers it by 2.38%.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$1,600 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

$kl = \$45,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$5,000	0.2273	1.0000	0.2273	0.2273
2	-\$1,600	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$6,600	0.1829	0.7727	0.1413	0.3686
3	-\$3,200	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$8,200	0.1531	0.6314	0.0966	0.4652
4	-\$4,801	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$9,801	0.1316	0.5348	0.0704	0.5356
5	-\$6,401	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$11,401	0.1154	0.4644	0.0536	0.5892
6	-\$8,001	\$1,500	\$100.22	\$13,001	0.1027	0.4108	0.0422	0.6314
7	-\$9,601	\$299	\$19.96	\$14,601	0.0200	0.3686	0.0074	0.6388

Product formula $P_2 = 0.6388$; full chain 0.6402.

$P_2 = 0.6402$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.62$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \398
Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 398)/15,000 = 0.6401$
Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$: cost lowers it by 2.64%.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$1,600 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.4762 \times 0.6402 = 0.3049$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.3005 ± 0.0058**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3260.

20.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split $\alpha = 80\%$.
One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.2357$.
Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.3084$; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,252.
Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 10,000 - 752 = \$9,248$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).
Cash: $\alpha \times 9,252 + R \cdot \text{Pr}(\text{refund}) = 0.8 \times 9,252 + 127 = \$7,529$ per funded account (chain); the refund term is \$127, the fee $R = \$539.00$ times the chance of reaching the payout that carries it.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,048** per funded account (-6.4% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 6.7% of attempts reach a payout; median 21 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7643	\$0
1	0.1801	\$24,539
2	0.0425	\$48,539
3	0.0100	\$72,539
4	0.0024	\$96,539

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

20.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3049 \times 7,529 - 539.00 = \$1,756$ (chain); engine \$1,579.
Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 6.22$ days per attempt, so 4.90 attempts a month per slot and \$2,640 of fees a month before refunds.
Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 53% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 3.2 days on average; a passed one spends 5.8 days in the evaluation and then 7.4 days funded, making 0.29 payouts on average; 11.5 trades per attempt.
Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,579/6.22 = \$7,734 \pm \$448$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; \$6,555 ± \$648 on the real 2024–26 history.

20.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$539	\$539	\$7,734 ± \$448	\$7,734
200K	\$989	\$494	\$15,903 ± \$889	\$7,952

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: \$200,000. **Copying:** no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts. **The plan:** 1 × 200K, worth \$15,903 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 × 200K, worth \$15,903 a month (1 accounts). One account, so the largest size.

20.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
× 1	\$7,657 ± \$639	29.7%	6.2
× 1.5	\$8,082 ± \$724	28.3%	5.1
× 2	\$7,785 ± \$742	26.9%	4.9

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

20.11 How the plan meets every rule

- one account at 200K (the cap), Nasdaq
- 1.5% risk, below the 2% limit

Sources: support.funderpro.com (leverage; consistency rule); tradelocker.com hub (prices); trustpilot.com (rating withheld).

Goat Funded Trader 2-Step Standard

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting $k = 8$, $m = 0.75$, cycle 8% of the account; **\$3,953 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$103); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$7,591 a month.

21.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$524 for 100K; \$974 for 200K; refundable
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10% static
Minimum trading days	3 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80% every 14 days; first payout needs 3% profit; the first two payouts at most 6% of the account or \$10,000; no open positions at a request
Daily profit cap (funded)	\$3,000 a day on 100K; profit above it is deducted
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	1:50 forex; 1:15 indices; 1:20 metals
Per person	\$400,000 funded
Copying	no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts

21.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$524
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 3 trading days
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 3 trading days
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; fee refunded with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$3,000; first payouts capped at \$6,000, \$6,000; profit above \$3,000 a day not counted; flat at weekends

Trades: Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

21.3 The search

Searched: 144 grid settings (Nasdaq; 4,000 attempts each) and 12 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on Nasdaq within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
8	0.75	8%	\$4,048 $\pm$ \$103	35.4%	15.6		yes
8	0.75	10%	\$4,037 $\pm$ \$111	35.3%	15.3		yes
7	0.75	8%	\$3,997 $\pm$ \$104	34.5%	15.2		yes
5	0.75	10%	\$3,983 $\pm$ \$113	34.7%	14.9	v5 default	yes
12	0.75	8%	\$3,946 $\pm$ \$103	34.9%	15.7		yes
5	0.75	12%	\$3,923 $\pm$ \$119	34.4%	14.6		yes
10	0.75	8%	\$3,916 $\pm$ \$104	35.3%	15.5		yes

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

k \ X	8%	10%	12%
3	-	3.72	-
5	-	3.98	3.92
7	4.00	-	-
8	4.05	4.04	-
10	3.92	-	-

k \ X		8%	10%	12%
12		3.95	-	-
15		3.77	-	-
20		3.77	-	-

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 –0.6) at the stop $m = 0.75$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
0.75	10	8 / 8%	\$4,048 $\pm$ \$103	35.4%	15.6
1	2	3 / 8%	\$3,771 $\pm$ \$100	34.7%	17.0

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

21.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	$k / m / X$	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	8 / 0.75 / 8%	\$3,953 $\pm$ \$103	\$3,608 $\pm$ \$162	35.0%	\$7,126	15.2	\$1,972
Version 5 default	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$3,982 $\pm$ \$112	\$3,604 $\pm$ \$170	34.1%	\$7,170	14.7	\$1,923

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

21.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.75 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2053\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **63.8 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$730,758$; **\$23.52 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot (platform specification), rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$46.77$, i.e. $c/l = 3.12\%$; financing \$110 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$8,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 1.101\%$ away, **342.1 points**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1571$.

Mean $-c = -\$46.77$; variance $l(w + c) = 12,070,153$ (sd \$3,474); duration 3.02 h on average (losers 2.20 h, winners 7.4 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$8,000: take-profit 342 points away, $p = 0.1571$, winners 7 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:15: $N/15 = \$48,717 = 48.7\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.609$.

21.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Not a pure bold chain: $kl = \$12,000 < A + B$, so from deep below the start one win does not reach the target. The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$$P_1 = 0.5415, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 6.27, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$255$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 255)/18,000 = 0.5414$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.5556: \text{ cost lowers it by } 1.41\%.$$

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day only \$160 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Not a pure bold chain: $kl = \$12,000 < A + B$, so from deep below the start one win does not reach the target. The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$$P_2 = 0.6535, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.85, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$198$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 198)/15,000 = 0.6535$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.6667: \text{ cost lowers it by } 1.32\%.$$

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day only \$160 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.5415 \times 0.6535 = 0.3538$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.3502 ± 0.0060**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3580.

21.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$6,000$, $X = \$8,000$ (the first payouts are capped at \$6,000, \$6,000, so the first cycles aim at the cap); split $\alpha = 80\%$.

One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.5847$, later cycles $q = 0.5090$.

Expected paid cycles $q_1 / (1 - q) = 1.2810$; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,395.

Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 10,000 - 1,607 = \$8,393$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).

Cash: $\alpha \times 8,395 + R \cdot \text{Pr}(\text{refund}) = 0.8 \times 8,395 + 306 = \$7,022$ per funded account (chain); the refund term is \$306, the fee $R = \$524.00$ times the chance of reaching the payout that carries it.

Daily profit cap \$3,000: each day's take-profit is capped at what is left of it.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,126** per funded account (1.5% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 20.6% of attempts reach a payout; median 24 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.4153	\$0
1	0.2428	\$5,324
2	0.1678	\$10,124
3	0.0854	\$16,524
4	0.0435	\$22,924

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

21.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3538 \times 7,022 - 524.00 = \$1,961$ (chain); engine \$1,972.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 15.18$ days per attempt, so 2.01 attempts a month per slot and \$1,051 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 46% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 4.6 days on average; a passed one spends 9.4 days in the evaluation and then 25.3 days funded, making 1.29 payouts on average; 22.4 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,972 / 15.18 = \$3,953 \pm \$103$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; \$3,608 ± \$162 on the real 2024–26 history.

21.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$524	\$524	\$3,953 ± \$103	\$3,953
200K	\$974	\$487	\$7,591 ± \$198	\$3,795

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: \$400,000 funded. **Copying:** no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts. **The plan:** 1 × 200K, worth \$7,591 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 × 200K, worth \$7,591 a month (1 accounts). One account, so the largest size.

21.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
× 1	\$3,877 ± \$145	34.9%	15.0
× 1.5	\$3,569 ± \$152	33.7%	14.1
× 2	\$3,326 ± \$148	33.6%	13.6

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

21.11 How the plan meets every rule

- one account, Nasdaq
- take-profit capped at the day's remaining profit cap

- first two cycles at 6%

Sources: help.goatfundedtrader.com (2-Step Standard); cryptoslate.com; tradelocker.com hub (prices); trustpilot.com (rating withheld).

BrightFunded 2-Step Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting $k = 12$, $m = 0.5$, cycle 25% of the account; **\$4,183 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$234); in the plan: $1 \times 100K$, \$4,183 a month.

22.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	€497 for 100K (about \$580); €997 for 200K; refund only with the paid refund add-on
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10% static
Minimum trading days	5 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80%; first payout about 30 days after funding, then every 14 days
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:20 indices; 1:40 gold
Per person	\$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited
Copying	allowed between your own accounts at any firm; trades must last at least 60 seconds

22.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$580
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 5 trading days
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 5 trading days
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; no fee refund; first payout 30 days after funding, then every 14 days; flat at weekends

Trades: Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

22.3 The search

Searched: 225 grid settings (Nasdaq; 4,000 attempts each) and 36 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on Nasdaq within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
12	0.5	25%	\$5,058 $\pm$ \$244	30.9%	11.1		yes
12	0.5	30%	\$5,000 $\pm$ \$263	31.6%	10.8		yes
16	0.5	25%	\$4,975 $\pm$ \$245	30.5%	10.9		yes
16	0.5	30%	\$4,927 $\pm$ \$270	30.6%	10.6		yes
15	0.5	25%	\$4,867 $\pm$ \$241	30.8%	11.0		yes
15	0.5	30%	\$4,850 $\pm$ \$265	30.6%	10.6		yes
20	0.5	30%	\$4,821 $\pm$ \$267	30.6%	10.6		yes
50	0.5	40%	\$5,034 $\pm$ \$313	30.8%	10.4	bold	no
50	0.5	50%	\$5,004 $\pm$ \$352	30.9%	10.2	bold	no
50	0.5	30%	\$4,932 $\pm$ \$266	30.8%	10.9	bold	no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

$k \setminus X$	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
7	-	4.11	-	-	-	-	-
8	3.84	4.11	-	-	-	-	-
10	-	4.40	-	-	-	-	-
12	-	4.19	4.58	5.06	5.00	-	-

k \ X	12%	15%	20%	25%	30%	40%	50%
14	.	.	4.59	4.71	4.78	.	.
15	.	4.21	4.57	4.87	4.85	.	.
16	.	.	4.53	4.98	4.93	.	.
20	.	4.30	4.67	4.64	4.82	4.67	4.71
30	.	.	.	4.81	4.79	4.91	4.81
50	.	.	.	4.72	4.93	5.03	5.00

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 –0.6) at the stop $m = 0.5$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
0.5	32	12 / 25%	\$5,058 $\pm$ \$244	30.9%	11.1
0.75	4	6 / 15%	\$3,815 $\pm$ \$158	31.1%	13.6

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

22.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	$k / m / X$	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	12 / 0.5 / 25%	\$4,183 $\pm$ \$234	\$4,879 $\pm$ \$374	31.5%	\$6,519	10.7	\$1,475
Version 5 default	5 / 0.75 / 10%	\$3,382 $\pm$ \$121	\$3,521 $\pm$ \$186	31.3%	\$7,249	15.2	\$1,688

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

22.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.5 \times 0.2737\% = 0.1368\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **42.5 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$1,096,137$; **\$35.28 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot (platform specification), rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$70.15$, i.e. $c/l = 4.68\%$; financing \$164 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$10,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.919\%$ away, **285.4 points**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1296$.

Mean $-c = -\$70.15$; variance $l(w + c) = 15,105,229$ (sd \$3,887); duration 1.68 h on average (losers 1.20 h, winners 4.9 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$18,000: take-profit 512 points away, $p = 0.0766$, winners 14 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:20: $N/20 = \$54,807 = 54.8\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.457$.

22.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Not a pure bold chain: $kl = \$18,000 < A + B$, so from deep below the start one win does not reach the target. The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$$P_1 = 0.4828, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.84, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$345$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 345)/20,000 = 0.4827$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.5000: \text{ cost lowers it by } 1.72\%.$$

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

$kl = \$18,000 \geq A + B$: every win ends the phase. The bold chain (5.6):

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$5,000	0.2283	1.0000	0.2283	0.2283
2	-\$1,570	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$6,570	0.1843	0.7717	0.1422	0.3705
3	-\$3,140	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$8,140	0.1545	0.6295	0.0972	0.4677
4	-\$4,710	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$9,710	0.1330	0.5323	0.0708	0.5385

Trade j	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win $A - x_j$	p_j	Still trading	Passes on this trade	Passed so far
5	-\$6,281	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$11,281	0.1167	0.4615	0.0539	0.5924
6	-\$7,851	\$1,500	\$70.15	\$12,851	0.1040	0.4076	0.0424	0.6348
7	-\$9,421	\$479	\$22.41	\$14,421	0.0321	0.3652	0.0117	0.6465

Product formula $P_2 = 0.6465$; full chain 0.6478.

$P_2 = 0.6478$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.68$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \284

Identity: $(B - K)/(A + B) = (10,000 - 284)/15,000 = 0.6477$

Zero-cost value $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$: cost lowers it by 1.89%.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 3 full losses in one day the plan stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.4828 \times 0.6478 = 0.3127$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.3152 ± 0.0059**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3205.

22.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$25,000$; split $\alpha = 80\%$.

One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.2662$.

Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.3628$; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,071.

Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 10,000 - 932 = \$9,068$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).

Cash: $\alpha \times 9,071 = \$7,257$ per funded account (chain).

Engine, fresh paths: **\$6,519** per funded account (-10.2% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 7.6% of attempts reach a payout; median 44 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7338	\$0
1	0.1954	\$20,000
2	0.0520	\$40,000
3	0.0138	\$60,000
4	0.0037	\$80,000

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

22.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3127 \times 7,257 - 580.00 = \$1,689$ (chain); engine \$1,475.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 10.74$ days per attempt, so 2.84 attempts a month per slot and \$1,645 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 51% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 4.2 days on average; a passed one spends 12.9 days in the evaluation and then 12.7 days funded, making 0.35 payouts on average; 13.6 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,475/10.74 = \$4,183 \pm \$234$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; \$4,879 ± \$374 on the real 2024–26 history.

22.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$580	\$580	\$4,183 ± \$234	\$4,183
200K	\$1,163	\$582	\$8,297 ± \$468	\$4,149

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: \$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited. **Copying:** allowed between your own accounts. **The plan:** 1 × 100K, worth \$4,183 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 4 × 100K, worth \$16,731 a month (4 accounts). One account (recommended, tier D) or four.

22.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
× 1	\$4,458 ± \$338	30.9%	10.8
× 1.5	\$3,847 ± \$335	29.1%	10.2
× 2	\$3,765 ± \$355	27.9%	9.2

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

22.11 How the plan meets every rule

- one account, Nasdaq
- trades last hours, far above 60 seconds

Sources: tradetanto.com; proptradingvibes.com (BrightFunded leverage); help.brightfunded.com (refund); trustpilot.com (rating withheld).

Blue Guardian 2-Step Standard

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting $k = 8$, $m = 1$, cycle 18% of the account; **\$2,810 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$169); in the plan: $1 \times 100K$, \$2,810 a month.

23.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$579 for 100K list (often half price with a code); \$1,162 for 200K; refunded after the fourth payout
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 4%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% / 8% static
Minimum days	3 profitable days per phase
Funded split and payouts	85% every 14 days
Guardian Shield (funded)	all trades closed at a 2% open loss; first time the split falls to 50%, second time the account closes
Leverage	1:10 on indices
Per person	\$400,000; evaluations up to \$200,000 each
Copying	your own accounts only

23.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$579
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500
Phase 2	target \$4,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500
Funded account	maximum loss \$8,000, static; daily loss \$4,000; split 85%; fee refunded with payout number 4; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; flat at weekends

Trades: Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

23.3 The search

Searched: 81 grid settings (Nasdaq; 4,000 attempts each) and 14 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on Nasdaq within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
8	1	18%	\$3,226 $\pm$ \$174	31.0%	13.6		yes
10	1	18%	\$3,219 $\pm$ \$173	30.6%	13.7		yes
10	1	13%	\$3,155 $\pm$ \$154	30.7%	14.0		yes
6	1	18%	\$3,148 $\pm$ \$176	30.5%	13.4		yes
6	1	13%	\$3,141 $\pm$ \$156	30.7%	13.8		yes
8	1	13%	\$3,096 $\pm$ \$151	30.6%	13.9		yes
6	1	8%	\$3,014 $\pm$ \$119	30.9%	15.1		yes

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

$k \setminus X$	6%	8%	13%	18%
4	-	2.77	-	-
5	2.62	2.90	-	-
6	2.73	3.01	3.14	3.15
8	-	2.87	3.10	3.23
10	2.56	2.77	3.16	3.22

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 – 0.6) at the stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
1	14	8 / 18%	\$3,226 ± \$174	31.0%	13.6

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

23.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	k / m / X	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	8 / 1 / 18%	\$2,810 ± \$169	\$2,397 ± \$256	29.9%	\$6,016	13.2	\$1,220
Version 5 default	5 / 1 / 8%	\$2,761 ± \$120	\$2,272 ± \$188	30.1%	\$6,346	14.7	\$1,330

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. ± is a 95% interval.

23.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$548,068$; **\$17.64 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot (platform specification), rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$35.08$, i.e. $c/l = 2.34\%$; financing \$82 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$8,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 1.466\%$ away, **455.5 points**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1573$.

Mean $-c = -\$35.08$; variance $l(w + c) = 12,052,615$ (sd \$3,472); duration 5.36 h on average (losers 3.90 h, winners 13.1 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$12,000: take-profit 682 points away, $p = 0.1108$, winners 27 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:10: $N/10 = \$54,807 = 54.8\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.913$.

23.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Not a pure bold chain: the phase needs 3 profitable days, so the plan aims at a daily target and wins are smaller (6.4); the chain below ignores that rule, which changes time, not the average (11.1); $kl = \$12,000 < A + B$, so from deep below the start one win does not reach the target. The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$$P_1 = 0.4903, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.47, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$155$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (8,000 - 155)/16,000 = 0.4903$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.5000: \text{ cost lowers it by } 0.97\%.$$

Daily loss limit \$4,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$730 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$4,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Not a pure bold chain: the phase needs 3 profitable days, so the plan aims at a daily target and wins are smaller (6.4); the chain below ignores that rule, which changes time, not the average (11.1). The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$$P_2 = 0.6569, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.06, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$118$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (8,000 - 118)/12,000 = 0.6569$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.6667: \text{ cost lowers it by } 0.98\%.$$

Daily loss limit \$4,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$730 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.4903 \times 0.6569 = 0.3221$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.2991 ± 0.0058**; the Brownian formula gives 0.3256.

23.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$8,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$18,000$; split $\alpha = 85\%$.

One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.2962$.

Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1-q) = 0.4209$; expected withdrawn before the split $\$7,577$.

Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 8,000 - 424 = \$7,576$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).

Cash: $\alpha \times 7,577 + R \cdot \text{Pr}(\text{refund}) = 0.85 \times 7,577 + 4 = \$6,445$ per funded account (chain); the refund term is \$4, the fee $R = \$579.00$ times the chance of reaching the payout that carries it.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$6,016** per funded account (-6.7% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 9.2% of attempts reach a payout; median 29 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7038	\$0
1	0.2085	\$15,300
2	0.0618	\$30,600
3	0.0183	\$45,900
4	0.0054	\$61,779

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

23.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.3221 \times 6,445 - 579.00 = \$1,497$ (chain); engine \$1,220.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 13.22$ days per attempt, so 2.30 attempts a month per slot and \$1,333 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 52% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 7.5 days on average; a passed one spends 14.5 days in the evaluation and then 12.5 days funded, making 0.47 payouts on average; 20.3 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,220/13.22 = \$2,810 \pm \$169$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; $\$2,397 \pm \256 on the real 2024–26 history.

23.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$579	\$579	\$2,810 $\pm$ \$169	\$2,810
200K	\$1,162	\$581	\$5,669 $\pm$ \$344	\$2,834

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: \$400,000; evaluations up to \$200,000 each. **Copying:** your own accounts only. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 100K, worth \$2,810 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 4 $\times$ 100K, worth \$11,239 a month (4 accounts). One account (recommended, tier D) or four.

23.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
$\times 1$	\$3,072 $\pm$ \$250	30.4%	13.5
$\times 1.5$	\$2,829 $\pm$ \$247	28.8%	13.1
$\times 2$	\$2,496 $\pm$ \$254	27.6%	12.7

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

23.11 How the plan meets every rule

- one account, Nasdaq with the stop widened to fit 1:10
- 1.5% risk: a stop-out stays below the 2% shield unless the price gaps

Sources: help.blueguardian.com (2 Step Standard rules); propfirmbridge.com; trustpilot.com (rating withheld).

Maven 2-Step

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting $k = 7$, $m = 1$, cycle 8% of the account; **\$2,341 a month per 100K** ($\pm \$105$); in the plan: $1 \times 100K$, \$2,341 a month.

24.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$440 for 100K (largest 2-Step size); refunded with the third payout
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% (from the higher of balance or equity) / 8% static
Profitable days	3 per phase, each at least +0.5%
Funded split and payouts	80%, about every 10 business days; at most \$10,000 of payouts per 30 days per person; after \$5,000 paid, no day above 50% of a payout's profit
Leverage	1:75 forex; 1:20 indices and commodities
Per person	\$200,000

24.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$440
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500
Funded account	maximum loss \$8,000, static; daily loss \$4,000; split 80%; fee refunded with payout number 3; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; best day at most 50% of a payout's profit; flat at weekends

Trades: Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100), entries 01:00–20:00 UTC on weekdays, risk 1.5% of the account (\$1,500 per 100K), every rule of 5.5 and 6.2–6.6.

24.3 The search

Searched: 135 grid settings (Nasdaq; 4,000 attempts each) and 25 refined settings (24,000 attempts each). The seven best refined settings on Nasdaq within the plan's limits (stop at least 0.35, cycle at most 30%, k at most 30), then the three best outside them:

k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Stage	Within limits
7	1	8%	\$2,538 $\pm$ \$105	28.2%	15.3		yes
4	1	8%	\$2,491 $\pm$ \$108	27.8%	14.7		yes
5	1	8%	\$2,488 $\pm$ \$103	28.3%	15.0		yes
7	0.85	8%	\$2,484 $\pm$ \$107	27.9%	14.4		yes
3	1	8%	\$2,462 $\pm$ \$108	27.7%	14.6		yes
6	1	8%	\$2,444 $\pm$ \$106	28.2%	15.0		yes
9	1	8%	\$2,424 $\pm$ \$101	28.3%	15.3		yes
7	1	18%	\$3,038 $\pm$ \$164	28.3%	13.4		no
11	1	18%	\$3,012 $\pm$ \$157	28.9%	13.9		no
11	0.85	18%	\$2,993 $\pm$ \$168	27.4%	12.8		no

Stage: blank = grid or edge setting, "bold" = bold-play round, "v5 default" = version 5's setting. These are refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so they are biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below.

k \ X	8%	13%	18%
3	2.46	-	-
4	2.49	-	-
5	2.49	-	-
6	2.44	-	-
7	2.54	2.71	3.04
9	2.42	2.53	2.96

k \ X	8%	13%	18%
11	2.36	2.75	3.01

Refined value per month (\$ thousands, 24,000 attempts on paths 25–28, ± 0.2 –0.6) at the stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and cycle target X as a share of the account (columns). Darker is more. The outlined cell is the plan's setting. Dots: not tried at this stop.

Stop m	Settings refined	Best k / X	Best EV/month	Pass rate	Days
0.5	1	8 / 8%	\$2,199 $\pm$ \$112	25.6%	12.6
0.75	2	10 / 8%	\$2,410 $\pm$ \$109	27.4%	13.9
0.85	9	11 / 18%	\$2,993 $\pm$ \$168	27.4%	12.8
1	13	7 / 18%	\$3,038 $\pm$ \$164	28.3%	13.4

The best refined setting at each stop. A tighter stop is faster (8.2) and dearer per trade (4.4); where the firm's leverage allows, the gain from speed wins down to the plan's limit of 0.35.

24.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	$k / m / X$	EV/month, fresh paths	EV/month, real history	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	7 / 1 / 8%	\$2,341 $\pm$ \$105	\$2,015 $\pm$ \$160	27.5%	\$5,749	14.8	\$1,139
Best outside the plan's limits	7 / 1 / 18%	\$2,738 $\pm$ \$158	\$1,802 $\pm$ \$224	28.0%	\$5,779	13.1	\$1,178
Version 5 default	5 / 0.75 / 8%	\$2,335 $\pm$ \$111	\$2,649 $\pm$ \$185	26.9%	\$5,477	13.5	\$1,032

One 100K account. Fresh paths: 24,000 attempts on paths 29–32 (33–36 for re-chosen settings); real history: 8,000 attempts on the 2024–26 hourly prices. $\pm$ is a 95% interval.

24.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$548,068$; **\$17.64 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot (platform specification), rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$35.08$, i.e. $c/l = 2.34\%$; financing \$82 per night held.

First trade of phase 1: the win is $w = \min(kl, A_1) = \$8,000$; the take-profit sits $u = s(w + c)/l = 1.466\%$ away, **455.5 points**; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.1573$.

Mean $-c = -\$35.08$; variance $l(w + c) = 12,052,615$ (sd \$3,472); duration 5.36 h on average (losers 3.90 h, winners 13.1 h of open market).

A funded-cycle win of \$8,000: take-profit 456 points away, $p = 0.1573$, winners 13 h on average, so usually held through nights.

Margin at 1:20: $N/20 = \$27,403 = 27.4\%$ of the balance; the smallest stop the leverage allows at the plan's 60% limit is $m_{\min} = 0.457$.

24.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Not a pure bold chain: the phase needs 3 profitable days, so the plan aims at a daily target and wins are smaller (6.4); the chain below ignores that rule, which changes time, not the average (11.1); $kl = \$10,500 < A + B$, so from deep below the start one win does not reach the target. The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$$P_1 = 0.4894, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 5.89, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$169$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (8,000 - 169)/16,000 = 0.4894$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.5000: \text{cost lowers it by } 1.06\%.$$

Daily loss limit \$4,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$730 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Not a pure bold chain: the phase needs 3 profitable days, so the plan aims at a daily target and wins are smaller (6.4); the chain below ignores that rule, which changes time, not the average (11.1); $kl = \$10,500 < A + B$, so from deep below the start one win does not reach the target. The chain of 5.6 is solved numerically:

$$P_2 = 0.6054, \mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 4.55, \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}] = K = \$130$$

$$\text{Identity: } (B - K)/(A + B) = (8,000 - 130)/13,000 = 0.6054$$

$$\text{Zero-cost value } B/(A + B) = 0.6154: \text{cost lowers it by } 1.00\%.$$

Daily loss limit \$4,000: the plan's risk never exceeds today's room less \$200, so a stop-out cannot break it; after 2 full losses in one day only \$730 of risk is left for the day, so the plan takes one smaller trade and then stops until tomorrow. Only a price gap through the stop can break it, which the engine models.

Both phases: $P = 0.4894 \times 0.6054 = 0.2963$ (chain). Engine on fresh paths: **0.2747 ± 0.0056**; the Brownian formula gives 0.2989.

24.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$8,000$; cycle targets $X_1 = \$8,000$; split $\alpha = 80\%$.

One cycle (the chain from 0 to the cycle target before $-D$): $q_1 = 0.4761$.

Expected paid cycles $q_1/(1 - q) = 0.9087$; expected withdrawn before the split \$7,269.

Withdrawal identity: $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] = 8,000 - 732 = \$7,268$ (equal to the withdrawn amount to within the grid's precision: the identity holds).

Cash: $\alpha \times 7,269 + R \cdot \text{Pr}(\text{refund}) = 0.8 \times 7,269 + 47 = \$5,863$ per funded account (chain); the refund term is \$47, the fee $R = \$440.00$ times the chance of reaching the payout that carries it.

Best-day rule (50%): each day's take-profit is capped at \$4,000 less what the day has made, so a cycle needs at least 2 profitable days; the chain applies it as a cap per win.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$5,749** per funded account (-1.9% against the chain: financing, gaps, weekend closes); 13.4% of attempts reach a payout; median 29 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.5239	\$0
1	0.2494	\$6,400
2	0.1187	\$12,800
3	0.0565	\$19,640
4	0.0269	\$26,040

Chain values, before financing. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: most pay nothing, a few pay one or more full cycles.

24.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt (1.2): $\mathbb{E}[V] = P \mathbb{E}[C] - F = 0.2963 \times 5,863 - 440.00 = \$1,297$ (chain); engine \$1,139.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 14.82$ days per attempt, so 2.05 attempts a month per slot and \$904 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (engine, 6,000 attempts on path 29): 51% of attempts fail in phase 1; a failed attempt lasts 7.7 days on average; a passed one spends 14.5 days in the evaluation and then 19.6 days funded, making 0.95 payouts on average; 22.5 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,139/14.82 = \$2,341 \pm \$105$ (95%) per 100K account on fresh paths; \$2,015 ± \$160 on the real 2024–26 history.

24.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$440	\$440	\$2,341 ± \$105	\$2,341

Every size uses the plan's setting scaled to the account (risk, targets and cycle all in proportion), on the same paths and random numbers, so the differences are the fee and the rules that do not scale.

Per person: \$200,000; payouts at most \$10,000 per 30 days per person. **Copying:** –. **The plan:** $1 \times 100K$, worth \$2,341 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: $1 \times 100K$, worth \$2,341 a month (1 accounts). The payout cap binds before the account cap.

24.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
× 1	\$2,337 ± \$148	27.5%	14.8
× 1.5	\$2,264 ± \$146	26.8%	14.6
× 2	\$2,065 ± \$147	25.4%	14.1

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage) and every night's financing multiplied, 12,000 attempts on fresh paths.

24.11 How the plan meets every rule

- one 100K account, Nasdaq
- daily take-profit capped at 50% of the cycle target
- cycles of 8% or less, inside the \$10,000 per 30 days cap

Sources: propfirmsradar.com; thepropfirmguide.com; lunefi.com (Maven rules); trustpilot.com (rating withheld).

Topstep 50K Trading Combine (futures, optional)

Micro Nasdaq futures, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts. Futures firms set no percentage risk rule, so the search covers the risk per trade as well: $k \in \{2, \dots, 8\}$, $m \in \{0.5, 0.75, 1\}$, risk \$600–\$1,100 (72 grid settings, then the eight best refined).

25.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$49 a month (Standard path); a reset after a breach \$49; \$149 activation per Express Funded Account
Target / maximum loss	\$3,000 / \$2,000 trailing at the end of each day, locking at the start balance
Consistency (Combine)	best day at most 55% of the profit target (the model uses 50%)
Funded payouts	after 5 winning days of \$150+; at most 50% of the balance and \$2,000 a request; 90%
Per person	up to 5 Express Funded Accounts at once
Trading hours	flat by the daily close (the plan: by 20:00 UTC)

25.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$49 a month (renewed while the evaluation lasts); activation \$149 on passing
Evaluation	target \$3,000; maximum loss \$2,000 below the start, trailing the best end-of-day balance; no daily loss limit; at least 2 trading days; best day at most 50% of the profit
Funded account	maximum loss \$2,000, trailing the best end-of-day balance; no daily loss limit; split 90%; no fee refund; a payout needs 5 qualifying days of at least \$150; first payouts capped at \$2,000, \$2,000; a payout at most 50% of the balance; weekend holding allowed
Trading hours	flat by 20:00 UTC every day

25.3 The search

k	m	Risk	Refined EV/month	Pass rate	Days
5	0.5	\$950	\$1,307 ± \$384	23.0%	3.2
4	0.75	\$1,100	\$1,187 ± \$292	22.9%	3.5
6	0.75	\$1,100	\$1,146 ± \$368	22.8%	3.8
6	0.75	\$950	\$1,116 ± \$246	24.2%	3.8
5	0.75	\$950	\$1,073 ± \$243	24.1%	3.5
5	0.75	\$1,100	\$991 ± \$290	23.0%	3.5
5	0.5	\$800	\$839 ± \$282	23.9%	3.1
8	1	\$950	\$799 ± \$189	23.9%	4.9

25.4 The chosen setting

Plan: $k = 5$, $m = 0.5$, risk \$950: stop 42.5 points, \$22 per point = 11.2 MNQ contracts at \$2 per point (round down).

Fresh paths: **\$832 ± \$280** a month per account (pass rate 23.8%, 2.9 days per attempt); real history \$1,477 ± \$400. Version 5's setting (5 / 0.75 / \$950): \$1,220 ± \$295.

Why so little: the funded account's maximum loss trails the balance until it locks, payouts are capped per request and (Apex) in number, and the evaluation fee recurs monthly (Topstep) or is only worth paying at a deep discount (Apex). The withdrawal identity of 7.1 still holds, but the allowance it pays out is small: \$2,000 of trailing loss on a \$50,000 account.

25.5 How many

5 Express Funded Accounts at once: 5 accounts, worth \$4,159 a month together. The intervals are wide (the funded stage is short and lumpy), and the real-history figure differs from the synthetic one by more than for the CFD programmes. This layer is optional and is not in the recommended plan's headline figure.

25.6 How the plan meets every rule

- micro Nasdaq futures, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts

- risk and k searched (no percentage rule applies)

Sources: [help.topstep.com](https://help.topstep.com/pricing) (pricing); protradingvibes.com (Combine rules, Sep 2026).

Apex 4.0 50K EOD (futures, optional)

Micro Nasdaq futures, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts. Futures firms set no percentage risk rule, so the search covers the risk per trade as well: $k \in \{2, \dots, 8\}$, $m \in \{0.5, 0.75, 1\}$, risk \$600–\$1,100 (72 grid settings, then the eight best refined).

26.1 The rules

Rule	As published (checked 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$550 list; public 80–90% codes most of 2026 (about \$55); \$99 activation when passed
Target / maximum loss	\$3,000 / \$2,000 trailing end of day; \$1,000 daily loss limit; evaluations expire after 30 days
Funded payouts	100% split; 5 qualifying days per request; best day under 50%; \$500 minimum; at most 6 payouts, then the account closes; safety net of drawdown + \$100
Per person	up to 20 funded accounts; copying between your own accounts allowed
Trading hours	flat by 4:59 pm ET every session

26.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$55; activation \$99 on passing
Evaluation	target \$3,000; maximum loss \$2,000 below the start, trailing the best end-of-day balance; daily loss \$1,000; at least 1 trading days
Funded account	maximum loss \$2,000, trailing the best end-of-day balance; daily loss \$1,000; split 100%; no fee refund; a payout needs 5 qualifying days of at least \$250; minimum payout \$500; first payouts capped at \$1,500, \$1,500; best day at most 50% of a payout's profit; at most 6 payouts; buffer \$2,100 kept in the account; weekend holding allowed
Trading hours	flat by 20:00 UTC every day

26.3 The search

k	m	Risk	Refined EV/month	Pass rate	Days
2	0.5	\$600	\$537 ± \$50	34.4%	7.0
2	0.75	\$600	\$517 ± \$48	34.7%	7.4
2	0.75	\$950	\$496 ± \$44	36.3%	7.8
2	1	\$1,100	\$477 ± \$41	37.2%	8.5
2	0.75	\$800	\$454 ± \$45	36.0%	7.5
2	1	\$950	\$445 ± \$43	36.3%	8.2
2	0.5	\$1,100	\$444 ± \$46	35.8%	7.1
2	0.5	\$950	\$410 ± \$46	36.0%	7.0

26.4 The chosen setting

Plan: $k = 2$, $m = 0.5$, risk \$600: stop 42.5 points, \$14 per point = 7.1 MNQ contracts at \$2 per point (round down).

Fresh paths: **\$594 ± \$51** a month per account (pass rate 35.0%, 7.1 days per attempt); real history \$378 ± \$72.

Why so little: the funded account's maximum loss trails the balance until it locks, payouts are capped per request and (Apex) in number, and the evaluation fee recurs monthly (Topstep) or is only worth paying at a deep discount (Apex). The withdrawal identity of 7.1 still holds, but the allowance it pays out is small: \$2,000 of trailing loss on a \$50,000 account.

26.5 How many

20 funded accounts: 20 accounts, worth \$11,873 a month together. The intervals are wide (the funded stage is short and lumpy), and the real-history figure differs from the synthetic one by more than for the CFD programmes. This layer is optional and is not in the recommended plan's headline figure.

26.6 How the plan meets every rule

- micro Nasdaq futures, shared direction
- only at 80–90% off: at the list price the value is negative

Sources: phidiaspropfirm.com (Apex 4.0); apextraderfunding.com help centre; propfirmmap.com (Apex).

One person, many accounts

Part II valued one account at a time. This part adds them up for one person: how much each firm allows, how to fill it (four 100K accounts or two 200K), how accounts at different firms move together, what happens if payouts can be refused, how much cash it takes, and the routine that runs it.

The maximum allocation per person

Every firm limits how much simulated capital one person may hold, and many limit how many of their accounts may carry the same trades. Those two rules, firm by firm, decide how many accounts the plan can run.

27.1 Firm by firm

Firm (tier)	Per-person limit	Copying between accounts	Market	Recommended	EV/month		Full allowance	EV/month
FTMO (A)	\$400,000 per trader across all accounts, evaluations included	your own accounts, within the cap	Nasdaq	4×100K	\$21,852		4×100K	\$21,852
FundingPips (A)	\$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts	your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services	USDJPY	4×100K	\$22,866		4×100K	\$22,866
The5ers (A)	one 100K (or 50K) High Stakes account, plus 1 × 25K, 3 × 10K, 3 × 5K, 3 × 2.5K	your own accounts	Nasdaq	1×100K	\$4,775	1×100K, 1×25K, 3×10K, 3×5K, 3×2.5K		\$7,691
FXIFY (A)	one active account of each size (\$805,000 in all)	between your own FXIFY accounts; Pro may not receive copied trades	Nasdaq	1×100K, 1×50K, 1×25K, 1×10K, 1×5K	\$7,096	1×100K, 1×50K, 1×25K, 1×10K, 1×5K		\$7,096
FundedNext (A)	\$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited	between your own challenge accounts, never into a funded account	EURUSD	1×200K	\$7,679		1×200K	\$7,679
Fintokei (B)	€500,000 of accounts	your own trades across your own accounts	Nasdaq	5×100K	\$20,361		5×100K	\$20,361
Hola Prime (B)	\$500,000	only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); never from other firms	gold	2×100K	\$9,156		2×100K	\$9,156
Alpha Capital (D)	\$400,000 per household, \$300,000 per strategy	from your own external accounts with proof	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$12,757		1×200K, 1×100K	\$19,129
FunderPro (D)	\$200,000	no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$15,903		1×200K	\$15,903
GFT (D)	\$400,000 funded	no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$7,591		1×200K	\$7,591
BrightFunded (D)	\$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited	allowed between your own accounts	Nasdaq	1×100K	\$4,183		4×100K	\$16,731
Blue Guardian (D)	\$400,000; evaluations up to \$200,000 each	your own accounts only	Nasdaq	1×100K	\$2,810		4×100K	\$11,239
Maven (D)	\$200,000; payouts at most \$10,000 per 30 days per person	–	Nasdaq	1×100K	\$2,341		1×100K	\$2,341
Topstep (A)	5 Express Funded Accounts at once	your own accounts	MNQ	–	–		5×50K	\$4,159
Apex (B)	20 funded accounts	your own accounts	MNQ	–	–		20×50K	\$11,873
Total, CFD firms					\$139,369			\$169,635

EV per month: the sum of each account's value from its programme chapter (renewal–reward, fresh paths). The portfolio simulation of Chapter 28 gives the same totals within its noise. Futures (Topstep, Apex) are an optional layer and are not in either total.

27.2 Four 100K accounts or two 200K?

At a firm whose cap is \$400,000, the cap can be filled with four 100K accounts, two 200K accounts, or a mix. Scale every dollar amount of a programme by a factor λ (account, targets, limits, risk, cycle target) and every formula of Part I scales with it: the pass probabilities (ratios of distances) are unchanged, the funded cash scales by λ , the cost per trade scales by λ (it is a fraction of the notional, which scales by λ), and the time is unchanged (it depends on ratios of distances and on m). Only the fee may not scale. Hence

SCALING AN ACCOUNT

$$\mathbb{E}[V](\lambda S) = \lambda (\Pr(\text{pass}) \mathbb{E}[C](S)) - F(\lambda S), \quad \mathbb{E}[T](\lambda S) = \mathbb{E}[T](S).$$

Two 200K accounts and four 100K accounts have the same value per month if and only if the 200K fee is exactly twice the 100K fee. Where it is cheaper per dollar, 200K is better by the saving times the attempts per month; where dearer, 100K is better. Beyond the fee, five differences decide:

1. **Rules by size.** Some programmes change at 200K (Hola Prime's daily and maximum loss fall to 4% and 8%) or stop at 100K (FundingPips Flex, The5ers High Stakes, FXIFY Classic, Maven).
2. **One account allowed.** Where the copying rules allow only one account (FunderPro, GFT, FundedNext's independent account), the largest size the cap allows is simply worth more: twice the value per month at 200K.
3. **Payout requests.** Two 200K accounts make half as many payout requests for the same money. If refusals are a risk per request (Chapter 29), fewer, larger requests lose the firm less often.
4. **Spread of outcomes.** Four accounts started at different times are not perfectly correlated, so four 100K accounts give a smoother cash path than two 200K accounts with the same mean.
5. **Work and lot size.** Fewer accounts mean fewer orders; larger accounts round lot sizes less.

Programme	100K fee	200K fee	200K – 2 × 100K fee	2 × 100K: EV/month	1 × 200K: EV/month	Difference	Cheaper per dollar
FTMO 2-Step	\$632	\$1,264	\$0	\$10,926	\$11,061	+\$135	equal
FundedNext Stellar	\$549.99	\$1,049.99	−\$49.99	\$7,609	\$7,679	+\$70	200K
Fintokei ProTrader	\$549	\$1,249	\$151	\$8,144	\$7,748	−\$396	100K
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	\$497	\$997	\$3	\$12,743	\$12,757	+\$14	equal
FunderPro Classic	\$539	\$989	−\$89	\$15,468	\$15,903	+\$436	200K
GFT Standard	\$524	\$974	−\$74	\$7,907	\$7,591	−\$316	200K
BrightFunded Classic	\$580	\$1,163	\$3	\$8,366	\$8,297	−\$69	equal
Blue Guardian 2-Step	\$579	\$1,162	\$4	\$5,620	\$5,669	+\$49	equal

Same setting scaled, same paths and random numbers (so the difference is mostly the fee and the rules that do not scale, such as GFT's \$10,000 payout cap, which is 5% of a 200K account but 6% would be allowed on 100K).

The answer, firm by firm. Where the 200K fee is exactly twice the 100K fee (FTMO, Alpha Capital), the two choices are worth the same. Where the 200K fee is lower per dollar (FundedNext, FunderPro, GFT), 200K is worth more, by about the saving times the number of attempts a month. Where it is higher (Fintokei: \$1,249 against 2 × \$549), 100K is worth more. Rules can override the fee: GFT's first two payouts are capped at \$10,000, which binds a 200K account's 6% cycle (\$12,000), so 2 × 100K would be worth \$7,907 against \$7,591; but GFT forbids duplicated trades between its accounts, so only one account can be used, and the larger one is worth more.

Where only one account is allowed (FunderPro, GFT, FundedNext on its own market), the largest size the cap allows is used, because one 200K account is worth about twice one 100K account.

FTMO, 4 × 100K or 2 × 200K. Same fee per dollar, same value: the whole recommended portfolio is worth $\$138,412 \pm \$4,867$ a month with four 100K accounts and $\$138,445 \pm \$4,850$ with two 200K accounts. The differences are second-order. Two accounts make half as many payout requests (1.38 against 0.69 a month), so if payouts can be refused, two 200K accounts lose the firm a little less often (Chapter 29: \$95,853 against \$93,711 in the tiered scenario, within the noise). Four accounts give a smoother cash path. The plan uses four 100K accounts for the headline figure; two 200K accounts are an equally good choice with half the orders.

Running every account at once

28.1 Why the values add

By linearity (2.1), the expected value per month of a set of slots is the sum of their values, however the accounts are correlated. What correlation changes is the spread: in a bad week every Nasdaq account loses together.

28.2 One direction per market

No two of your accounts ever hold opposite positions on the same market at the same time. Most firms call that hedging across accounts, and FTMO forbids it across firms as well. So the plan uses one direction rule per market group: when a new trade opens and another of your accounts already holds that market, the new trade takes the same direction; when none does, the rule decides (the sign of the last five hourly closes). This rule has no edge (version 4 tested it on eight independent paths: $+\$280 \pm \529 a month against random). Its only job is to keep every account on the same side.

28.3 The lockstep simulation

The portfolio results come from an engine that runs every account of one person on one shared price path and one calendar (lockstep.py). Trades are processed in the order of their entry time, so the shared-direction rule is enforced exactly, every firm's rules are applied to its own accounts, and every fee, phase result and payout is written to a dated ledger. Each portfolio is run for 400 simulated years: 50 independent first years of the plan on each of 8 independent sets of paths (Nasdaq paths 21–28 with their own gold, yen and euro paths). The real history is not used here, because it has no independent gold, yen and euro histories aligned with the Nasdaq; each programme's real-history check is in its own chapter. In 2,800 simulated years, no two accounts ever held opposite positions.

28.4 The portfolios

Portfolio	Accounts	Firms	EV/month, first year (95%)	Months 2–12	First-year cash p5	median	p95	Lowest cumulative cash: median	p5
Tier A only	15	5	\$63,427 $\pm$ \$2,734	\$69,644	\$297,194	\$714,850	\$1,400,570	–\$36,112	–\$93,049
Tiers A and B	22	7	\$95,560 $\pm$ \$3,735	\$104,884	\$471,249	\$1,107,338	\$1,966,711	–\$46,619	–\$110,946
Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm)	28	13	\$138,412 $\pm$ \$4,867	\$151,557	\$858,837	\$1,552,019	\$2,745,202	–\$59,276	–\$136,015
Recommended, FTMO as 2 $\times$ 200K	26	13	\$138,445 $\pm$ \$4,850	\$151,593	\$844,137	\$1,548,773	\$2,750,231	–\$59,381	–\$136,015
All firms at full allowance	35	13	\$163,234 $\pm$ \$5,965	\$179,442	\$926,528	\$1,846,874	\$3,211,693	–\$74,793	–\$175,933
Full allowance + The5ers small accounts	45	13	\$169,645 $\pm$ \$5,872	\$186,424	\$1,035,617	\$1,933,346	\$3,420,906	–\$75,575	–\$178,542
Recommended + futures (Topstep 5, Apex 20)	53	15	\$151,715 $\pm$ \$5,631	\$166,433	\$867,693	\$1,707,147	\$3,051,054	–\$70,688	–\$155,078

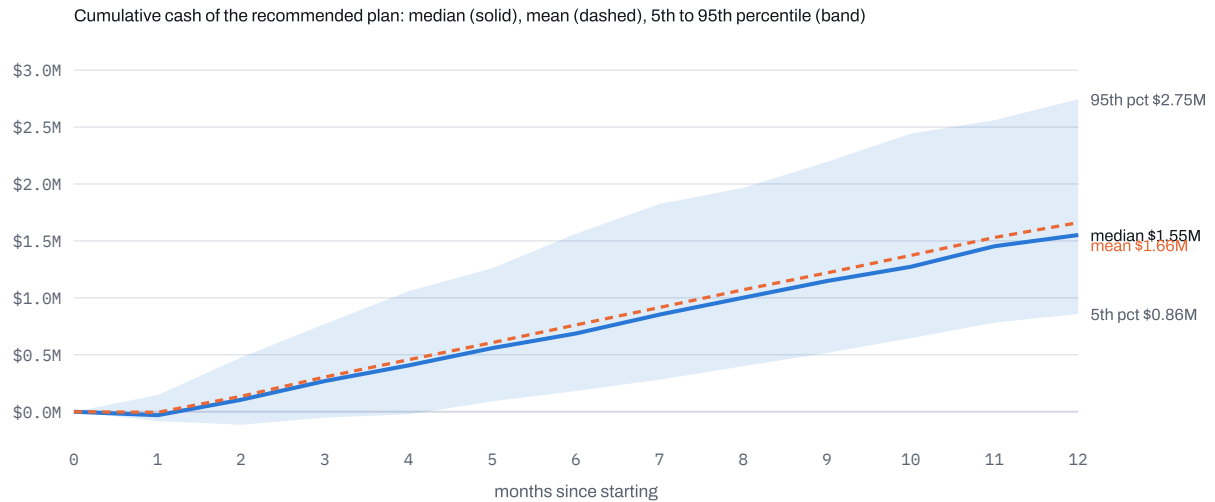
400 simulated first years per portfolio (lockstep_portfolio_v6.py). EV/month: total cash over the year $\div$ 12, including the first month's fees before any payout. Lowest cumulative cash: the deepest point of the running total of fees paid minus cash received, i.e. the money that must be available to pay fees before the payouts arrive.

The portfolio adds up. The recommended portfolio's simulated first year averages \$138,412 a month; the sum of its accounts' renewal–reward values from Part II is \$139,369. Linearity (2.1) says these must agree, and they do within the simulation's interval ($\pm \$4,867$). From the second month on, when the first payouts arrive, the average is \$151,557 a month. Every one of the 400 simulated first years ended ahead (the lowest at \$475,799); the 5th percentile of the first year's cash is \$858,837.

No account ever opposed another. In 2,800 simulated years the engine recorded 0 moments when two accounts held opposite positions on the same market. A person running the recommended plan places about 63 orders a day across all accounts.

More accounts. The full allowance (35 accounts) adds \$24,822 a month, all of it at tier-D firms. The futures layer adds \$13,303, and The5ers' ten small accounts change nothing measurable (\$6,411, inside the noise of $\pm \$5,872$). Whether the extra tier-D accounts are worth it depends on how far their payouts can be trusted, which is the subject of Chapter 29.

28.5 Month by month



400 simulated first years of the recommended plan (28 accounts at 13 firms). Cash = payouts received minus fees paid. The table below gives the same numbers month by month.

Month	Mean cash	p10	median	p90	Cumulative mean	Ahead (cumulative > 0)
1	-\$6,181	-\$76,310	-\$30,302	\$103,380	-\$6,181	38%
2	\$141,322	-\$38,541	\$112,680	\$366,281	\$135,141	73%
3	\$171,133	-\$17,253	\$138,765	\$402,685	\$306,274	91%
4	\$150,901	-\$30,614	\$112,091	\$371,357	\$457,175	94%
5	\$149,602	-\$30,632	\$111,743	\$376,569	\$606,778	98%
6	\$156,353	-\$25,392	\$131,756	\$371,967	\$763,130	99%
7	\$153,367	-\$26,512	\$114,331	\$391,328	\$916,498	99%
8	\$155,534	-\$14,204	\$121,181	\$384,323	\$1,072,032	100%
9	\$148,325	-\$26,452	\$111,947	\$381,259	\$1,220,357	100%
10	\$152,356	-\$21,339	\$121,231	\$371,236	\$1,372,713	100%
11	\$157,300	-\$12,980	\$120,452	\$392,376	\$1,530,013	100%
12	\$130,932	-\$35,226	\$94,725	\$350,790	\$1,660,945	100%

If payouts can be refused

Every firm keeps the right to refuse a payout it judges to break its rules, so each payout is, in the end, the firm's decision. Nobody publishes how often it happens. This chapter turns that uncertainty into numbers.

29.1 A model

Suppose each payout request at a firm is refused with probability ρ , independently, and that a refusal ends your use of that firm (in practice it usually comes with the account closed). The number of paid requests before the first refusal is geometric:

$$\Pr(\text{first refusal at request } j) = (1 - \rho)^{j-1} \rho, \quad \mathbb{E}[\text{paid requests}] = \frac{1 - \rho}{\rho}.$$

If a firm's accounts make r requests a month, the firm is expected to last $1/(\rho r)$ months, and over a horizon of H months the fraction of its all-paid value you keep is about

$$\frac{1 - e^{-\rho r H}}{\rho r H}.$$

Two consequences follow. A firm with many accounts makes many requests and is lost sooner, so stacking accounts at one firm is worth less than it looks; and spreading the same money over more firms keeps more of it. In the recommended plan the four FTMO accounts together make about 1.38 requests a month: at $\rho = 2\%$, FTMO is expected to last $1/(0.02 \times 1.38) = 36$ months. The single FunderPro 200K account makes 0.45 requests a month: at $\rho = 15\%$, it is expected to last $1/(0.15 \times 0.45) = 15$ months.

29.2 Tiers and scenarios

Tier	Evidence (4 October 2026)	Firms	Refusal chance per request: tiered harsh	
A	PropFirmMap A/A+, TrustPilot profile active	FTMO, FundingPips, The5ers, FXIFY, FundedNext, Topstep	2%	5%
B	PropFirmMap B+, TrustPilot active	Fintokei, Hola Prime, Apex	5%	10%
D	TrustPilot rating withheld for fake reviews; PropFirmMap D	Alpha Capital, FunderPro, GFT, BrightFunded, Blue Guardian, Maven	15%	30%

The refusal chances are judgements, not measurements. The tiers come from public evidence: in August and September 2026 TrustPilot withheld the ratings of six firms for fake reviews (checked on their pages on 4 October 2026), and PropFirmMap grades them D. Two scenarios are used: *tiered* (2% / 5% / 15% for tiers A / B / D) and *harsh* (5% / 10% / 30%).

29.3 What it does to each portfolio

Portfolio	All payouts honoured	Tiered	kept	Harsh	kept
Tier A only	\$63,427	\$52,223	82%	\$39,868	63%
Tiers A and B	\$95,560	\$70,847	74%	\$52,012	54%
Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm)	\$138,412	\$93,711	68%	\$64,499	47%
Recommended, FTMO as 2 × 200K	\$138,445	\$95,853	69%	\$68,340	49%
All firms at full allowance	\$163,234	\$96,684	59%	\$62,967	39%
Full allowance + The5ers small accounts	\$169,645	\$98,766	58%	\$63,264	37%
Recommended + futures (Topstep 5, Apex 20)	\$151,715	\$94,644	62%	\$62,850	41%

First-year average per month. Each payout request is refused with its firm's probability; after a refusal the person stops using that firm. Ten random draws of refusals per simulated year.

Firm	Tier	Payout requests a month	Average request	Net cash a month	Expected months until a refusal (tiered)
FTMO	A	1.38	\$24,075	\$24,105	36
FundingPips	A	1.36	\$20,573	\$21,083	37
The5ers	A	0.32	\$20,387	\$5,072	156
FXIFY	A	1.01	\$8,581	\$6,234	49
FundedNext	A	0.23	\$38,428	\$6,649	216
Fintokei	B	1.47	\$20,108	\$22,120	14
Hola Prime	B	0.87	\$13,368	\$8,580	23
Alpha Capital	D	0.34	\$47,623	\$12,325	20
FunderPro	D	0.45	\$48,538	\$16,970	15
GFT	D	0.92	\$9,767	\$6,982	7

Firm	Tier	Payout requests a month	Average request	Net cash a month	Expected months until a refusal (tiered)
BrightFunded	D	0.27	\$19,932	\$3,617	25
Blue Guardian	D	0.29	\$13,908	\$2,587	23
Maven	D	0.49	\$6,177	\$2,086	14

Recommended plan, first-year averages from the portfolio simulation.

Bold play makes requests rare and large: the recommended plan's 28 accounts make about 9.4 payout requests a month in all. In the tiered scenario the plan keeps 68% of its value over the first year; in the harsh scenario 47%. The full allowance, with three more tier-D accounts at BrightFunded and at Blue Guardian and a second Alpha account, is worth \$24,822 more if every payout is honoured, but only \$2,973 more in the tiered scenario and -\$1,531 in the harsh one: more requests at the doubtful firms mean losing them sooner. That is why the recommended plan holds one account at each tier-D firm.

PART IV

Running it

The settings of every account in one place, the routine that runs them, and everything that could make the numbers wrong.

The routine

30.1 Every account's settings

Programme	Accounts	Market	Risk per trade	Stop	Size	k (target cap)	Cycle target	EV/month
FTMO 2-Step	4 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	0.5 σ = 42.5 points	\$35.28/pt	20	\$30,000	\$21,852
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (85%) (cap)	4 × 100K	USDJPY	\$1,500	0.5 σ = 9.4 pips	25.14 lots	20	\$25,000	\$22,866
The5ers High Stakes Classic	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	0.5 σ = 42.5 points	\$35.28/pt	20	\$25,000	\$4,775
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$17.64/pt	12	\$30,000	\$4,046
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 50K	Nasdaq	\$750	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$8.82/pt	12	\$15,000	\$1,759
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 25K	Nasdaq	\$375	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$4.41/pt	12	\$7,500	\$836
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 10K	Nasdaq	\$150	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$1.76/pt	12	\$3,000	\$321
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 5K	Nasdaq	\$75	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$0.88/pt	12	\$1,500	\$134
FundedNext Stellar	1 × 200K	EURUSD	\$3,000	1 σ = 9.6 pips	31.26 lots	20	\$50,000	\$7,679
Fintokei ProTrader	5 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	0.5 σ = 42.5 points	\$35.28/pt	12	\$25,000	\$20,361
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	2 × 100K	gold	\$1,500	1 σ = 11.9 dollars	1.27 lots	10	\$20,000	\$9,156
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,000	0.5 σ = 42.5 points	\$70.56/pt	30	\$60,000	\$12,757
FunderPro Classic	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,000	0.35 σ = 29.8 points	\$100.80/pt	30	\$60,000	\$15,903
GFT Standard	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,000	0.75 σ = 63.8 points	\$47.04/pt	8	\$16,000	\$7,591
BrightFunded Classic	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	0.5 σ = 42.5 points	\$35.28/pt	12	\$25,000	\$4,183
Blue Guardian 2-Step	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$17.64/pt	8	\$18,000	\$2,810
Maven 2-Step	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$17.64/pt	7	\$8,000	\$2,341

Stops in points (Nasdaq), pips (USDJPY, EURUSD) or dollars (gold) at the prices of 2 October 2026. They move with the market: recompute $m\sigma \times \text{price}$ every week with the current price; σ is re-measured monthly. Size: lots for currency pairs (standard lot) and gold (100 oz); for index CFDs, dollars per index point, to be divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot. The take-profit is the smaller of k times the risk and the distance to the current target, plus the cost (4.1).

30.2 Placing a trade, step by step

- 1. Is a trade allowed now?** Entry hours (Nasdaq 01:00–20:00 UTC, USDJPY 00:00–20:00, EURUSD 07:00–20:00, gold 01:00–20:00), weekdays only, nothing new after 19:00 UTC on Friday, nothing from 15 minutes before to 5 minutes after a high-impact US release, and at least 10 minutes since this account's last losing trade in the same direction (FundingPips' trade-idea rule, applied everywhere).
- 2. Direction.** If any of your accounts holds this market, the same direction. Otherwise the plan's rule: long if the last completed hourly close is above the close five hours earlier, short if below. The rule has no edge (Chapter 11); its only job is that no two of your accounts are ever opposite.
- 3. Risk.** l = the smallest of 1.5% of the account, the room above the maximum-loss floor less 0.1% of the account, and the room left in today's daily loss less 0.2%. If that is under 0.15% of the account, stop for the day.
- 4. Stop.** $m\sigma$ times the current price, from the settings card; the size is l divided by the stop in points times the dollars per point per lot, rounded *down*.
- 5. Take-profit.** The win w is the smallest of $k l$, the distance to the phase target or the cycle target, and any cap the firm sets (best day, daily profit, FundingPips' 55% of the phase target). The take-profit distance is the stop distance times $(w + c)/l$, with c the measured round-trip cost of this size.
- 6. Place it as one bracket order:** entry, stop and take-profit together. Never move either.
- 7. Log it:** time, account, market, direction, size, stop, target, and the fill. The log is the evidence for any review.

30.3 Phases, payouts and refills

- When a phase target is reached: stop. If the firm requires more trading days, place one minimal trade (the smallest lot) on each remaining day where it counts *trading* days; where it counts *profitable* days the daily target of 6.4 has already met it.
- When a funded account reaches its cycle target: stop trading it, request the payout on the first allowed day, withdraw everything above the starting balance, and start the next cycle at the start balance.
- When an account fails (phase or funded): buy the next evaluation of the same programme the same day. A slot is never left empty: the renewal–reward value assumes it.
- Never let an account lapse for inactivity, never abandon a funded account, never trade an account to lose it. Account rolling is prohibited at most firms, and the plan's value does not need it.

30.4 Cash needed

Fees are paid before payouts arrive. In the simulation the running total of the recommended plan (fees out, payouts in) falls to $-\$59,276$ at its lowest in a typical first year, and to $-\$136,015$ in the worst 5%. Starting with that much available (or starting fewer slots and adding them as payouts arrive) keeps every slot filled. The first month alone costs about $\$6,181$ net.

30.5 Workload

About 63 bracket orders a day across 28 accounts, each set and left, plus payout requests and evaluation purchases. The order times follow the market, so the routine is best run from a written checklist with alarms at the entry hours.

What could make the numbers wrong

31.1 Higher trading costs

The single most important assumption is the cost κ of a round trip. Every programme was rerun with all costs (spreads, commissions, slippage and financing) multiplied by 1.5 and by 2:

Programme	Market	Engine EV/month: cost $\times$ 1	$\times$ 1.5	$\times$ 2	Chain: value of an attempt	$\times$ 1.5	$\times$ 2
FTMO 2-Step	Nasdaq	\$5,411	\$5,350	\$4,910	\$1,749	-8%	-16%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (85%) (cap)	USDJPY	\$5,341	\$4,692	\$3,510	\$1,860	-26%	-46%
The5ers High Stakes Classic	Nasdaq	\$4,627	\$4,136	\$4,023	\$2,129	-7%	-13%
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	Nasdaq	\$3,918	\$3,714	\$3,127	\$2,337	-9%	-18%
FundedNext Stellar	EURUSD	\$3,630	\$3,153	\$2,273	\$1,958	-11%	-19%
Fintokei ProTrader	Nasdaq	\$3,932	\$3,581	\$3,344	\$1,863	-10%	-18%
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	gold	\$4,362	\$4,043	\$3,578	\$1,859	-12%	-23%
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	Nasdaq	\$6,654	\$5,516	\$5,960	\$1,872	-7%	-13%
FunderPro Classic	Nasdaq	\$7,657	\$8,082	\$7,785	\$1,756	-10%	-17%
GFT Standard	Nasdaq	\$3,877	\$3,569	\$3,326	\$1,961	-12%	-23%
BrightFunded Classic	Nasdaq	\$4,458	\$3,847	\$3,765	\$1,689	-10%	-19%
Blue Guardian 2-Step	Nasdaq	\$3,072	\$2,829	\$2,496	\$1,497	-6%	-11%
Maven 2-Step	Nasdaq	\$2,337	\$2,264	\$2,065	\$1,297	-8%	-16%

One 100K account. Engine: 12,000 attempts per cell on fresh paths with the same random numbers in each row, so the columns are paired; even so each cell is uncertain by $\pm\$150$ – $\$650$ (8.4), and a row can rise by chance. Chain: the exact equations of 5.6 with the cost scaled, noise-free but without financing or time effects; it shows the size of the cost effect on the value of one attempt.

Scaled to the recommended plan, the value per month is about \$139,369 at the assumed costs, \$129,202 at 1.5 times and \$116,300 at twice. The Nasdaq and gold accounts hold up best (their κ/σ is lowest); the currency accounts lose more. **Measure your real costs in the first week** (the fill against the quoted price, spread and commission, per account) and redo the settings card if they differ from the table of 3.1 by more than a quarter.

31.2 Payouts refused, accounts closed

Chapter 29 puts numbers on it: \$93,711 a month if payouts are refused at 2/5/15% per request by tier, \$64,499 at 5/10/30%. The plan's defence is to follow every written rule exactly and keep the evidence (the trade log), not to disguise anything. Firms most often cite "gambling", "one-sided betting", copy trading from others and hedging across accounts. The plan risks 1.5% with a stop on every trade, trades both directions, copies nobody, and never holds opposite positions. But bold play does produce large single-trade wins, and a firm may still review them. That is a real risk that no model can price.

31.3 Spread widening and tight stops

The stops are 0.35–1 hourly standard deviations: Nasdaq 29.8–85.0 points; USDJPY 9.4 pips; EURUSD 9.6 pips; gold 11.9 dollars. Spreads on CFDs widen several-fold at the daily break (about 21:00–22:00 UTC), at the weekly open and around news. A stop within a widened spread of the price can be filled without the mid price touching it. The engine's cost is an average and does not model this; it is the reason for the plan's 0.35 limit. If positions held through the daily break are stopped noticeably more often than the model's win rates (4.2) imply, close them before the break. A forced close is a fair stopping time, so it costs only the extra round trip.

31.4 Rules change

Every rule in Part II was read on 4 October 2026, and prop firms change them often: leverage, consistency rules, payout schedules, prices and per-person limits most of all. Recheck each firm's rules page before buying, and rerun the programme's optimisation (optimize_v6.py) when a rule that enters the model changes.

31.5 The model itself

- **Zero skill is an assumption in your favour only if it is true.** If entries are systematically late, fills systematically worse, or the price moves against new positions (adverse selection), the edge is negative and the cost check of 31.1 is the guide: twice the cost is an extra cost of $c/l = \kappa/(m\sigma)$ per trade: 4.7% of the risk on the Nasdaq at $m = 0.5$, 6.7% at 0.35.
- **Volatility changes.** σ moves over time; stops are set in units of the current σ , so the plan adapts, and the calibration is the 2024–26 average.
- **Gaps and limits.** The engine fills gaps at the open and fails accounts whose daily or maximum loss a gap breaks, as the firms do.

- **Independence of firms.** Values add (linearity), but in a bad week every Nasdaq account loses together; the month table of Chapter 28 shows the spread.
- **Taxes and payment costs** are not modelled.

31.6 What is not allowed, and is not in the plan

No hedging across accounts or firms; no accounts in anyone else's name; no copy-trading services or other people's signals; no trading of news windows the firm restricts; no tick scalping, latency or gap arbitrage; no grid or martingale sizing; no abandoned or deliberately failed accounts. Do not share or sell the plan: several firms treat traders who run the same marketed strategy as a group, and close them together.

Formula sheet

Quantity	Formula	Where
Value of one attempt	$\mathbb{E}[V] = \Pr(\text{pass}) \mathbb{E}[C] - F$	1.2
Notional, target distance	$N = l/(m\sigma), u = m\sigma(w + c)/l$	4.1
Win probability of a bracket	$p = l/(l + w + c)$	4.2
Mean and variance of a trade	$-c$ and $l(w + c)$	4.3
Cost per unit of risk	$c/l = \kappa/(m\sigma)$; financing per night $\varphi/(m\sigma)$	4.4
Pass probability, no cost	$B/(A + B)$	5.1
Pass probability, Brownian with cost	$(e^{\theta B} - 1)/(e^{\theta(A+B)} - 1), \theta = 2c/v$	5.2
Expected trades, Brownian	$((1 - P)B - PA)/c \rightarrow AB/v$	5.3
Exact chain	$V(x) = pV(x + w) + (1 - p)V(x - l - c)$	5.6
Pass probability, exact, any k	$P = (B - \mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}])/(A + B)$	5.6
Bold play	$P = 1 - \prod_j (1 - p_j), p_j = l/(l + A - x_j + c), x_j = -j(l + c)$	5.6
Two phases	$P = P_1 P_2$	6.1
Withdrawal identity	$\mathbb{E}[W] = D - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost of funded trades}]$	7.1
Funded cash, cycle form	$\alpha(X_1 q_1 + X q_1 q/(1 - q)) + R q_1 q^{r-1}$	7.2
Trade duration (hours of open market)	$m^2(w + c)/l$; winners $m^2(b^2 + 2b)/3$, losers $m^2(1 + 2b)/3, b = (w + c)/l$	8.1
Phase market time, zero cost	$(A/l)(B/l) m^2$ hours	8.2
Value per month	$30.44 \mathbb{E}[V]/\mathbb{E}[T_{\text{days}}]$	8.3
Standard error of a ratio estimate	$\text{sd}(V_i - \hat{r}T_i)/(\sqrt{n}\bar{T})$	8.4
Smallest stop the leverage allows	$m_{\min} = (l/S)/(0.6\lambda\sigma)$	10.2
Scaling an account	$\mathbb{E}[V](\lambda S) = \lambda \Pr(\text{pass}) \mathbb{E}[C](S) - F(\lambda S)$	27.2
Refusals	$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid requests}] = (1 - \rho)/\rho$; firm life $1/(\rho r)$	29.1

Glossary

Allowance D	The funded account's maximum loss: the floor sits D below the starting balance.
Attempt	One evaluation bought, from purchase until a phase fails or the funded account that followed it is lost.
Bold play	Staking enough on each bet to reach the goal in one win; optimal in fair and unfavourable games (Dubins and Savage).
Bracket	A position with its stop-loss and take-profit attached at entry and never moved.
Cycle target $\bar{X}$	The profit at which the funded account stops and requests a payout.
Engine	The rule-by-rule simulation of an account on hourly price paths (acct_mc.py, pathfirm.py, lockstep.py).
Exact chain	The trade-level Markov chain of 5.6, solved by iteration (analytic_v6.py).
k	Reward-to-risk: a full win nets k times the risk after costs.
m	The stop distance in hourly standard deviations of the market.
Renewal-reward	The long-run value per unit time of a repeated process: $\mathbb{E}[V]/\mathbb{E}[T]$.
Slot	One account position at one firm, refilled with a new evaluation whenever an attempt ends.
Tier	A firm's reliability class (A, B, D) from public evidence, used for the refusal scenarios.
Winner's curse	The upward bias of the best of many noisy estimates; removed here by reporting every figure from paths not used to choose it.

How every number was computed

File	What it does
<code>fetch_data.py</code>	downloads two years of hourly bars from Yahoo Finance (not redistributed)
<code>calibrate.py</code> , <code>sigma_v32.json</code>	costs, financing and trading hours per market; hourly volatilities
<code>multi.py</code> , <code>pathfirm.py</code>	synthetic price paths (12 years, Brownian-bridge extremes) and the bracket trader on a path
<code>acct_mc.py</code> , <code>firms_v3.py</code> , <code>firms_v5.py</code>	the rule engine (phases, funded accounts, payouts) and every firm's rules
<code>optimize_v6.py</code>	grid, refine, edges, bold play, final, robust stages (<code>opt_v6_*.jsonl</code> / <code>.json</code>)
<code>analytic_v6.py</code>	the Brownian formulas and the exact chain, written independently of the engine
<code>verify_v6.py</code> , <code>extra_v6.py</code> , <code>sens_v6.py</code>	checks against theory; zero-cost checks; cost, risk, k, direction and financing sensitivities
<code>lockstep.py</code> , <code>lockstep_portfolio_v6.py</code>	one person's accounts on one shared path and calendar; refusal scenarios (<code>lockstep_v6.json</code>)
<code>progs_v6.py</code>	the firms' written rules and sources, as quoted in Part II
<code>build_math_v6.py</code> , <code>doc6_*.py</code>	this document: every number is read from the files above

To reproduce: `python3 fetch_data.py` (real-history checks only); `python3 optimize_v6.py grid`, then `refine`, `extra`, `edge`, `futures`, `futures_refine`, `bold`, `final6`, `robust`; `python3 sens_v6.py`; `python3 extra_v6.py`; `python3 verify_v6.py`; `python3 lockstep_portfolio_v6.py --lives=50`; `python3 build_math_v6.py`. Synthetic paths are rebuilt exactly from their seeds and `sigma_v32.json`; no price data is needed for them.

Sources

Programme	Sources (read 4 October 2026)
FTMO 2-Step Challenge	ftmo.com (trading objectives; FAQ on accounts and the \$400,000 cap; forbidden practices); propfirmmatch.com (FTMO leverage)
FundingPips 2-Step Flex	protradingvibes.com (FundingPips rules, updated 16 Sep 2026; account types and leverage); help.fundingpips.com (2 Step Flex; Risk Per Trade Idea); search summaries of the Profit Concentration Policy
The5ers High Stakes	the5ers.com (High Stakes page; payout policy and hub credit FAQ); propfirmbridge.com (High Stakes review, 15 Sep 2026)
FXIFY Two Phase Classic	cryptoslate.com (FXIFY review, updated 4 Oct 2026: Classic and Pro prices and rules); fxify.com FAQs ("What is the max allocation?"; 2 Phase Pro max allocation; copy trading); search summaries of FXIFY leverage
FundedNext Stellar 2-Step	help.fundednext.com (Stellar 2-Step, updated 2 Oct 2026; copy trading; prohibited strategies); protradingvibes.com (Stellar 2-Step; consistency rule); search summaries of FundedNext leverage and 200K price
Fintokei ProTrader	fintokei.com (ProTrader page); Fintokei ProTrader terms (version 6); support.fintokei.com (consistency rules); propfirmmap.com
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	holaprime.com (2-Step Prime FAQ; prohibited trading practices); propfirmmap.com; thetrustedprop.com
Alpha Capital Alpha Pro 10%	alphacapitalgroup.uk; tradetanto.com; quantvps.com (Alpha payout rules); trustpilot.com (rating withheld)
FunderPro Classic	support.funderpro.com (leverage; consistency rule); tradelocker.com hub (prices); trustpilot.com (rating withheld)
Goat Funded Trader 2-Step Standard	help.goatfundedtrader.com (2-Step Standard); cryptoslate.com; tradelocker.com hub (prices); trustpilot.com (rating withheld)
BrightFunded 2-Step Classic	tradetanto.com; protradingvibes.com (BrightFunded leverage); help.brightfunded.com (refund); trustpilot.com (rating withheld)
Blue Guardian 2-Step Standard	help.blueguardian.com (2 Step Standard rules); propfirmbridge.com; trustpilot.com (rating withheld)
Maven 2-Step	propfirmsradar.com; thepropfirmguide.com; lunefi.com (Maven rules); trustpilot.com (rating withheld)
Topstep 50K Trading Combine (futures, optional)	help.topstep.com (pricing); protradingvibes.com (Combine rules, Sep 2026)
Apex 4.0 50K EOD (futures, optional)	phidiaspropfirm.com (Apex 4.0); apextraderfunding.com help centre; propfirmmap.com (Apex)

Reliability evidence: TrustPilot company pages (rating withheld notices, August–September 2026) and PropFirmMap safety grades, both checked on 4 October 2026.